PRABHAT

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

WELFARE SCHEMES AND POLICIES

FOR COMPETITIVE EXAMS

COVERS

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Environmental Policies in India

Policies of Welfare of Minorities

Agriculture Policies

Must for IAS Prelims & Mains, CDS, NDA, CAPF and States PCS

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

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TEAM PRABHAT

PRABHAT EXAM

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GOVERNMENT OF INDIA WELFARE SCHEMES & POLICIES
For Competitive Exams

by Team Prabhat

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1 Major Government Initiatives, Welfare Schemes and Flagship Programmes in India

MAHATMA GANDHI NATIONAL RURAL EMPLOYMENT GUARANTEE ACT (MGNREGA)

The Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA) is an Indian job guarantee scheme, enacted by legislation on 25 August 2005. The scheme provides a legal guarantee for at least 100 days of employment in every financial year to adult members of any household willing to do public work-related unskilled manual work at the statutory minimum wage of 120 (US$2.10) per day in 2009 prices. If they fail to do so, the government has to pay the salary at their homes. The central government's outlay for the scheme was 4,000 billion (US$69 billion) in the FY 2010–2011. This act was introduced with an aim of improving the purchasing power of the rural people, primarily semi- or un-skilled work to people living in rural India, whether or not they are below the poverty line. Around one-third of the stipulated workforce is women. The law was initially called the National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (NREGA) and was renamed on 2 October 2009. In 2011, the programme was widely criticized, as it was no more effective than other poverty reduction programmes in India. Despite its best intentions, MGNREGA is beset with controversy about corrupt officials, deficit financing as the source of funds, poor quality of infrastructure built under this programme and unintended destructive effect on poverty.

History

MGNREGA was launched on 2 February 2006 from Anantapur in Andhra Pradesh and initially covered 200 of the 'poorest' districts of the country. The Act was implemented in phases; 130 districts were added from 2007 to 2008. With its spread to over 626 districts across the country, the flagship programme of the UPA government has the potential to increase the purchasing power of rural poor, reduce distress migration and to create useful assets in rural India. It can foster social and gender equality, as 23%

workers under the scheme are Scheduled Castes, 17% Scheduled Tribes and 50% women. In 2010–2011, 41 million households were employed on NREGA worksites. The Act was passed by the Lok Sabha on 23 August 2004 and was signed by the President of India on 5 September 2005.

Implementation

The Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) of India, in its performance audit of the implementation of MGNREGA, has found 'significant deficiencies' in the implementation of the Act. The plan was launched in February 2006 in 200 districts and eventually extended to cover 593 districts. During 2008–2009, 44,940,870 rural households were provided jobs under NREGA, with a national average of 48 working days per household. In recent times, NREGA workers have faced delays in payment of wages, some of which have been pending for months. In July 2012, the government admitted that the programme is plagued with corruption, and it needs to be dealt with meaningfully.

Works/Activities

The MGNREGA achieves twin objectives of rural development and employment. The act stipulates that work must be targeted towards a set of specific rural development activities, such as water conservation and harvesting, afforestation, rural connectivity, flood control and protection such as construction and repair of embankments, etc. Digging of new tanks/ponds, percolation tanks and construction of small check dams are also given importance. The employers are given work such as land levelling, tree plantation, etc. Firstly, a proposal is given by the panchayat to the block office and then the office decides whether the work should be sanctioned. In Rangareddy district, manchal mandal, the dry land horticulture and plantation of trees on the bunds of the fields taken up under MGVN programme, is taken up in a big way.

MGNREGA 2.0

MGNREGA 2.0 is an attempt to overcome the weaknesses of the earlier programme and infuse it with a truly livelihood generation character through a focus on the creation of durable assets and improvement in rural productivity. The vision is of an initiative whose success breeds its own demise, with more and more people no longer requiring its support. Thirty new works have been added to the programme's list. Earlier, only

eight types of works were allowed. The programme now covers almost every source of rural livelihood in every agro-ecological zone, from poultry to fishery and from watershed development to sanitation works.

SARVA SHIKSHA ABHIYAN (SSA)

Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan (SSA) is Government of India's flagship programme for the achievement of Universalization of Elementary Education (UEE) in a time bound manner, as mandated by 86th amendment to the Constitution of India making free and compulsory education to the children of 6–14 years age group, a fundamental right.

SSA is being implemented in partnership with state governments to cover the entire country and address the needs of 192 million children in 1.1 million habitations.

The programme seeks to open new schools in those habitations, which do not have schooling facilities and strengthen existing school infrastructure through provision of additional classrooms, toilets, drinking water, maintenance grant and school improvement grants.

Existing schools with inadequate teacher strength are provided with additional teachers, while the capacity of existing teachers is being strengthened by extensive training, grants for developing teaching-learning materials and strengthening of the academic support structure at a cluster, block and district level.

SSA seeks to provide quality elementary education including life skills. SSA has a special focus on girl's education and children with special needs. SSA also seeks to provide computer education to bridge the digital divide.

APPLICATIONS OF INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY (ICT)

Resource mapping for fisheries

- Remote sensing technology can be used for effective management of vital resources like water. Using data from satellites, government agencies and institutions can plan effective utilization such as watershed management and development of fisheries.
- The chlorophyll image of Indian coastline helps to increase the fish catch by 2–3 times.

- GPS devices in boats have helped fishermen to navigate in the seas and prevent them from getting lost or crossing international borders.
- An app 'Fisher Friend' gives fishermen alerts on weather, potential fishing zones and maritime boundaries.

Agriculture

- One of the challenges for farmers is the lack of access to market information. This creates an imbalance in bargaining power with urban buyers.
- Also, a farmer needs to know about weather on day-to-day basis, new technologies and government schemes for farmer welfare.
- Instruments like media, radio, TV, literature and newspapers were used to transfer agricultural technology to illiterate as well as literate segments of rural populace.
- **Drawback:** Not demand driven and limited scope to get feedback from farmers
- Thus, two-way interactive ICT tools can be used in knowing farmers' opinions and queries and also giving them required information.

Some ICT tools are as follows

Kisan Vikas Kendras

- Backbone of information and technology dissemination
- Link between scientific community and Indian farmers

Mera Gaon Mera Gaurav

- Agri-scientists would go to villages to help farmers adopt new technologies.
- Scientists form WhatsApp and Facebook groups with rural youths and interact with them frequently.

Interlinking of Agricultural Colleges

- Through IT linkages, there would be more interaction among academics
- Good technology developed anywhere can reach other parts without much delay.

India Initiatives

- Enhancing internet access in rural areas
- As not everyone can afford laptop or smart phone, broadband connections in all gram panchayats have been initiated
- Common Service Centres in villages for poor to have access to internet.

Kisan Call Centre

- Expert advisory system
- Has toll free number to seek expert advice on different matters related to agriculture and allied sector.

mKisan portal

- to provide information to farmers at a single place
- SMS service of the portal to disseminate all central and state government information in their languages
- Semi-literate and illiterate farmers have been targeted with voice messages.

Dairy Sector

- Four new programmes–Pashudhan Sanjeevani, Nakul Swasthya Patra, e-Pashudhan Haat and National Genomics Centre – have been allocated ₹ 850 crores.
- Nakul Swasthya Patra is a 'health card' to keep record of the livestock; farmers will be able to keep the records like health, fertility, production, etc.
- e-Pashudhan Haat created as an online platform to buy and sell cattle
- Automatic milking systems can be used which are computer-controlled standalone systems that milk the dairy cattle without much labour involved.

Welfare Schemes' Implementation

- **PM Fasal Bima Yojana:** Farmers can send photo of damaged crop to authorities via internet. Government will also assess the situation through satellite imagery. After this, insurance claims will be directly sent to bank accounts.
- **PM Krishi Sinchayi Yojana:** It can be used for smart agriculture by measuring soil moisture and then automatically supplying water through drip irrigation.
- Leakages in PDS can be plugged by connecting ration shops through internet and using biometric authentication system of beneficiary.
- Through DBT, subsidy can be directly deposited in the bank accounts. This has effectively stopped black marketing of subsidized LPG cylinders.

Rural Education and Skill Training

Though enrolment of children in primary education is appreciable, the learning outcomes are not encouraging. Using ICT tools in education can improve learning:

- Use of projectors and computers to easily understand complex things
- The need is to train the teachers to use ICT effectively
- Government is promoting ICT use though Rashtriya Madhyaik Shiksha Abhiyan by establishment of smart schools, exclusive teacher for ICT, development of e-content, etc.
- e-Basta is conceived where school books are accessible in digital form as e-books
- Promotion of skills in youth through schemes like Skill India, PM Kaushal Vikas Yojana.

Rural Health Sector

- There is lack of quality infrastructure, dearth of qualified medical practitioners and non-access to basic medicines in rural areas
- Use of telemedicine in which doctors in city can interact with patients in remote villages and prescribe medication– cheap, convenient and less time consuming
- Apps like Mera Doctor launched by private sector, which offers WhatsApp like sessions between patients and licensed doctors to ask questions
- Marketing Needs
- ICT will provide unique opportunities to producers of rural products, agriculture/agro-processing products, rural handicrafts etc. to have direct market access
- National Agriculture Market in field of agri-marketing, which integrates mandis through Internet.

NATIONAL E-GOVERNANCE PLAN

The National e-Governance Plan (NeGP) is a plan of the Government of India to make all government services available to the citizens of India via electronic media. This plan was an outcome of the recommendations of the second Administrative Reforms Commission (ARC). It is under the administration of the Department of Information Technology of the Ministry of Communications and Information Technology,

Government of India. The 11th report of the Second Administrative Reforms Commission, entitled 'Promoting e-Governance – The Smart way forward', established the government's position that an expansion in e-government is necessary in India.

The ARC report was submitted to the GOI on 20 December 2008. The report cited several prior initiatives as source of its inspiration including reference to the Singapore ONE programme. To pursue this goal, the NeGP was formulated by the Department of Information Technology (DIT) and Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances (DARPG). The programme required the development of new applications to allow citizens' access to government service through Common Service Centres; it aims to both reduce government costs and make access to services easier.

Types of Government Interaction in e-Governance

- **G2G:** Government to Government
- **G2C:** Government to Citizen
- **G2B:** Government to Business
- **G2E:** Government to Employee

Government to Citizen (G2C) Initiatives

- **Computerization of Land Records (CLR):** In collaboration with NIC. Ensuring that landowners get computerized copies of ownership, crop and tenancy and updated copies of Records of Rights (RoRs) on demand.
- **Bhoomi Project:** Online delivery of land records. Self-sustainable e-governance project for the computerized delivery of 20 million rural land records to 6.7 million farmers through 177 government-owned kiosks in the state of Karnataka.
- **Gyandoot:** It is an Intranet-based Government to Citizen (G2C) service delivery initiative. It was initiated in the Dhar district of Madhya Pradesh in January 2000 with the twin objective of providing relevant information to the rural population and acting as an interface between the district administration and the people.
- **Lokvani Project in Uttar Pradesh:** Lokvani is a public–private partnership project at Sitapur district in Uttar Pradesh, which was initiated in November 2004. Its objective is to provide a single-

window, self-sustainable e-governance solution with regard to handling of grievances, land record maintenance and providing a mixture of essential services.

- **Project FRIENDS (Fast, Reliable, Instant, Efficient Network for the Disbursement of Services) in Kerala:** FRIENDS is a single-window facility providing citizens the means to pay taxes and other financial dues to the state government. The services are provided through FRIENDS Janasevana Kendrams located in the district headquarters.
- **e-Mitra Project in Rajasthan:** e-Mitra is an integrated project to facilitate the urban and the rural masses with maximum possible services related to different state government departments through Lokmitra-Janmitra Centres/Kiosks.
- **e-Seva (Andhra Pradesh):** This project is designed to provide 'Government to Citizen' and 'e-Business to Citizen' services. The highlight of the e-Seva project is that all the services are delivered online to consumers/citizens by connecting them to the respective government departments and providing online information at the point of service delivery.

Admission to Professional Colleges – Common Entrance Test (CET)

With the rapid growth in the demand as well as supply of professional education, the process of admission to these institutions became a major challenge in the early 1990s. Recourse was then taken to ICT to make the process of admission transparent and objective. One of the pioneering efforts was made by Karnataka. The state government decided to conduct a common entrance test based on which admission to different colleges and disciplines was made.

Government to Business (G2B) Initiatives

- e-Procurement project in Andhra Pradesh and Gujarat.
- To reduce the time and cost of doing business for both vendors and government.

MCA 21: It was started by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs. The project aims at providing easy and secure online access to all registry-

related services provided by the Union Ministry of Corporate Affairs to corporates and other stakeholders at any time and in a manner that best suits them.

Government to Government (G2G) Initiatives

- **Khajane Project in Karnataka:** It is a comprehensive online treasury computerization project of the government of Karnataka. The project has resulted in the computerization of the entire treasury-related activities of the state government, and the system has the ability to track every activity right from the approval of the state budget to the point of rendering accounts to the government.
- **SmartGov (Andhra Pradesh):** SmartGov has been developed to streamline operations, enhance efficiency through workflow automation and knowledge management for implementation in the Andhra Pradesh Secretariat.

National e-Governance Plan

The NeGP has been formulated by the Department of Electronics and Information Technology (DeitY) and Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances (DARPG) in 2006.

The NeGP aims at improving delivery of government services to citizens and businesses with the following vision: 'Make all Government services accessible to the common man in his locality, through common service delivery outlets and ensure efficiency, transparency & reliability of such services at affordable costs to realize the basic needs of the common man'.

Central government initiatives as mission mode projects (MMPs)

e-Office

The Government of India has recognized the need to modernize the central government offices through the introduction of Information and Communications Technology. e-Office is aimed at increasing the usage of work flow and rule-based file routing, quick search and retrieval of files and office orders, digital signatures for authentication, forms and reporting components.

Immigration, Visa and Foreigner's Registration and Tracking (IVFRT)

India has emerged as a key tourist destination, besides being a major business and service hub. immigration check post is the first point of contact that generates public and popular perception about the country, thus necessitating a state of the art system for prompt and user-friendly services.

UID

The unique identification project was conceived as an initiative that would provide identification for each resident across the country and would be used primarily as the basis for efficient delivery of welfare services. It would also act as a tool for effective monitoring of various programmes and schemes of the government.

Pensions

The pensions MMP is primarily aimed at making the pension-/retirement-related information, services and grievances handling mechanism accessible online to the needy pensioners, through a combination of interactive and non-interactive components, and thus, helps bridge the gap between the pensioners and the government.

Banking

The Banking MMP is yet another step towards improving operational efficiency and reducing the delays and efforts involved in handling and settling transactions. The MMP, which is being implemented by the banking industry, aims at streamlining various e-service initiatives undertaken by individual banks. Implementation is being done by the banks concerned, with the banking department providing a broad framework and guidance.

Posts

Modernization of postal services has been undertaken by the department of posts through computerization and networking of all post offices using a central server-based system, and setting up of computerized registration centres (CRCs).

State MMPs

e-Governance in Municipalities

It is a unique initiative of the Government of India conceptualized under the umbrella of the overall NeGP and the Jawaharlal Nehru National Urban Renewal Mission (JNNURM) aimed at improving operational efficiencies within urban local bodies (ULBs).

Crime and Criminal Tracking Network & Systems

Crime and Criminal Tracking Network and Systems (CCTNS) MMP aims at creating a comprehensive and integrated system for enhancing the efficiency and effective policing at all levels and especially at the police station level through adoption of principles of e-governance, and creation of a nationwide networked infrastructure for evolution of IT-enabled state-of-the-art tracking system.

Public Distribution System

Computerization of the PDS is envisaged as an end-to-end project covering key functional areas such as supply chain management, including allocation and utilization reporting, storage and movement of food grains, grievance redressal and transparency portal, digitization of beneficiary database, Fair Price Shop automation, etc.

Health

ICT for programme management has been undertaken by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare in the Mother and Child Tracking System (MCTS) programme, and the Ministry envisages a more comprehensive use of ICT, including for Hospital Information Systems, supply chain management for drugs and vaccines, providing ICT tools to ASHA and ANM workers, programme management of National Rural Health Mission (NRHM), etc., through this MMP.

e-Panchayat

The Panchayati Raj Institutions (PRIs) are saddled with the problems of inadequate physical and financial resources, technical capabilities and extremely limited computerization. As a result, the potential of PRIs as the preferred delivery channel for the schemes of state and centre as well as for citizen services has not been fully realized. While some computerization efforts for PRIs have been made by NIC over the years, the

e-governance revolution sweeping the country has not touched the PRIs yet in significant measure. The Ministry of Panchayati Raj, Government of India, has therefore decided to take up the computerization of PRIs on a mission mode basis.

e-District

e-District is one of the 31 MMPs under NeGP with the DIT, the GOI being the nodal ministry. This project aims at providing support to the basic administrative unit, i.e., district administration by undertaking back-end computerization to enable electronic delivery of high volume citizen centric government services, which would optimally leverage and utilize the three infrastructure pillars of State Wide Area Networks (SWAN), State Data Centres (SDCs) and Common Service Centres (CSCs) to deliver services to the citizen at his doorsteps.

National Land Records Modernization Programme (NLRMP)

A Project for CLR was launched in 1988–89 with the intention to remove the inherent flaws in the manual system of maintenance and updation of Land Records. In 1997–98, the scheme was extended to tehsils to start distribution of records of rights to landowners on demand. The focus of the entire operation has always been to employ state of the art information technology (IT) to galvanize and transform the existing land records system of the country.

Integrated MMPs

e-Procurement

Ministry of Commerce and Industry (Department of Commerce) has been nominated as the Nodal Ministry for the implementation of e-Government Procurement (e-GP) MMPs. The vision of the e-Procurement MMP is 'To create a national initiative to implement procurement reforms, through the use of electronic government procurement, so as to make public procurement in all sectors more transparent and efficient'.

e-Courts

The e-Court MMP was conceptualized with a vision to transform the Indian judiciary by making use of technology. The project had been developed, following the report submitted by the e-Committee under Supreme Court on national policy and action plan on implementation of information communication tools in Indian judiciary.

A clear objective – to re-engineer processes and enhance judicial productivity both qualitatively and quantitatively–to make the justice delivery system affordable, accessible, cost effective, transparent and accountable.

e-Biz

The e-Biz MMP, being executed by the Department of Industrial Policy and Promotion (DIPP), Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Government of India, was conceptualized with the vision 'To transform the business environment in the country by providing efficient, convenient, transparent and integrated electronic services to investors, industries and business throughout the business life cycle'.

CSCs

The CSCs would provide high-quality and cost-effective video, voice and data content and services, in the areas of e-governance, education, health, telemedicine, entertainment as well as other private services. A highlight of the CSCs is that it will offer web-enabled e-governance services in rural areas, including application forms, certificates and utility payments such as electricity, telephone and water bills.

Governance

NeGP is monitored and coordinated at the highest level by the National e-Governance Advisory Group. Appointments to the groupwere done in first week of November 2010 with its first scheduled meeting on 12 November 2010. It is headed by the Minister of Communications and Information Technology, Government of India.

Implementation

Infrastructure

The plan includes development of the National/State Service Delivery Gateway (NSDG/SSDG), SWAN, SDC, CSC and development of e-Forms for service delivery. The infrastructure requirements of NeGP are broken down into core and support infrastructure requirements. The core infrastructure consists of National e-Government Intranet (NICNET, ERNET and other service providers), state wide Intranets, National e-Government Data Centre, SDC, Security Infrastructure (PKI etc.), resource centre for e-governance, GIS National Spatial Data Infrastructure and Language Resource Centre. The support infrastructure includes service delivery infrastructure at state, district, block and village

levels including wireless infrastructure for last mile connectivity. Further e-post and integrated service delivery front ends like the proposed CSC are required as part of the support infrastructure.

Web-Enabled Delivery of Public Services

NeGP comprises 27 MMPs encompassing 10 central MMPs, 10 state MMPs and 7 integrated MMPs, including National Portal of India, spanning multiple ministries/departments. It was approved on 18 May 2006 by the Government of India.

e-Gov Knowledge Exchange

To assist the government, the NISG (a non-profit organization) started a portal project called e-Gov Knowledge Exchange. It is a collaborative effort to collect, develop and share knowledge and material on e-governance initiatives across the different government agencies, state government, union government and private institutions of India. The objective is collective learning from each other's projects and learning lessons.

e-KRANTI: NATIONAL e-GOVERNANCE PLAN 2.0

- The national-level e-governance programme called NeGP was initiated in 2006. There were 31 MMPs under NeGP covering a wide range of domains, viz. agriculture, land records, health, education, passports, police, courts, municipalities, commercial taxes, treasuries, etc., 24 MMPs have been implemented and started delivering either full or partial range of envisaged services.
- Considering the shortcomings in NeGP that included lack of integration amonggovernment applications and databases, low degree of government process reengineering, scope for leveraging emerging technologies like mobile, cloud…etc., Government of India has approved the e-Kranti programme recently with the vision of 'Transforming e-Governance for Transforming Governance'.
- All new and ongoing e-governance projects as well as the existing projects, which are being revamped, should now follow the key principles of e-Kranti, namely 'Transformation and not Translation', 'Integrated Services and not Individual Services', 'Government Process Reengineering (GPR) to be mandatory in every MMP', 'ICT Infrastructure on Demand', 'Cloud by Default', 'Mobile First', 'Fast Tracking Approvals', 'Mandating Standards and Protocols',

'Language Localization', 'National GIS (Geo-Spatial Information System)', 'Security and Electronic Data Preservation'.

- The portfolio of MMPs has increased from 31 to 44 MMPs. Many new social sector projects, namely Women and Child Development, Social Benefits, Financial Inclusion, Urban Governance, e-Bhasha… etc., have been added as new MMPs under e-Kranti.

MAJOR e-GOVERNANCE INITIATIVES IN INDIA

The Government in India has been continuously endeavouring to provide citizen services in a better manner. There have been several successful initiatives, and many noteworthy projects have undertaken in various states of India. The present work tries to study the various e-government projects across India with a view to explore the nature of implementation of these projects, and benefits from them to citizens.

Some of the successful initiatives are **Gyandoot, e-Sewa, SETU and SUDA.**

- **Gyandoot:** The first such project to gain prominence is Gyandoot in the state of Madhya Pradesh. Gyandoot, arguably, has more services under its ambit than other projects.
  - ❖ Gyandoot is an intranet connecting rural cyber cafe catering to the needs of citizens.
  - ❖ The present scope of the project is limited to land records and the immediate needs of the citizens that can be fulfilled at local government level.
  - ❖ The success of the Gyandoot project is due to single-window facility for the citizens to avail the information, empowerment of citizens, a model for public-private partnership in providing the e-governance service to the citizen and for facilitating entrepreneurship among the rural mass through ownership of the information kiosks.
- **e-Sewa:** It is the first major initiative in the country to employ information technology as a tool to improve services for citizens.
  - ❖ The Andhra Pradesh government launched the e-Sewa programme to provide integrated services to citizens of the state.
  - ❖ The e-Sewa centre is a one-stop shop for more than 30 G2C and B2C services. From payment of electricity, water and telephone

bills to the issue of birth and death certificates, permits of licenses, reservation of bus tickets and receipt of passport applications, the e-Sewa centres offer a wide range of services under one roof.

- ❖ Internet services like Internet-enabled electronic payments, downloading of forms and government orders and filing of applications on the Web are also offered.
- ❖ The e-Sewa centres function 7 days' week.
- ❖ e-Sewa is an extension and renamed version of 'Twin Cities Network Services Project' (TWINS; which was launched in November 1999 to focus on the twin cities of Hyderabad and Secunderabad).

- **SETU:** It means 'Bridge' in local language or the Citizen Facilitation Centre has been set up by government of Maharashtra in the city of Aurangabad (population 1 million approx.) as a one-stop service centre for citizens who have to visit government offices for certificates, permits, authentication, affidavit and other services.
  - ❖ The Centre attempts, through the use of ICT, to reduce the visit of citizens from office to another and prevent the functioning of touts, while providing greater transparency, accessibly and efficiency to the procedures in decision making.
  - ❖ Key stakeholders are the general public, especially farmers, labourers, small entrepreneurs and students who require certificates and permits. Other stakeholders are the NGOs, and government officials.
  - ❖ SETU can be adjudged a partial success at present. The centre has been successful in introducing transparency into official procedures, and in increasing the efficiency of the delivery mechanism for completed applications. However, the constraint is in preparing a complete application, since it requires the support of many documents that are issued by other offices at lower (sub-district or block or village) level, and these offices still have the old procedures.
- **FRIENDS:** In the state of Kerala in South India, FRIENDS centres provide a one-stop, front-end, IT-enabled payment counter facility for the government payments to be made by citizens.
  - ❖ FRIENDS is a front-end solution now, i.e., it is a counter automation as opposed to a process improvement project, since

the back-end computerization is yet to be completed. The counters are equipped to handle approximately 1,000 types of payments due to public sector departments/agencies viz., utility payments for electricity and water, revenue taxes, license fees, motor vehicle taxes, university fees, etc.

DIGITAL INDIA

In order to transform the entire ecosystem of public services through the use of information technology, the Government of India has launched the Digital India programme with the vision to transform India into a digitally empowered society and knowledge economy.

The Digital India programme is centred on three key vision areas as follows:

- Digital Infrastructure as a Core Utility to Every Citizen
- Governance and Services on Demand
- Digital Empowerment of Citizens

Digital Infrastructure as a Utility to Every Citizen

- Availability of high-speed internet as a core utility for the delivery of services to citizens
- Cradle to grave digital identity that is unique, lifelong, online and authenticable to every citizen
- Mobile phone and bank account enabling citizen participation in digital and financial space
- Easy access to a CSC
- Shareable private space on a public cloud
- Safe and secure cyberspace

Governance and Services on Demand

- Seamlessly integrated services across departments or jurisdictions
- Availability of services in real time from online and mobile platforms
- All citizen entitlements to be portable and available on the cloud
- Digitally transformed services for improving ease of doing business
- Making financial transactions electronic and cashless
- Leveraging Geospatial Information Systems (GIS) for decision support systems and development

Digital Empowerment of Citizens

- Universal digital literacy
- Universally accessible digital resources
- Availability of digital resources/services in Indian languages
- Collaborative digital platforms for participative governance
- Citizens not required to physically submit government documents/ certificates

Digital Rural India

The Government's ambitious ₹ 1.3 lakh crore Digital India scheme aims to bridge the rural-urban gap and bring internet to the masses.

The vision of Digital India is centred around three key areas:

1. Digital Infrastructure as a utility to every citizen
2. Governance and Services on demand
3. Digital Empowerment of citizens

Digital India programmes' direct benefit to farmers

- Virtual platform for National Agricultural Market (NAM)
- Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY) will leverage e-Technology by using mobile phones and DBT
- e-Kisan portal for farmers to get authentic information in real time
- Weather information will be made available to farmers real time
- Farmer-agri experts interaction through digital platforms

Merger of three ongoing programmes:

1. National Optical Fibre Network (NOFN)
2. National Knowledge Network
3. e-Governance initiative

Objectives:

- Transform India into digitally empowered society and knowledge economy
- Increased availability of electronic government services to citizens
- Wipeout digital divide and offer digital solutions in almost all sectors like education, health, agriculture and administration.

Nine Pillars

1. **Broadband Highways:** Connecting Panchayats through broadband and provide SWAN and NOFN in urban areas.

2. **Universal Access to Phones:** Pan-India mobile connectivity especially in the remotest places. Increasing spectrum will support growing mobile penetration.
3. **Public Internet Access:** Public Internet Access through CSC and post offices in gram panchayats, where all government schemes would be accessible.
4. **e-Governance:** Reforming government through technology– bringing government to doorsteps of citizen through online applications, simple forms, electronic databases, etc.
5. **e-Kranti:** Electronic delivery of service–comprises 41 large e-governance initiatives, called 'MMPs', which include e-education, e-healthcare, security and technology for cyber security.
6. **Information for All:** Two-way communication channel to access information and provide feedback. For example, MyGov.in, social media use to reach out to citizens (Twitter).
7. **Electronics Manufacturing:** It boosts electronics manufacturing through incentives, support to incubators, increased skill development, more local procurement, etc. Target Net Zero Imports by 2020, i.e., imports = exports.
8. **IT for Jobs:** To train 1 crore students from small towns and villages for IT sector jobs in five years.
9. **Early Harvest Programmes:** Simple initiatives to enable prompt digitalization of services like biometric attendance in government organizations, Wi-Fi in universities, e-books, SMS-based weather reports, etc.

Challenges to Digital India

1. **Sizeable adult illiteracy**
   - India has achieved 'universal primary education' in 2015 but there exists sizeable adult illiterate and semi-literate population
   - Computer and digital literacy to such population is a challenge
   - **Solution:** Use graphic user interface tohelp understand even illiterates
2. **Multiple language content**
   - Predominance of English in apps and software
   - Challenge to create content in Indian languages that is clear and up to the mark, not like shoddy mechanical translations

- **Solution:** develop capacities to indigenize software and apps in Indian languages

3. **Low digital literacy**
   - Very low in rural areas
   - Digital Literacy Mission has a long way to go
4. **'Resistant to change' attitude**
   - Change in work environment of government will encounter resistance from officials.
   - Digital governance includes more transparency, less scope of corruption, compulsory response to grievances and criticisms.
   - Officials may try to sabotage government initiatives for their own good.
   - **Solution:** seminars, training to explain them importance and usability of digital government.
5. **Cyber security threat**
   - Increased digitization and e-services enhance cyber security threats also
   - **Man-in-the-middle attack:** a type of cyberattack where a malicious actor intrudes himself/herself into a conversation between two parties and gains access to information that the two parties were trying to send to each other.
   - **Solution:** Make people aware about cyber threats, informing them about cautious cyber behaviour, etc.
6. **NOFN targets and Wi-Fi centres**
   - Laying optical fibre cables does not ensure that they will be used.
   - BSNL's (Bharat Sanchar Nigam Ltd.) mass deployment of Wi-Fi hotspots across the country is not widespread.
7. **Infrastructural challenges**
   - Inadequate spectrum
   - High price of spectrum
   - Non-availability of contagious spectrum
   - Non-allocation of back haul spectrum
   - Government auctioning spectrum in small chunks
8. **Need of legal backing**
   - India still lacks mandatory legal framework for e-governance
   - Electronic Services Delivery Bill, 2011 lapsed in Parliament and has yet not been re-introduced with required amendments

- ❖ Aadhar has legal backing but concern of data privacy still persists
- ❖ **Solution:** Prompt legislation on e-services

9. **Data Vulnerability**
   - ❖ Citizens now have personal information online bank like details, Income tax details, PAN details, which might be vulnerable if not secured properly. In case this is breached, then any individual would lose the privacy of the data and would be compromised.

REVISITING SELECT RECENT INITIATIVES

Direct Cash Transfer

To facilitate disbursements of government entitlements like NREGA, Social Security pension, Handicapped Old Age Pension, etc., of any central or state government bodies, using Aadhaar and authentication thereof as supported by UIDAI.

Aadhaar-Enabled Payment System (AEPS)

AEPS is a bank led model, which allows online interoperable financial inclusion transaction through the business correspondent of any bank using the Aadhaar authentication. This has helped in financial inclusion. The four Aadhaar-enabled basic types of banking transactions are as follows:

- Balance Enquiry
- Cash Withdrawal
- Cash Deposit
- Aadhaar-to-Aadhaar Funds Transfer
- Digital India programme

This programme has been envisaged by DeitY. The vision of Digital India aims to transform the country into a digitally empowered society and knowledge economy. The programme will be implemented in phases from the current year till 2018.

The Digital India is transformational in nature and would ensure that government services are available to citizens electronically. It would also bring in public accountability through mandated delivery of government's services electronically, a Unique ID and e-Pramaan based on authentic and standard-based interoperable and integrated government applications and data basis.

This programme aims at providing digital infrastructure as a utility to every citizen as well as high-speed internet as a core utility in all gram panchayats. The overall scope of this programme is 'to prepare India for a knowledge future', 'to make technology central to enabling change' and 'to become an umbrella programme covering many departments'.

MyGov Citizen Portal

Prime Minister launched an online platform mygov.nic.in to engage citizens in the task of 'good governance' (surajya) as he completed 60 days in office on Saturday. MyGov is a technology-driven platform that would provide people with the opportunity to contribute towards good governance.

e-Kranti Scheme

This is a project for linking the internet with remote villages in the country. This scheme will broaden the reach of internet services to the rural areas in the country. The fundamental features of this scheme will be making the records handy to the government with ease. It also includes expansion of internet and commencement of IT-based jobs in rural areas. It will also boost the use of mobile phones and computers in rural areas. It will also expand the use of IT in agriculture and retail trade.

Digital Cloud for Every Indian

Certificates issued by the government – education, residential, medical records, birth certificates, etc.,– are to be stored in individual 'digital lockers' and a communication protocol established for government departments to access them without physically having to see the hard copy. The purpose of government is that copies of certificates issued by the government itself not to be carried around by people to government offices for various services.

m-Governance

m-governance is not a replacement for e-governance, rather it complements e-governance. m-governance is the use of mobile or wireless to improve governance service and information 'anytime, anywhere'. Mobile applications also rely on good back office ICT infrastructure and work processes. It has potential of using mobile phones as input devices

in certain areas where last mile connectivity becomes issues for simple data inputs of critical importance for decision making in government departments.

m-Governance is not a new concept. The private sector has been greatly leveraging these of mobile phones for delivery of value added services for the following, which however are mostly SMS based: banking, media, Airlines, telecom, entertainment, News, sports, astrology and movie tickets, etc.

m-Governance has increased the productivity of public service personnel, improving the delivery of government information and services, increasing channels for public interactions and lower costs leading to higher participation of people.

Recent thrust to m-governance is being provided through USSD Services. Unstructured Supplementary Services Data (USSD) is a session-based service unlike SMS, which is store and forward service. It can be used by the user to send commands to an application in text format. USSD acts as a trigger for the application.

Government Initiatives for m-Governance

Mobile Seva

- It aims to provide government services to the people through mobile phones and tablets. It has been developed as the core infrastructure for enabling the availability of public services through mobile devices.
- Mobile Seva enables the integration of the mobile platform with the common e-governance infrastructure consisting of SDCs, SWANs, SSDGs/NSDG.
- It enables a government department to integrate both Web- and mobile-based services' seamlessly and enhances the access to electronic services tremendously leveraging the very high penetration of mobile phones, especially in rural areas.
- A Mobile Applications Store (m-App Store) has also been developed by DeitY as a part of Mobile Seva. The Mobile Governance Portal and the m-App Store can be accessed at http://mgov.gov.in/. The m-Appstore currently hosts over 240 live mobile applications. The live applications can be downloaded and installed free of cost on a mobile phone by any person.

- The project, 'mobile seva' has won the second prize at the prestigious United Nations' Public Services Awards in the category 'Promoting Whole of Government Approaches in the Information Age' for Asia Pacific.
- A few years ago, Kerala launched 'Dr. SMS', an m-health information system, for providing information on medical facilities available in the locality of the resident.
- Goa followed, with a mobile governance initiative for issuing alerts for receipt of government applications and complaints and status tracking.
- Next came Maharashtra. It adopted a similar traffic management system through mobile alerts.
- A laudable initiative launched by the Greater Hyderabad Municipal Corporation in September tries to use technology in a mobile phone-based Intelligent Garbage Monitoring System enables sanitary supervisors to report the status of cleaning of garbage bins through their GPS-enabled mobile phones. Centralized reports as well as those of individual bins can be generated with the system.

The Advantages of e-Governance

- **Speed:** Technology makes communication speedier. Internet, phones, cell phones have reduced the time taken in normal communication.
- **Cost Reduction:** Most of the government expenditure is appropriated towards the cost of stationary. Paper-based communication needs lots of stationary, printers, computers, etc., which calls for continuous heavy expenditure. Internet and phones make communication cheaper saving valuable money for the government.
- **Transparency:** Use of ICT makes governing process transparent. All the information of the government would be made available on the internet. The citizens can see the information whenever they want to see. But this is only possible when every piece of information of the government is uploaded on the internet and is available for the public to peruse. Current governing process leaves many ways to conceal the information from all the people. ICT helps make the information available online eliminating all the possibilities of concealing of information.
- **Accountability:** Once the governing process is made transparent, the government is automatically made accountable. Accountability is answerability of the government to the people. It is the answerability

for the deeds of the government. An accountable government is a responsible government.

- **Convenience:** e-government brings public services to citizens on their schedule and their venue.
- **Improved Customer Service:** e-government allows to re-deploy resources from back-end processing to the front line of customer service.
- **Increased Access to Information:** e-government improves the accessibility of government information to citizens allowing it to become an important resource in making the decisions that affect daily life and so it helps in empowerment of citizens.

Disadvantages of e-Governance

Electronic governments also consist on certain disadvantage. The main disadvantage of an e-government is to move the government services into an electronic-based system. This system loses the person-to-person interaction, which is valued by a lot of people.

In addition, the implementation of an e-government service is that, with many technology-based services, it is often easy to make the excuse (e.g. the server has gone down) that problems with the service provided are because of the technology.

The implementation of an e-government does have certain constraints. Literacy of the users and the ability to use the computer, users who do not know how to read and write would need assistance. An example would be the senior citizens. In general, senior citizens do not have much computer education and they would have to approach a customer service officer for assistance. And also in case of rural people, it gives scope for middle man, who distorts the information.

Studies have shown that there is potential for a reduction in the usability of government online due to factors such as the access to Internet technology and usability of services and the ability to access to computers.

Even though the level of confidence in the security offered by government websites is high, the public are still concerned over security, fear of spam from providing email addresses and government retention of transaction or interaction history. There has been growing concern about the privacy of data being collected as a part of UID project. The security of cyber space and misuse of data is still holding back the citizens to full adaptation of Aadhaar card.

Challenges in e-Governance

There are large numbers of potential barriers in the implementation of e-governance. Some hindrance in the path of implementation, like security, unequal access to the computer technology by the citizen, high initial cost for setting up the e-government solutions and resistance to change. Challenges are identified as trust, resistance to change, digital divide, cost and privacy and security concerns.

Trust

Trust can be defined along two dimensions: as an assessment of a current situation, or as an innate personality traitor predisposition. The implementation of public administration functions via e-government requires the presence of two levels of trust. The first is that the user must be confident, comfortable and trusting of the tool or technology with which they will interact. The second dimension of trust pertains to trust of the government.

There has to be a balance between ensuring that a system prevents fraudulent transactions and the burden that extensive checks can take place on people who are honest.

Recently, confidential information on military veterans was compromised when a computer containing their personal information was lost. This type of incident can erode trust and user confidence in government systems. Trust along with financial security are two critical factors limiting the adoption of e-government services.

Resistance to Change

The innovation diffusion theory states that over time, an innovation will diffuse through a population, and the rate of adoption will vary between those who adopt early, referred to as early adopters and to those who adopt the innovation much later, referred to as—laggards.

The resistant to change phenomenon can explain much of the hesitation that occurs on the part of constituents in moving from a paper-based to a Web-based system for interacting with government.

Citizens, employees and businesses can all have their biases with respect to how transactions should be processed. However, government entities and public policy administrators cannot ignore the changes that occur as a result of the implementation of ICT.

Education about the value of the new systems is one step towards reducing some of the existing resistance. It can also be particularly useful for a leader or manager to buy the new system at an early stage in the adoption process.

Digital Divide

The digital divide refers to the separation that exists between individuals, communities and businesses that have access to information technology and those that do not have such access.

Social, economic, infrastructural and ethno-linguistic indicators provide explanations for the presence of the digital divide.

Economic poverty is closely related to limited information technology resources.

An individual living below poverty line does not afford a computer for himself to harness the benefits of e-government and other online services. As the digital divide narrows, broader adoption of e-government in the public domain becomes possible. Economic poverty is not the only cause of digital divide. It can also be caused by the lack of awareness among the people. Even some of the economic stable people don't know about the scope of e-governance.

Awareness can only help to bring users to that service delivery channel once. It cannot guarantee sustained use of the system unless the system is designed in such a way to deliver satisfactory outcome. Procedures need to be simplified to deliver concrete benefits and clear guidelines provided to encourage their use by the actual end users and reduce user's dependence on middlemen/intermediaries.

Cost

Cost is one of the most important prohibiting factor that comes in the path of e-governance implementation particularly in the developing countries like India where most of the people are living below the poverty line. Elected officers and politician don't seem to be interested in implementing e-governance.

Privacy and Security

There will be three basic levels of access exists for e-government stakeholders: no access to a Web service, limited access to a Webservice or fullaccess to a Web service; however, when personal sensitive data exist the formation of the security, access policy is a much more complex process

with legal consideration. With the implementation of e-government projects, effective measures must be taken to protect sensitive personal information. A lack of clear security standards and protocols can limit the development of projects that contain sensitive information such as income, medical history.

THE CITIZEN'S CHARTERS: INDIAN EXPERIENCE

Basic Concept, Origin and Principles

It has been recognized that in the world, good governance is essential for sustainable development, both economic and social. The three essential aspects emphasized in good governance are transparency, accountability and responsiveness of the administration. The 'Citizen's Charters initiative' is a response to the quest for solving the problems which a citizen encounters, day in and day out, while dealing with organizations providing public services. The concept of Citizen's Charter enshrines the trust between the service provider and its users. The concept was first articulated and implemented in the United Kingdom by the Conservative Government of John Major in 1991 as a national programme with a simple aim: to continuously improve the quality of public services for the people of the country so that these services respond to the needs and wishes of the users. The programme was re-launched in 1998 by the Labour Government of Tony Blair which rechristened it 'Services First'. The basic objective of the Citizen's Charter is to empower the citizen in relation to public service delivery. The six principles of the Citizen's Charter movement as originally framed were:

1. **Quality:** Improving the quality of services;
2. **Choice:** Wherever possible;
3. **Standards:** Specifying what to expect and how to act if standards are not met;
4. **Value:** For the taxpayers' money;
5. **Accountability:** Individuals and Organizations;
6. **Transparency:** Rules/Procedures/Schemes/Grievances.

These were later elaborated by the Labour Government as the nine principles of Service Delivery (1998), which are as follows:

1. Set standards of service;
2. Be open and provide full information;

3. Consult and involve;
4. Encourage access and the promotion of choice;
5. Treat all fairly;
6. Put things right when they go wrong;
7. Use resources effectively;
8. Innovate and improve;
9. Work with other providers.

The International Scene

The United Kingdom's Citizen's Charter initiative aroused considerable interest around the world, and several countries implemented similar programmes, e.g., Australia (Service Charter, 1997), Belgium (Public Service Users' Charter, 1992), Canada (Service Standards Initiative, 1995), France (Service Charter, 1992), India (Citizen's Charter, 1997), Jamaica (Citizen's Charter, 1994), Malaysia (Client Charter, 1993), Portugal (The Quality Charter in Public Services, 1993) and Spain (The Quality Observatory, 1992). Some of these initiatives are very similar to the UK model, whereas others break new ground by leaning on the service quality paradigm of the 'Total Quality Management' (TQM) movement. Some other initiatives are pitched somewhere in between. Even in the United Kingdom, in the context of the Next Steps/ Modernizing Government Initiatives, Citizen's Charters have acquired a service quality face for delivery of public services. The quality tools adopted for improving public services include the Business Excellence Model, Investors in People, Charter Mark, ISO 9000 and Best Value (Government of United Kingdom, 1999). The Government of Malaysia issued guidelines on the Client's Charter in 1993 to assist government agencies to prepare and implement Client's Charter, which is 'a written commitment by an agency to deliver outputs or services according to specified standards of quality' (Government of Malaysia, 1998). A 'Best Client's Charter Award' was instituted in 1993. The Malaysian system of Client's Charter closely follows the UK Model. A distinction is made, however, between agency-wide and unit charters. The concept of 'service recovery' enjoins taking steps to restore the trust and confidence of the client in a proactive manner when things go wrong.

The Commonwealth Government of Australia launched its Service Charter Initiative in 1997 as part of its ongoing commitment to improve the quality of service provided by agencies to the Australian community

by moving the government organization away from bureaucratic processes to customer-focused outcomes. Service Charters are considered a powerful tool for fostering change and require the organization to focus on services delivered, to measure and assess performance and to initiate performance improvement. By providing goals for agencies to strive towards, a Charter acts as a surrogate for competition where none exists (Department of Finance and Administration, 1999). **Centrelink** is a one-stop shop that provides access to Australian government services for over six million customers. Centrelink has adopted one-to-one service as an innovative and personalized approach to service delivery. One-to-one service treats customers with respect and consistency and takes the complexity out of dealing with government.

The Treasury Board of Canada Secretariat started a Service Standard Initiative in 1995, which took its cue from the Citizen's Charters of the United Kingdom, but enlarged the scope considerably. This Service Standard Initiative in Canada was started against the backdrop of citizen expectations relating to friendly, respectful and courteous service, faster response times, extended hours at government offices and 'one-stopshopping'. At the same time, there was a need to reduce the deficit and provide value for money through more efficient use of resources (Treasury Board of Canada, 1995). A perusal of these four major Citizen's Charter initiatives shows that the service quality approach is embedded in all of them in different degrees. Once a decision is taken to make public services citizen-centric, the customer focus of the 'TQM' variety cannot be far behind. In fact, the Citizen's Charter approach has several things in common with TQM. Both begin by focusing on meeting customer/citizen requirements. Other key common elements are conformance to standards, stakeholder involvement and continuous improvement.

The Indian Scenario

Over the years, in India, significant progress has been made in the field of economic development. This, along with a substantial increase in the literacy rate, has made Indian citizens increasingly aware of their rights. Citizens have become more articulate and expect the administration not merely to respond to their demands but also to anticipate them. It was in this climate that a consensus began to evolve since 1996 on effective and responsive administration. At a Conference of Chief Ministers of various states and union territories held on 24 May 1997 in New Delhi, presided

over by the Prime Minister of India, an **'Action Plan for Effective and Responsive Government'** at the centre and state levels was adopted. One of the major decisions at that conference was that the central and state governments would formulate Citizen's Charters, starting with those sectors that have a large public interface (e.g., Railways, Telecom, Posts, Public Distribution Systems and the like). These Charters were to include first, standards of service as well as the time limits that the public can reasonably expect for service delivery, avenues of grievance redressal and a provision for independent scrutiny through the involvement of citizen and consumer groups. The DARPG in Government of India initiated the task of coordinating, formulating and operationalizing Citizen's Charters. The guidelines for formulating the Charters as well as a list of do's and don'ts were communicated to various government departments/ organizations to enable them to bring out focused and effective Charters. For the formulation of the Charters, the government agencies at the centre and state levels were advised to constitute a task force with representation from users, senior management and the cutting-edge staff.

The Charters are expected to incorporate the following elements:

- Vision and mission statements;
- Details of business transacted by the organization;
- Details of clients;
- Details of services provided to each client group;
- Details of grievance redressal mechanism and how to access it;
- Expectations from the clients.

Primarily, an adaptation of the UK model, the Indian Citizen's Charter, has an additional component of **'expectations from the clients'** or in other words **'obligations of the users'**. Involvement of consumer organizations, citizen groups, and other stakeholders in the formulation of the Citizen's Charter is emphasized to ensure that the Citizen's Charter meets the needs of the users. Regular monitoring, review and evaluation of the Charters, both internally and through external agencies, have been enjoined.

Exemplary Implementation of the Citizen's Charter

Even as the overall efforts and initiatives of the government on Citizen's Charter were on, it was realized that exemplary implementation of a Charter in a major public interface area of government would not only

establish a new concept in the inertia-prone bureaucracy, but also act as a role model for replication in other sectors/areas. The banking sector was identified for this purpose keeping in view the second phase of economic reforms and the fact that this sector was fairly advanced in terms of customer service and was also taking advantage of information technology to speed up various processes. The primary objective of this exercise was to build the banking sector as a model of excellence in the implementation of a Citizen's Charter. To begin with, three major national-level banks, namely, Punjab National Bank, Punjab and Sind Bank and Oriental Bank of Commerce, were selected for a hand-holding exercise by the DARPG in the year 2000. The following key issues were highlighted for exemplary implementation of their Citizen's Charters:

- Stakeholder involvement in the formulation of Citizen's Charters;
- Deployment of Citizen's Charters in the banks by full involvement of the staff, especially the employees at the cutting-edge level;
- Creation of awareness about the Charters among the customers of the banks;
- Special training for employees at all levels about the concept and implementation of a Citizen's Charter.

After an evaluation of the current status of the Charters by the identified banks through independent agencies, action plans were chalked out to rectify shortcomings. The Charters were, accordingly, revised and standardized on the basis of the model/mother Charter developed by the Indian Banks Association (IBA). Training for employees of selected branches through master trainers, trained by the National Institute of Bank Management using a module developed in consultation with DARPG was organized. Several measures to give wide publicity to Citizen's Charter were also undertaken. An external agency was engaged to reassess and re-evaluate the implementation of Citizen's Charter of these banks and at the end of this exercise also to document the hand-holding exercise. The 'National Institute of Bank Management' (NIBM) was assigned this task, which was executed and a document about the exercise was brought out in the Year 2003.

Evaluation of Citizen's Charters

An evaluation of the Citizen's Charters of various government agencies was carried out by DARPG and Consumer Coordination Council, New Delhi, an NGO, in October 1998. The results were quite encouraging

given the nascent stage of this initiative in India. A brief questionnaire has been circulated to all ministries/departments and state governments/ union territories to enable them to undertake an in-house evaluation of their Citizen's Charters. These organizations were also advised to undertake external evaluations, preferably through NGOs. During the Year 2002–2003, DARPG engaged a professional agency to develop a standardized model for internal and external evaluation of Citizen's Charters in a more effective, quantifiable and objective manner. This agency also carried out evaluation of implementation of Charters in 5 central government organizations and 15 departments/organizations of states of Andhra Pradesh, Maharashtra and Uttar Pradesh. This agency was also required to suggest methods for increasing awareness, both within the organization and among the users, and to suggest possible methods for orientation of management and the staff in the task of formulating and deploying Charters. The major findings of the evaluation carried out by the agency, as stated I, its report were:

- In majority of cases, Charters were not formulated through a consultative process;
- By and large service providers are not familiar with the philosophy, goals and main features of the Charter;
- In none of the departments evaluated, had adequate publicity been given to the Charters. In most departments, the Charters were only in the early stages of implementation;
- No funds were specifically earmarked for awareness generation on Citizen's Charter or for orientation of the staff on various components of the Charter.
- Further, the key recommendations in the report, *inter alia*, stressed upon:
    - ❖ The need for citizens and staff to be consulted at every stage of formulation of the Charter;
    - ❖ Orientation of staff about the salient features and goals/objectives of the Charter; vision and mission statement of the department and skills such as team building, problem-solving, handling of grievances and communication skills;
    - ❖ The need for creation of database on consumer grievances and redress;

- The need for wider publicity of the Charter through print media, posters, banners, leaflets, handbills, brochures, local newspapers, etc., and also through electronic media;
- Earmarking of specific budgets for awareness generation and orientation of staff;
- Replication of best practices in this field.

Compendium on Citizen's Charters in Government of India

With the objective of generating awareness among the citizens as well as government functionaries about the commitments of various organizations enshrined in their Citizen's Charter, the DARPG brought out a Compendium of abridged versions of all Citizen's Charters in Government of India in a book as well as in CD form on 14 May 2003. The Compendium contains the operative standards and quality of services proposed to be provided as also the public grievance redressal mechanism as committed in the Citizen's Charters. It also contains the name, address, telephone number, e-mail address, etc., of nodal officers for Citizen's Charters in central government ministries/departments/organizations and also the list of website addresses of ministry/department/organization concerned. The Compendium is not only useful for the citizens for ready reference, but also enables them to critically review the functioning of these organizations. It would also help the organizations to compare the standards set by them, vis-à-vis, those set by other organizations.

Information and Facilitation Counters

Information and Facilitation Counter (IFC) is a facility set up by selected central government organizations to provide information to citizens about their programmes/schemes, rules and procedures, etc., as well as status of cases/applications. An IFC also acts as a nodal point for redress of public grievances. The IFC, therefore, is a physical manifestation of Citizen's Charter. Hence, it has now been decided to set up IFCs in all government ministries/departments having Citizen's Charters. One hundred and five IFCs/May I Help You/Inquiry Counters have been set up so far. Evaluation of the functioning of the IFCs was carried out by the DARPG and the Consumer Coordination Council. The organizations concerned have taken action on deficiencies pointed out in these evaluations. This

department also regularly monitors the working of the IFCs through a half-yearly report prescribed for all the organizations that have set up IFCs.

Problems Faced in Implementing the Charters

As pointed out earlier, the Citizen's Charters initiative in India had started in 1997, and most of the Charters formulated thereupon are in a nascent stage of implementation. Introduction of new concepts is always difficult in any organization. Introduction and implementation of the concept of Citizen's Charter in the Government of India was much more difficult due to the old bureaucratic set up/procedures and the rigid attitudes of the workforce. The major obstacles encountered in this initiative were:

- The general perception of organizations which formulated Citizen's Charters was that the exercise was to be carried out because there was a direction from above. The consultation process was minimal or largely absent. It, thus, became one of the routine activities of the organization and had no focus;
- For any Charter to succeed, the employees responsible for its implementation should have proper training and orientation, as commitments of the Charter cannot be expected to be delivered by a workforce that is unaware of the spirit and content of the Charter. However, in many cases, the concerned staff were not adequately trained and sensitized;
- Sometimes, transfers and reshuffles of concerned officers at the crucial stages of formulation/implementation of the Citizen's Charter in an organization severely undermined the strategic processes which were put in place and hampered the progress of the initiative;
- Awareness campaigns to educate clients about the Charter were not conducted systematically;
- In some cases, the standards/time norms of services mentioned in Citizen's Charter were either too lax or too tight and were, therefore, unrealistic, thereby creating an unfavourable impression on the clients of the Charter;
- The concept behind the Citizen's Charter was not properly understood. Information brochures, publicity materials, pamphlets produced earlier by the organizations were mistaken for Citizen's Charters.

STRENGTHENING TRANSPARENCY AND ACCOUNTABILITY IN PROCUREMENT PROCEDURES IN INDIA

Procurement is the acquisition of goods or services by public bodies and private companies. The prime objective of any procurement is getting the right product or service, at the right price and quality at the right time. However, procurement processes are also highly vulnerable to corruption, collusion, fraud and manipulation. Estimates suggest that 20–30% of the value of procurement may be lost through corruption, while, on the other hand, procurement itself is estimated to constitute 15% of gross domestic product (GDP) in OECD countries, a higher percentage in developing economies and up to 45% of government spending in some economies. As part of its ongoing project on 'Public–Private Partnership for Probity in Public Procurement', implemented under the Siemens Integrity Initiative, UNODC, in partnership with the Global Compact Network India (GCNI), organized a national consultation on 'Transparency and Anti-Corruption Measures in Procurement in India' on 18 and 19 April in New Delhi. The consultation was aimed at deliberating on challenges related to maintaining transparency in procurement procedures and exploring opportunities and collaborations to address corruption and enhance accountability in procurement in India, in line with the United Nations Convention against Corruption (UNCAC). India ratified the UNCAC in May 2011, the first legally binding global anti-corruption instrument adopted by the world community in 2003. The Convention calls upon states parties to establish systems of procurement based on transparency, competition and objective criteria in decision-making. It also encourages states parties, the corporate community and relevant organizations to collaborate with each other and share best practices on the alignment of systems of public procurement with the requirements of the convention.

NATIONAL HEALTH MISSION

The union government launched National Urban Health Mission in 1 May 2013 as a sub-mission of an over-arching National Health Mission (NHM), with National Rural Health Mission (NRHM) being the other sub-mission of NHM.

Thus, both NRHM and NUHM are now sub-missions of NHM.

NHM has six components as follows:

1. National Rural Health Mission (now called NRHM-RCH Flexipool) for all towns and villages below population of 50,000;
2. National Urban Health Mission Flexipool for population above 50,000;
3. Flexible pool for communicable disease;
4. Flexible pool for non-communicable disease including injury and trauma;
5. Infrastructure maintenance and;
6. Family welfare central sector component.

National Rural Health Mission

National Rural Health Mission (NRHM) is an Indian health programme for improving healthcare delivery across rural India. The mission, initially mooted for 7 years (2005–2012), is run by the Ministry of Health. The scheme proposes a number of new mechanism for healthcare delivery including training local residents as Accredited Social Health Activists (ASHA), and the Janani Suraksha Yojana (motherhood protection programme). It also aims at improving hygiene and sanitation infrastructure. Noted economists Ajay Mahal and Bibek Debroy have called it 'the most ambitious rural health initiative ever'. The mission has a special focus on 18 states: Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Bihar, Chhattisgarh, Himachal Pradesh, Jharkhand, Jammu and Kashmir, Manipur, Mizoram, Meghalaya, Madhya Pradesh, Nagaland, Odisha, Rajasthan, Sikkim, Tripura, Uttarakhand and Uttar Pradesh.

Under the mission, health funding had increased from 27,700 crores in 2004–2005 to 39,000 crores in 2005–2006 (from 0.95% of GDP to 1.05%). This has further increased from 14,974 crores in 2007–2008 to 34,488 crores in 2012–2013. As of 2009, economists noted that 'the mid-term appraisal of the NRHM has found that there has been a significant improvement in health indicators even in this short period'. However, in many situations, the state-level apparatus have not been able to deploy the additional funds, often owing to inadequacies in the Panchayati Raj functioning. Fund utilization in many states is around 70%. The largest programme under NRHM, covering India's most populous state, Uttar

Pradesh, has been clouded by a large-scale corruption scandal in which two apex health officials have been murdered. The state government headed by Chief Minister Mayawati has been accused of fraud to the tune of 10,000 crores (US$2 billion).

Forward Linkages Scheme to NRHM in NE: With a view to complement and supplement the initiatives under the NRHM for improving the secondary/tertiary level and other health infrastructure in the north eastern region, the Forward Linkage Scheme to NRHM was introduced in the 11th Plan (to be financed form likely saving from other health schemes). This scheme has been continued in the 12th Plan. The Forward Linkages Scheme is fully funded by the central government. The projects sent by the state are appraised and for the approved projects, funds are released by the ministry.

Goals of this mission are as follows:

1. Reduce MMR to 1/1000 live births
2. Reduce IMR to 25/1000 live births
3. Reduce Total Fertility Rate (TFR) to 2.1
4. Prevention and reduction of anaemia in women aged 15–49 years
5. Prevent and reduce mortality and morbidity from communicable, non-communicable; injuries and emerging diseases
6. Reduce household out-of-pocket expenditure on total healthcare expenditure
7. Reduce annual incidence and mortality from tuberculosis by half
8. Reduce prevalence of Leprosy to <1/10,000 population and incidence to zero in all districts
9. Annual malaria incidence to be <1/1,000
10. Less than 1% microfilaria prevalence in all districts
11. Kala-azar elimination by 2015, <1 case per 10,000 population in all blocks

At the central level, the National Health Systems Resource Centre (NHSRC) has been established to serve as the apex body for technical support to the centre and states.

2 Overview of Government Schemes, Missions, Campaigns and Programmes in India

OROP: 5 SEPTEMBER 2015

The One Rank One Pension scheme stated that individuals who retired with the same rank and service duration can avail the same amount of pension money irrespective of the year in which they retired.

This scheme was started basically to cater to the army personnel, as in such cases, the rank matters a lot. Thus, a general who retired 20 years ago will get the same pension as a general who recently retired.

PRADHAN MANTRI JAN AUSHADHI YOJANA: 21 JULY 2015

Narendra Modi launched this scheme for health reforms in the nation. This scheme stated that Jan Aushadhi stores spread all over the country would sell medicines at an affordable cost as compared to the market price.

A financial assistance will be provided to NGO groups and other private hospitals by extending a fund of 2.5 lakhs INR each to them.

With these funds, the organizations were encouraged to open these Jan Aushadhi stores. The scheme ensured that everyone can afford medicines at the time of need.

SKILL INDIA: 15 JULY 2015

Skill India was a scheme introduced by Modi in order to create a larger platform for developing the talents of an individual with good technical skills.

This scheme basically caters to the youth of India by encouraging them to enhance their talents and come forward in order to build a skilful nation.

PRADHAN MANTRI KRISHI SINCHAI YOJANA: 1 JULY 2015

The PMKSY aimed at improving the agricultural sector of India. Under this scheme, proper irrigation facilities were to be provided to all the areas that involved agricultural activities.

Thus, water provision and water recycling facilities will be provided in those areas enabling the implementation of the concept of 'More Crop Per Drop'. There has been a major growth in the quantity and quality of cultivable land after the introduction of this scheme.

DIGITAL INDIA: 1 JULY 2015

Narendra Modi introduced this scheme in order to promote the development of the country by digitizing it. Digitization included providing technical education to all citizens and improving the Internet speed and connectivity. Also, the scheme involved encouraging the use of online facilities by promoting them and making their interface userfriendly.

PRADHAN MANTRI AWAS YOJANA: 25 JUNE 2015

This scheme launched by Narendra Modi aims at providing housing to all Indian citizens. It basically caters to the individuals and families falling under the Economically Weaker Sections (EWS) and Low-Income Groups (LIG). The implementation will be through funding the poor families so that they can afford housing, home loans and subsidy linked housing facilities. Thus, an approximate number of 5 crores homes will be provided for the financially deprived families and individuals to reside in. This scheme is to continue over a span of four years.

AMRUT SCHEME: 24 JUNE 2015

Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation or AMRUT scheme aimed at improving the infrastructural conditions of urban India. This included building proper roads, improving transport facilities, providing clean drinking water and developing the sewerage systems. Another dimension of this scheme was to eradicate the pollution in urban areas by introducing pollution control methods and increasing the greenery in cities.

PRADHAN MANTRI JEEVAN JYOTI BEEMA YOJANA: 9 MAY 2015

This scheme was launched keeping in mind the fact that a meager population of India was covered by a proper Life Insurance Scheme. Thus, every individual was encouraged to contribute in this scheme for increasing the insurance coverage of citizens. Under this scheme, a

minimum contribution of 330 INR yearly premium was required for a citizen to avail an insurance cover of 2 lakhs (minimum). Thus, there was an increased participation of citizens in this scheme.

PRADHAN MANTRI SURAKSHA BEEMA YOJANA: 9 MAY 2015

This government scheme aimed to increase the coverage of a citizen of India in the case of an untoward accident. An individual can avail an insurance cover of 2 lakhs INR by investing a premium of 12 INR only. Thus, the scheme spread awareness among everyone to avail for an accident cover.

ATAL PENSION YOJANA: 9 MAY 2015

Another protection scheme was launched by Modi in form of the Atal Pension Scheme. This scheme ensured that every individual had a pension facility to their name. Thus, the number of pension account beneficiaries were increased by promoting the requirement of a pension scheme for an individual. According to this scheme, a subsidiary can avail a pension of 1000 INR to 5000 INR per month according to the investment done.

SMART CITIES SCHEME: 29 APRIL 2015

Smart City Scheme was launched under the reign of Modi to take a further step in the development of the country. Under this scheme, a smart and digitized approach will be undertaken to improve the facilities in Indian cities. This includes proper water and electricity supply along with facilities like better transportation, good Internet speed and few safety measures.

PRADHAN MANTRI GARIB KALYAN YOJANA: 19 APRIL 2015

This scheme was introduced as a welfare scheme by Narendra Modi in order to provide financial support to the poverty struck citizens. The concept was to organize workshops all over the country which citizens can pay and attend. Funds raised through these workshops will go directly to the account of PMGKY. Post demonetization, all black money holders were encouraged to get rid of their unaccounted cash via contributing a part of it to PMGKY.

MUDRA YOJANA: 8 APRIL 2015

Micro-finance Units Development and Refinery Agency or MUDRA was a scheme launched in order to provide proper financial support to all small businesses in the country. Start-ups and other microfinance sectors can avail a loan ranging from 50,000 INR to 10 lakhs INR under this scheme. The loan provided to these small business units will enable them to expand and develop which in turn will be profitable for the country.

PRASAD SCHEME: 9 MARCH 2015

Pilgrimage Rejuvenation and Spiritual Augmentation Drive or PRASAD Scheme aimed at providing an excellent tourism framework to the famous spiritual cities of India. This included cultural promotion of these cities via different media. Also, it involved the development of facilities to attract more tourists and make these cities a hub for financial income through tourism.

SUKANYA SAMRIDDHI YOJANA: 22 JANUARY 2015

Narendra Modi launched this scheme to empower the girl child. The scheme stated that the parents of a girl child could start a Sukanya Samriddhi Account under her name for a duration of 14 years. This sum deposited in the account matures at a rate of interest as decided by the government. When the girl child is 18 years of age, then withdrawal can be made from this account for her education purposes. Also investing in this scheme would qualify for tax exemption under the Section 80C.

HRIDAY SCHEME: 21 JANUARY 2015

The Heritage City Development and Augmentation Yojana or HRIDAY is a government scheme that was launched on 21 January 2015. The main objective of this scheme was to preserve the rich Indian heritage that was taking steady steps towards deterioration. The concept was to develop ancient India alongside urban and rural planning and management. This scheme would cover under it the cities which are Indian heritage sites.

Features

India is a land of diverse cultural traditions. People of all religious strata reside in India from time immemorial. Thus, India houses a classic and rich collection of music, art, literature, handicrafts and architectural wonders.

Conservation of these resources has often been a neglected process. The efforts were mainly from local communities residing in heritage sites. But they did not have the full means to implement their ideas. The central government focused basically on financial issues, urban development, provision of facilities like sewerage connection and water supply. This resulted in the heritage being derelict. Proper direction, sanitary facilities, lighting and other decorative aspects were found missing from heritage sites. Thus, the pride of India suffered.

This is when HRIDAY came to play. The scheme took up the objective to develop heritage cities on an overall basis. Conservation of the main monuments was the key objective, but not the only objective. HRIDAY covered an entire heritagecity and aimed to improve its sanitary systems, economic status and quality of basic services provided. This, in turn, would lead to financial development via tourism, thus exposing the Indian culture maximally.

Objectives of HRIDAY Scheme

HRIDAY aims to develop the basic heritage framework of India by conserving and renewing ancient infrastructure like:

- Ancient monuments
- Temples and their architecture
- Prayer ghats

Apart from the infrastructural development of the heritages stated above, the cities around them would also undergo a revitalization. This includes improved sanitary facilities, sewerage system, connectivity through main roads and transportation facilities. Thus, the main objective revolves around the following ideas:

The HRIDAY scheme is to be implemented over a period of approximately four years (January 2015 to November 2018).

Development and improving the framework of heritage sites.

Improving public service delivered to cities with heritage sites.

Keep a documentation of all heritage sites ready to refer to the architectural and cultural aspects while development.

Improve the connectivity to heritage sites through roads so as to make tourism easier.

Growth and Implementation of HRIDAY Scheme

The 4 years allotted to implementing the HRIDAY scheme with over 12 major cities identified as the heritage sites of India. They are:

(a) Amaravati,	(b) Amritsar,	(c) Ajmer,
(d) Badami,	(e) Gaya,	(f) Dwarka,
(g) Mathura,	(h) Kanchipuram,	(i) Velankanni,
(j) Varanasi,	(k) Puri and	(l) Warangal.

These are the targeted cities in which the objectives are being currently implemented. Thus, from the development and tourism point of view, a large progress has been made.

Funding Towards HRIDAY

The Government of India has allocated a total asset of 500 crores INR to fund the HRIDAY Scheme. The funds are divided as follows:

Eighty-five per cent of the funds will go towards specific heritage site improvement.

Three per cent of the funds will go towards the development of heritage city.

The cost of operation and administration is covered by 1% of the funds.

Improving communication and networking is covered by 4% of the funds.

To increase the capacity of local communities aiming to develop these sites, 3% of the total funds are being allocated.

Four per cent of the funding will go towards the preparation of reports and other documentation regarding the heritage sites.

The above division stands for the funds allocated to each of the 12 cities for heritage development.

START-UP INDIA

Concept of Start-Up India

The young ignited minds will help build a better India. And that is exactly the inspiration drawn by Narendra Modi when he launched the Start-Up India Scheme. The aim was to take the country to a level where

innovations will lead the youth to embark on a journey from **'Job Seekers to Job Creators'**. Thus, the end result would be a developed nation with a stable economy. The Start-Up India Scheme states that if any Indian citizen shows potential entrepreneurship qualities by presenting an innovative idea that promotes development, they will get a monetary support from the Government of India.

What Is a Start-Up and How Will It Be Eligible for Start-Up India Loan Scheme?

The eligibility criteria as set by the Government of India for a Start-Up Organization avail financial aid under Start-Up India Loan Scheme are as follows:

- The organization must be independent and registered in India.
- It should not be formed after division, modification or close down of any previously present organization.
- The organization must not be an establishment older than five years.
- The turnover of the company should not be more than 25 crores annually.

Action Plan for Start-Up India Loan Scheme

The action plan for implementation of Start-Up India Scheme will be in these areas:

To provide technical guidance to a Start-Up organization to simplify their working plan and if required modify their innovations to get better results.

Support a Start-Up organization with proper funding and provide good incentives.

Involve a Start-Up organization with incubators and help them partner with well-established industrial and academic institutions.

Loan Value under Start-Up India Scheme

The scheme Start-Up India was announced on 16 January 2016 and was officially launched on 1 April 2016. Under this scheme, if any organization with innovative ideas for development is considered as a 'Start-Up' by the Government of India, then a loan be extended to the organization. The amount of loan will range from **10 lakhs to 100 lakhs** according to the requirement and set norms. Parallel to it, a scheme known as Stand-Up India will be launched with similar facilities to promote entrepreneurship among women, SC/ST and other backward classes.

Features of Start-Up India Loan Scheme

The key features of Start-Up India Scheme are:

- The registration to apply for Start-Up India loan will be done via online application forms.
- A system to self-certify a Start-Up has been introduced.
- To provide proper online support, a web domain and a mobile app will be developed which will be dedicated to the Start-Up organization.
- The organization will not be inspected for the initial three years.
- Exemption from income tax for the first three years.
- Innovation promoting courses will be started under the Atal Innovation Mission.
- An important point to note while applying for Start-Up India is that the Start-Up organization will be exempt from tax deductions unless it gets a certification from Inter-Ministerial Board.

Start-Up India: Registration Procedure

All aspirants who wish to register for the Start-Up India Scheme must follow either of the two options:

- An individual can register himself or herself via a MCA or through Registrar of Firms. Simultaneously, they have to register themselves officially on the web portal of Start-Up India.
- The second option is to make the complete application through the Start-Up India mobile application. Though mostly it is recommended that this mobile application process is followed as it is an easier one. Registering via MCA or Registrar firms had to be done previously as the mobile app was not built.

GRAM UDAY SE BHARAT UDAY ABHIYAN: 14 APRIL 2016

It states that promoting proper governance in rural India is mandatory for the overall development of the country. Thus, this scheme aims at setting up an organized rural Panchayat in order to make the villages more self-sustained.

PRADHAN MANTRI SURAKSHIT MATRITVA YOJANA: 9 JUNE 2016

This scheme by the Modi government aims at providing free health checkups for pregnant women for the first six months of pregnancy.

Also, a benefit of this scheme is a free treatment for the pregnant woman on the 9th of every month.

VIDYANJALI YOJANA: 16 JUNE 2016

Vidyanjali Yojana has been introduced to provide equal primary education to all budding children across India. The action plan is that volunteers will provide free primary education in all rural government schools.

GANGAJAL DELIVERY SCHEME: 10 JULY 2016

This scheme was launched in the state of Bihar to provide clean water of the Ganges to domestic areas via postal services.

MISSION BHAGIRATHI IN TELANGANA: 7 AUGUST 2016

The problem of safe drinking water in Telangana district was solved with the introduction of this scheme. It aims at building a proper pipeline and filtering infrastructure in order to provide clean water for drinking purposes and household use.

SMART GANGA CITY: 13 AUGUST 2016

This scheme was launched in 10 cities located on the banks of Ganga. The action plan is to provide proper sewage discharge by establishing sewage treatment plants.

NATIONAL APPRENTICESHIP PROMOTION SCHEME: 19 AUGUST 2016

The National Apprenticeship Scheme states that according to the Government of India, a monthly stipend of INR 1,500 must be paid to all apprentices by the private and government companies that employ them.

RAILWAY TRAVEL INSURANCE SCHEME: 1 SEPTEMBER 2016

This scheme states that an insurance of 10 lakhs INR will cover each passenger traveling by Indian Rail while booking a ticket if an amount of 92 paise is paid. It aims at providing proper accident relief in case of any major mishaps.

UDAY DESH KA AAM NAGRIK (UDAN SCHEME): 21 OCTOBER 2016

UDAN Scheme aims at providing affordable aviation by making domestic flight charges economically accessible for middle-class citizens of India.

URJA GANGA: 24 OCTOBER 2016

Launched in Varanasi, this scheme aims at providing cooking gas to all houses in the town of Varanasi and its neighbouring areas along the banks of Ganga. About 50,000 domestic households have benefited from the URJA Ganga till date.

EK BHARAT SHRESTHA BHARAT: 31 OCTOBER 2016

Modi introduced this scheme to strengthen the bond between all the states, regions and districts of India. This will involve a mandatory partnership between two states at a time and exchange of cultural and educational values between them.

DEMONETIZATION-CEASE OF INR 500 AND INR 1000 TO BE LEGAL NOTES: 8 NOVEMBER 2016

The end of 2016 was marked by demonetization which collapsed the very foundation of every black money holder across India. Overnight the old 500 and 1000 rupees notes were withdrawn from the market and new currency notes of INR 500 and INR 2000 were introduced.

PRADHAN MANTRI UJJWALA YOJANA: 23 DECEMBER 2016

This scheme aims at providing LPG connection to all domestic households in Maharashtra to solve their problem of limited cooking fuel for regular use.

CASHLESS TRANSACTION SCHEME: EFFECTIVE FROM 2017

A supporting scheme for demonetization, the idea is to promote cashless transactions via the unique Aadhaar card issued to the citizens of India. The bank account will be linked to the Aadhaar card in order to enable complete cash-free transactions.

PRADHAN MANTRI JAN DHAN YOJANA (PMJDY)

Objectives of PMJDY

- Universal access to banking facilities for all households across the country through a bank branch or a fixed point Business Correspondent (BC) within a reasonable distance.
- To cover all households with at least one Basic Bank Account with RuPay Debit card.
- Having inbuilt accident insurance cover of ₹ 1 lakh.
- An overdraft facility upto ₹ 5,000/- after satisfactory operation in the account for six months.
- A life cover of ₹ 30,000/- to those beneficiaries who open their accounts for the first time from 15 August 2014 to 31 January 2015.
- Financial literacy programme which aims to take financial literacy upto village level.
- The mission also envisages expansion of Direct Benefit Transfer under various government schemes through bank accounts of the beneficiaries.
- Providing micro-insurance to the people.
- Unorganized sector pension schemes through the Business Correspondents.

Achievements Under PMJDY (as on 21 December 2016)

- 26.03 crore accounts have been opened under PMJDY out of which 15.86 crore accounts are in rural areas and 10.17 crore in urban areas.
- Deposits of ₹ 71,557.90 crore have been mobilized.
- 19.93 crore RuPay Debit cards have been issued under PMJDY.
- Aadhaar seeding in PMJDY accounts 14.43 crore.
- Zero balance accounts has been reduced to 23.86%.
- Household coverage: 99.99% households out of the 21.22 crore households surveyed have been covered under PMJDY.

Insurance Claims Settled

As on 23 December 2016, out of 1,712 claims lodged, 1,626 claims have been disposed of under accidental insurance cover of ₹ 1 lakh under RuPay debit card.

JAN DHAN TO JAN SURAKSHA

Social Security Schemes in the Insurance and Pension sectors;

1. Pradhan Mantri Suraksha Bima Yojana,
2. Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana,
3. Atal Pension Yojana on Pan India basis on 9 May 2015.

PRADHAN MANTRI JEEVAN JYOTI BIMA YOJANA (PMJJBY)

1. The PMJJBY is available to people in the age group of 18 to 50 years having a bank account who give their consent to join/enable auto-debit.
2. Aadhaar would be the primary KYC for the bank account.
3. The life cover of ₹ 2 lakhs shall be for the one-year period.
4. Risk coverage under this scheme is for ₹ 2 lakh in case of death of the insured, due to any reason.
5. The premium is ₹ 330 per annum which is to be auto-debited in one instalment from the subscriber's bank account.
6. The scheme is being offered by Life Insurance Corporation and all other life insurers.

PRADHAN MANTRI SURAKSHA BIMA YOJANA (PMSBY)

1. Age group 18 to 70 years with a bank account who give their consent to join/enable auto-debit.
2. Aadhaar would be the primary KYC for the bank account.
3. The risk coverage under the scheme is ₹ 2 lakh for accidental death and full disability and ₹ 1 lakh for partial disability.
4. The premium of ₹ 12 per annum.
5. The scheme is being offered by Public Sector General Insurance Companies or any other General Insurance Company.

ATAL PENSION YOJANA (APY)

1. APY was launched on 9 May 2015.
2. APY is open to all bank account holders in the age group of 18 to 40 years and the contributions differ, based on pension amount chosen.
3. Subscribers would receive the guaranteed minimum monthly pension of ₹1,000 or ₹2,000 or ₹3,000 or ₹ 4,000 or ₹5,000 at the age of 60 years.

4. Under APY, the monthly pension would be available to the subscriber, and after him to his spouse and after their death, the pension corpus, as accumulated at age 60 of the subscriber, would be returned to the nominee of the subscriber.
5. The central government would also co-contribute 50% of the total contribution or ₹ 1,000 per annum, whichever is lower, for a period of five years.

Some Recent Revisions in APY

In the event of premature death of the subscriber, government has decided to give an option to the spouse of the subscriber to continue contributing to APY account of the subscriber, for the remaining vesting period, till the original subscriber would have attained the age of 60. The earlier provision was to over lump sum amount to spouse on the premature death (death before 60 years of age) of the subscriber.

PRADHAN MANTRI MUDRA YOJANA (PMMY)

- Launched on 8 April 2015 to provide formal access of financial facilities to Non-Corporate Small Business Sector (NCSBS).
- All loans sanctioned on or after 8 April 2015 upto a loan size of ₹ 10 lakh for non-farm income generating activities will be branded as PMMY loans.

Objective: To promote and ensure bank finance to unfunded segments of the economy.

Target Clients

Non-Corporate Small Business Segment (NCSB) comprising of proprietorship/partnership firms running as small manufacturing units, service sector units, shopkeepers, fruits/vegetable vendors, truck operators, food-service units, repair shops, machine operators, small industries, artisans, food processors and others, in rural and urban areas.

Schemes under PMMY

Scheme	Amount of Loan
Shishu	Up to ₹ 50,000/-
Kishore	Above ₹ 5,000/- and up to ₹ 5 Lakh
Tarun	Above ₹ 5 lakh and up to ₹ 10 lakh

Features of MUDRA Loans under PMMY

1. Borrowers can avail loan facility from any Public/Private/Regional Rural Banks, NBFCs and MFIs.
2. No processing fee for loans up to ₹50,000/- (Shishu category).
3. Banks have been mandated by RBI not to insist for collateral security in the case of loans upto 10 lakh extended to the units in the Micro Small Enterprises sector.
4. Activities allied to Agriculture, e.g. pisciculture, beekeeping, poultry, livestock, rearing, grading, sorting, aggregation agro industries, dairy, fishery, agriclinics and agribusiness centres, food and agro-processing, etc., also included.
5. All credit-related matters of banks including charging of interest (ROI) have been deregulated by RBI and are governed by the banks' own lending policies.

STAND-UP INDIA SCHEME

- The scheme was launched on 5 April 2016. The scheme envisages extending bank loans between ₹ 10 lakh and ₹ 1 crore for Greenfield Enterprises set-up by SC, ST and women entrepreneurs and extending effective handholding support to them.
- Each bank branch is to extend loans to at least one SC/ST and one woman entrepreneur.
- Enterprises covered under the scheme may be in manufacturing, services or the trading sector.
- The scheme shall be implemented through 1.25 lakh bank branches of all scheduled commercial banks.
- Credit Guarantee Fund Scheme for Stand-Up India (CGFSI) is operational with a corpus fund of ₹ 5,000 crore.
- A dedicated portal (www.standupmitra.in) for the Stand-Up India Scheme is active.
- The portal as a virtual market place endeavours to provide 'End-to-End' solutions not only for credit delivery but also for a host of handholding services.

VIDYA LAKSHMI PORTAL

- Vidya Lakshmi Portal (VLP) (www.vidyalakshmi.co.in) was launched on 15 August 2015.

- Developed and is being maintained by NSDL e-Governance Infrastructure Limited.
- Students can view, apply and track the education loan applications made to banks anytime, anywhere by accessing the portal.
- Twenty seven PSBs, six Private Sector Banks and two co-operative bank have integrated their system with the VLP for submitting online loan applications and for providing loan processing status to students.
- This initiative aims to bring on board all banks providing educational loans. The portal covers 64 educational loan schemes of different banks.

DEENDAYAL UPADHYAY GRAM JYOTI YOJANA (DUGJY)

Launched: 25 July 2015 in Patna

Objective: To bring reforms and uninterrupted power supply in rural areas of the country.

Features

- Funding of ₹ 43,033 crores.
- BPL will get a free electricity connection with LED lamps at ₹ 3,000 per connection.
- GARV-2 app launched to provide real-time data about the 6 lakh villages of the country.
- Hundred per cent electrification of rural areas.

PRADHAN MANTRI UJJAWALA YOJANA (PMUY)

Launched: 1 May 2016 in Uttar Pradesh

Objective: Social welfare by providing LPG connections to BPL households in the country.

Features

- To replace the unclean cooking fuels with the clean and more efficient LPG.
- Financial support of ₹ 1,600 for each LPG connection.
- Implemented by the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas.

URJA GANGA YOJANA (UGY)

Launched: 24 October 2016 in Varanasi

Objective: A 2,540 km long gas pipeline which will guarantee supply of clean and eco-friendly fuel to at least seven main cities – Varanasi, Patna, Jamshedpur, Kolkata, Ranchi, Bhubaneswar and Cuttack.

Features

- To provide the accessibility of approx. 5 lakh LPG gas cylinders within next five years.
- Twenty thousand vehicles will get CNG.

SWACHH SWASTH SARVATRA ABHIYAN (SSSA)

Launched: 25 December 2016 by Union Health Ministry in collaboration with the Ministry of Drinking Water and Sanitation and Human Resource Development.

Objective: To strengthen health centres in open defecation-free blocks

Features: Grant of ₹10 lakh to each Community Health Centres (CHCs) in ODF blocks of the country.

Main components

- CHCs in ODF blocks supported to achieve Kayakalp certification.
- Gram Panchayat of Kayakalp Primary Health Centres (PHCs) prioritized to become ODF.
- Training in WASH (Water, Sanitation and Hygiene) of CHC/PHC nominees.

Deendayal Antyodaya Mission (DAM)

Launched: June 2011

Objective: To nurture rural power till they come clear of abject poverty.

To expand livelihoods in small enterprises, agriculture-based rural areas and employment in formal sector.

Features

- Also known as National Rural Livelihood Mission (NRLM).
- SAMARTHYA – A set of 10 training programmes focusing on technical education created under MGNREGA.
- Provides scope for value addition, innovation and entrepreneurship.

PRADHAN MANTRI SURAKSHIT MATRITVA ABHIYAN (PMSMA)

Launched: 9 June 2016

Objective: To improve the quality and coverage of Antenatal Care with Diagnostics and Counselling services as part of Reproductive Maternal Neonatal Child and Adolescent Health.

Features

- Offers some additional opportunities to all pregnant women who have missed their ante-natal visits due to some reasons.
- Provides care provision by a doctor, physician or specialist in the second or third trimester.
- PMSMA will be held on the 9th of every month.

PRADHAN MANTRI VITTIYA SAKSHARTA ABHIYAAN (PMVSA)

Launched: 1 December 2016 by Human Resource Development Minister Prakash Javadekar in New Delhi.

Objective: To go for cashless transaction and payment modes like using credit or debit cards or the payment wallets to reduce the malpractice in the country.

Features

- To stop the malpractice of corruption and to finish black money in India.
- Encourages the common people to evolve and opt for cashless transactions.

DIGI DHAN VYAPAR YOJANA (DDVY)

Launched: 15 December 2016 by Prime Minister Narendra Modi

Proposed by: NITI Ayog headed by Arvind Panagariya

Objective: To increase the 'Cashless Transactions'

Features

- NITI Ayog stands for the 'National Institution for Transforming India'.
- Prizes for merchants for all digital transactions are worth ₹ 50,000, ₹ 5,000 and ₹ 2,500.

- Incentives shall be restricted to transactions within the range of ₹ 50 and ₹ 3,000 (common people).
- The winners will be selected through a random draw of the eligible Transaction IDs.

LUCKY GRAHAK YOJANA (LGY)

Launched: 15 December 2016 by NITI Aayog and NPCI

Objective: To increase the 'Cashless Transactions'

Features

- In this Yojana, there is a lucky draw for those who will do more cashless transactions during a particular period. This scheme is for merchants and customers only.
- Those who are doing cashless transactions by using AEPS, USSD, UPI, RuPay will be eligible for this scheme.

PRADHAN MANTRI GARIB KALYAN YOJANA (PMGKY)

Launched: December 2016

Objective: To improve the financial position of the poor people.

Features

- To organize Garib Kalyan Mela
- Make our country developing to developed

NTR AROGYA RAKSHA SCHEME

Launched: 1 December 2016 in Vijayawada

Objective: To provide medical treatment to the people belonging to Above Poverty Line (APL) at ₹ 1,200 premium per annum.

Features

- Offers health insurance cover up to 2 lakh and free treatment.
- Provides medical treatment for 1,044 diseases.
- The new married couple either the wife or husband who belongs to other state can be registered under one family by paying the entire annual premium.
- People can register for this scheme at any of the Mee Seva centres till 28 February 2017.

DIGI-LOCKER SCHEME

Launched: 1 July 2015

Objective: To provide a secure storage of documents in digital form I

Features

- Helpful in sharing the e-documents through the registered repositories.
- Digital document contains the URL's of the documents issued by the government agencies or any other entities. Uploaded documents contain all the documents uploaded by the user, each not exceeding 10 mb of space.

ATAL AMRIT ABHIYAN (AAA)

Launched: 25 December 2016 on 92nd birth anniversary of Atal Bihari Vajpayee

Objective: To provide health insurance against 437 illnesses including 5 critical diseases.

Features

- The scheme will roll out from 1 April 2017.
- A health/smart card will be given at the cost of ₹ 100/-.
- Four hundred and thirty seven illnesses are divided into six groups which are kidney, cardiovascular, cancer, burns, neo-natal and neurological conditions.

NAGAR UDAY SCHEME (NUS)

Launched: 25 December 2016 on the birthday of former Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee

Launched: Chief Minister of Madhya Pradesh Shivraj Singh Chouhan

Objective: To assess service being provided to citizens and bring them at standard life.

Features

- To inform lower-income class people about public welfare scheme and provide benefit.
- Under this scheme, CM Shivraj Singh Chouhan flagged off Uday Abhiyan Rath and 51 e-rickshaws.

VOLUNTARY DISCLOSURE AND SURCHARGE WAVIER SCHEME

Launched: 19 November 2016 by Haryana Government

Objective: For declaring tampered or defective meters for all category of consumer having sanctioned load up to 5KW and for small domestic and non-domestic consumers having sanctioned load up to 2 KW in rural areas.

Features

- Applicable to only those consumers falling in the aforesaid three categories, who were in default as on 30 September 2016.
- To replace old meters with a new electronic meter within three days.
- No checking during the period of operation of the scheme for consumers having load up to 5KW.

BARISTHA BUNKAR SAHAYATA YOJANA (BBSY)

Launched: 7 August 2016 by Odisha Government

Objective: All weavers within age of 60 years would get a monthly pension of ₹ 500/- per month.

Features

- Weavers above age of 80 years would get ₹ 700/- per month.
- Weavers within age of 60 years would get a monthly pension of ₹ 500.

PRADHAN MANTRI ZERO DEFICIT ZERO EFFECT SCHEME (ZED)

Launched: The scheme is launched on 2016 by Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

Objective: To suppress the bad effect of products on environment.

Features

- Micro Small and Medium Enterprises companies which follow the guidelines set by ZED and meet the standards set by the ZED will be awarded ZED certification along with various benefits.
- More emphasis on producing items that have 'Zero Deficits' so as to achieve the quality.
- To encourage a sustainable environment and development.

e-NIRVAN: ONLINE TAX-RELATED GRIEVANCE SCHEME

Launched: 8 September 2016 by CBDT.

Objective: To reduce the forged cases on tax evasions and to provide assistance through electronic media.

Features

- Works will be done under paperless environment under the eyes of an assessment officer of IT department.
- Everyone will be able to track their complaint and get a solution on the real-time basis.
- A separate and dedicated window for grievance redressal in the Income Tax Business Application.

MISSION BHAGIRATHI: SAFE DRINKING WATER SCHEME

Launch: 7 August 2016 in Telangana

Objective: To provide safe drinking water to everyone in the state through dedicated water pipeline channels in the state.

Features

- The state government has designed a water grid project to provide a sustainable and durable solution to the problem of safe drinking water.
- Mission 'Bhagirathi' will provide 100 litres and 150 litres of clean drinking water per person in rural households and in urban households, respectively.

KAYAKALP AWARD SCHEME

Launched: 15 May 2015 by Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

Objective: To promote cleanliness and enhance the quality of public health facilities in hospitals, clinics, public space.

To incentivize and recognize such public healthcare facilities that show exemplary performance in adhering to standard protocols of cleanliness and infection control.

Features

- Few parameters on which the performance of Health Facilities Centre would be judged are as Hospital or Facility Upkeep, Sanitation and hygiene, Waste Management, Infection control, Support Services, Hygiene Promotion.

PRADHAN MANTRI FASAL BIMA YOJANA (PMFBY)

Launched: 13 January 2016 by Government of India

Objective: To provide insurance coverage and financial support to the farmers in the event of failure of any of the notified crop as a result of natural calamities, pests and diseases.

Features

- It replaced the National Agriculture Insurance Scheme (NAIS) and modified NAIS.
- It covers nearly 50% of the total cropped area in our country in the next three years.
- It offers a uniform premium rate of 2% for Kharif crops and 1.5% for Rabi crops.

PRADHAN MANTRI AWAS YOJANA (PMAY)

Launched: 25 June 2015

Objective: To provide affordable houses to Indian citizen.

Features

- More than 2 crore houses to be built among which 1 crore houses are to be built by 2019.
- Ministry of Housing and Urban Poverty Alleviation (HUPA) is the nodal agency.
- It has a cost of 1.25 lakhs per unit.
- The houses constructed under PMAY will be in accordance with 'Going Green' concept.

UNNAT JYOTI BY AFFORDABLE LEDS FOR ALL(UJALA)

Launched: 1 May 2015 by Piyush Goyal

Objective: It aims at replacing 77 crores of incandescent lamps with LEDs which are more energy saving.

Features

- Domestic Efficient Lighting Programme (DELP) has come up with this new UJALA scheme.
- Energy Efficient Services Limited (EESL) has implemented the UJALA scheme.

LALIMA ABHIYAN

Launched: 1 November 2016 by CM of Madhya Pradesh Shivraj Singh Chouhan

Objective: To make the Madhya Pradesh anaemia free.

Features

- Iron folic acid tablets will be provided free in anganwadis, hospitals and academic institutions.
- Ferrous escorbate tablets will be distributed by the Health Minister J. P. Nadda.

KALINGA SHIKSHA SATHI YOJANA (KSSY)

Launched: 27 June 2016 by Chief Minister of Odisha Mr. Naveen Patnaik

Objective: To reduce the financial stress of the parents facing hardship in paying high rate of interest of educational loans.

To provide the education loan at only 1% interest rates.

Features

- The loan facility will be given to the students on the basis of their merit and the total annual income of their family.
- Release the financial burden from the shoulders of the parents of the aspiring students.
- The Odisha government is allotted the budget for this scheme which is nearly 500 crore from its own resources.

SOVEREIGN GOLD SCHEME

Launched: Budget session 2016

Objective: To reduce the demand of physical gold thus keeping a tab on gold imports and utilizing resources effectively.

Features

- On gold bond maturity, redemption will be made in Rupee only
- Price of gold bond will vary with the market prices of gold
- RBI has fixed tenor of the bond from five to seven years to protect the investors from medium term volatility.

ANNAPURNA RASOI YOJANA

Launched: 15 December 2016 by Rajasthan's Chief Minister Vasundhara Raje Annapurna

Objective: To provide nutritious food to street-dwellers, vendors, rickshaw-pullers and students and working women.

Features

- People will be provided breakfast at ₹ 5 and nutritious will be provided at ₹ 8.

- The scheme is implemented in 12 districts including Jaipur, Jodhpur, Kota, Ajmer, Bikaner, Udaipur, Bharatpur and many other districts along with Raje's constituency Jhalawar.
- The skilled will prepare meals with their gloves, head-masks and aprons on.

NIRAMAYA HEALTH INSURANCE

Launched: October 2016

Implemented and monitored by: National Trust with the active participation of the Local Level Committees (LLC).

Objective: To enable and empower persons with disability to live as independently and as fully as possible, health services and their access to persons with disabilities assume a very significant role.

Features

- Scheme available all over India except J&K
- Insurance cover of up to 1 lakh to PwDs
- Persons with disabilities under the National Trust Act are eligible.

SWAVLAMBAN HEALTH INSURANCE SCHEME

Launched: 2 October 2015

Implementing agency: New India Assurance Company

Objective: To provide affordable health facilities.

Features

- Uniform premium of ₹ 357 per PwD person throughout the country
- Sum insured is 2 lakhs for a year and will cover PwDs in the age group of 0 to 65 years
- OPD benefits include ₹ 10,000 p.a. per PwD and ₹ 3,000 p.a. for mentally retarded people
- No premedical tests involved
- Swavlamban excludes people with autism, cerebral palsy and multiple disabilities

3 New Initiatives Taken by the Ministry of Human Resources Development

EDUCATION FOR GIRLS

Beti Bachao Beti Padhao Abhiyan

The Department of School Education and Literacy has supported the Ministry of Women and Child Development for roll out of 'Beti Bachao Beti Padhao' Abhiyan in 100 districts of the country to enhance the sex ratio and the status of the girl child. An award is being instituted from the 'Beti Bachao Beti Padhao' Abhiyan for School Management Committees which achieve 100% transition of girls at different levels of education.

Swachh Vidyalaya

Under this provision, a functional girls toilet in every school is proposed. A specific 'Swachh Vidyalaya' campaign has been rolled out which will ensure that a functional toilet is available in every school before 15 August 2015.

Udaan

UDAAN is an initiative of the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) to enable disadvantaged girl students and other students from SC/ST and minorities to transit from school to post-school professional education especially in Science and Math. The first flight of UDAAN is to address lower enrolment of girls in engineering colleges which is currently about 23% girls as against 77% of boys. It aims to reduce the quality gap between school education and engineering education entrance systems by focussing on the three dimensions—curriculum design, transaction and assessment. It will do this by enriching and supplementing teaching and learning of Science and Mathematics at Senior Secondary level. The CBSE will provide free and online resources to the entire student population with special incentives and support to a thousand selected disadvantaged girls per year.

Swami Vivekananda Single Girl Child Scholarship for Research in Social Sciences

UGC has formulated this scheme under which 300 scholars would be provided Junior Research Fellowship @ ₹ 8,000–10,000/- per month, and will be implemented from academic year 2014–2015.

Pragati

Providing Assistance for Girls' Advancement in Technical Education Initiative: The AICTE scheme envisages selection of one girl per family where family income is less than 6 lakhs per annum on merit at the qualifying examination to pursue technical education. The scheme is to be implemented by the authorized admission centre of respective state governments. Four thousand girls are expected to benefit of scholarships available per annum. The scholarship amount is ₹ 30,000 or tuition fees or actual whichever is less and ₹ 2,000 per month for 10 months as contingency allowance.

PERSONS WITH SPECIAL NEEDS

Handbook on Inclusive Curricula

For integrating over 25 lakh children with special needs enrolled in elementary education across the country in a regular classroom environment, a handbook on curricular adaptations to orient all primary school teachers across the country was developed by National Council for Education Research and Training (NCERT) and released by the Human Resource Minister on 26 August 2014.

Saksham

Scholarship for Differently Abled Children: AICTE has decided to award 1,000 scholarships per annum to differently abled students to pursue technical education based on merit in the qualifying examination to pursue technical education. The scholarship amount would be ₹ 30,000 or tuition fees or actual whichever is less and ₹ 2,000 per month for 10 months as contingency allowance.

INITIATIVES FOR THE NORTH EAST

Rural Development in North East

- India's North East Region is endowed with huge untapped natural resources and is acknowledged as the eastern gateway for the country.

- The region comprises of eight states occupying 8% of India's geographical spread having 4% of country's population.
- Inspite of being endowed with vast natural resources in terms of forests, biological diversity, hydroelectricity, the region has remained largely underdeveloped.
- The region is connected with the rest of country by a narrow stretch of land called 'chicken's neck'. This region needs infrastructure to support and ensure significant investments and developmental aids.
- A good infrastructure and wide connectivity are the key factors for growth and development, both within the region and with rest of country.
- The region in past has witnessed a series of insurgencies and was alienated from the economic resurgence experienced by rest of country. But with time, the situation has improved and insurgencies have come to a halt.
- A critical appraisal of the key economic indicators along with a detailed sketch of the individual strengths of the eight states is necessary to achieve a holistic framework to target growth in the region.

Opportunities in and for North East India

- Increasing the speed of industrialization will lead to rapid economic development. New employment opportunities will be created for educated people and skilled labourers. It will also divert surplus labour from agriculture.
- Modernized means of cultivations should be used to increase employment potential of agriculture. Raising agricultural productivity through farm mechanization will help NER economy.
- The traditional educational system has to be replaced with technical and vocational educational system to make it production-oriented.
- Employment exchanges should be provided to increase the mobility of labour and reduce unemployment.
- To increase scope of self-employment, liberal institutional finance should be made available.
- Entrepreneurial mindset should be created among the indigenous people with government support and NGOs. Efficient implementation of SHG model with modification based on need and situation will deliver positive results.

- Tourism sector should be highly encouraged as NER provides wide range of choices and good value for money with nature's breath-taking scenic beauty, pleasant climatic conditions and extraordinary diverse cultural heritage of people.
- Healthy connectivity in terms of roads and mobile coverage will boost trade and commerce with the rest of the country.
- Special packages have been announced for socio-economic development of NER. Bodoland Territorial Council Package and Special Accelerated Road Development Programme are two of them.
- The Look East Policy of Government of India has made NER more important and strategic. Hence, it has to gear up to take more challenges and capitalize on opportunities thrown open by huge market in South East Asian countries.

Ishan Uday: Special Scholarship Scheme for students of North East Region

The UGC has launched a special scholarship Scheme for students of North East Region from the academic session 2014–2015. The scheme envisages grant of 10,000 scholarships to students from North East Region whose parental income is below ₹ 4.5 lakh per annum and would be provided scholarship ranging from ₹ 3,500 to 5,000 per month for studying at under graduate level in Colleges/Universities of the country.

ISHĀN VIKĀS

Ishan Vikas is a comprehensive plan to bring selected students from the school and college levels from the North Eastern states into close contact with the IITs, NITs and IISERs during their vacation periods. A typical visit is envisaged for a period of 10 days to one of these institutions, in the form of either an exposure or an internship programme. Each school will send 1 teacher to accompany a group of about 32 students of class IX and X and 8 teachers. The college students would be organized in two groups in summer and in winter, consisting of 32 students each group. About 2,016 college students and 504 teachers from NE will be visiting premier Institutes, like IIT/NIT/IISERs in an academic year.

The summer internship for students from the engineering colleges (state or centrally funded technological institutes) with stipends and travel will be taken up. From 25 institutions, about 250 students will be visiting 16 IITs and 6 NITs (to start with 6 NITs are being considered) per year.

Focus on Quality

- **Padhe Bharat Badhe Bharat:** This initiative was launched on 26 August 2014 to focus on the quality of foundational learning so that each child attains appropriate learning levels in classes I and II for reading, writing language comprehension and numeracy. Padhe Bharat Badhe Bharat is a sub-component of SSA and is being rolled out by 17 states and UTs.

  Framework of School Assessment and Evaluation: A framework for school assessment and evaluation is being developed as a self-improvement tool for schools themselves and also to re-orient school inspectors, district and block level officers to objective assessment of schools with a view to enhance their effectiveness. The programme in the field would be rolled out by January 2015.
- **Enabling Interaction of Scholars with our Students:** The initiative aims at creating a talent pool of eminent scientists/scholars abroad or in India to enable their interaction with Indian student/faculty. The task of identifying such scientists/scholars has been initiated. A database is being created with the help of eminent academic institutions so as to initiate activities from the academic year 2015.

ICT ENABLED ENHANCEMENT OF LEARNING OPPORTUNITIES

It aims to accelerate outreach, improve quality and promote equity by facilitating access to the best educational resources for learners/teachers:

SWAYAM (Study Webs of Active-Learning for Young Aspiring Minds) Programme

Under this programme, professors of centrally funded institutions like IITs, IIMs, centrally universities will offer online courses to citizens of our country. All courses will be made available free of cost for learning. In case, the learner requires a verified certificate, a small fee will be applicable.

In first phase, IIT Bombay, IIT Chennai, IIT Kanpur, IIT Guwahati, University of Delhi, Jawahar Lal Nehru University, IGNOU, IIM Bangalore, IIM Calcutta, Banaras Hindu University, alone as well as with the help of faculty from foreign universities will be offering courses in areas of engineering education, social science, energy, management, basic sciences. At least one crore students are expected to benefit in 2 to 3 years through this initiative. SWAYAM was launched in 2014.

National e-Library

The e-library has been envisaged as an online portal that will democratize access to knowledge by ensuring that quality content from central universities and premier educational institutions are available in a digital format that can be easily accessed by students, working professionals and researchers across the country through laptops, smartphones, tablets, PC's. International collaboration has been offered by Israel, Norway, the United Kingdom, and UNESCO. The National e-library becomes operational in the academic year 2015.

The National Repository of Open Educational Resources (NROER)

The NROER offers digital and digitizable resources (audio, video, interactive images and documents) in different languages along with online activities. Thirteen thousand seven hundred seventy three registered users/contributors of e-content, 71,447 unique visitors have already contributed more than 45 lakh hits on the NROER portal.

Use of ICT for Transparency and Accountability to Citizens

- **Know Your College:** There are almost 10,500 colleges which conduct about 14,000 programmes and 18,000 levels in technical education. Programmes are engineering/technology, architecture, pharmacy, applied arts, management and hotel management and catering technology. Levels are Diploma, Post Diploma, Graduate, Post Graduate and Ph.D. Similarly, there are more than 35,000 colleges conducting at least 20,000 programmes and 50,000 levels in the higher education sector (other than technical colleges).

  A new know your college portal has been developed for helping a prospective student make a valued judgement of the college. He/she wishes to join by providing him/her the necessary information about the same. KYC is a repository of information pertaining to colleges in India vis-à-vis faculty, labs and infrastructure.
- **Shaala Darpan:** Work has commenced on 'Shaala Darpan' to ensure that from next academic year, parents of students of government and government-aided schools can through a mobile application access updates on their child's progress regarding attendance, assignments and achievements.

- **GIS Mapping of Schools:** GIS mapping of schools at elementary as well as secondary level initiated and completed for 13 states with work underway for another 8 states. This enables mapping infrastructure gaps and responding to the felt needs of the people in providing schooling facilities.

19 New Institutions

- **Five IITs:** AP, J&K, Chhattisgarh, Goa, Kerala
- **Six IIMs:** HP, AP, Punjab, Maharashtra, Bihar, Odisha
- **Four new central universities:** AP (1 central university and 1 tribal university), MP (Jai Prakash Narayan National Centre For Excellence in Humanities), Bihar (Mahatma Gandhi Central University)
- One IISER, AP
- One NIT, AP
- One new IIIT, AP
- One tribal university, Telangana.

RIGHT TO EDUCATION ACT, 2009

Launched: 1 April 2010

Objective

Every child between 6 to 14 years of age to have free and compulsory education.

Main Features

- Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Bill, 2008, passed in both Houses of Parliament in 2009. The law received President's assent in August 2009.
- Article 21-A and the RTE Act come into effect on 1 April 2010
- Every child between the ages of 6 to 14 years has the right to free and compulsory education. This is stated as per the 86th Constitution Amendment Act via Article 21A. The Right to Education Act seeks to give effect to this amendment.
- The government schools shall provide free education to all the children and the schools will be managed by School Management Committees (SMC). Private schools shall admit at least 25% of the children in their schools without any fee.

- The National Commission for Elementary Education shall be constituted to monitor all aspects of elementary education including quality.
- No child shall be held back, expelled or required to pass a board examination until the completion of elementary education.
- If a child above 6 years of age has not been admitted in any school or could not complete his or her elementary education, then he or she shall be admitted in a class appropriate to his or her age.
- A child who completes elementary education shall be awarded a certificate.
- Call need to be taken for a fixed student–teacher ratio.
- School teachers will need adequate professional degree within five years or else will lose job.
- School infrastructure (where there is a problem) need to be improved in every 3 years, else recognition will be cancelled.
- Financial burden will be shared between the state and the central government.

SAMAGRA SHIKSHA SCHEME

Launched: May 24, 2018

Samagra Shiksha is an overarching programme for the school education sector extending from pre-school to class 12. The scheme has been prepared with the broader goal of improving school effectiveness measured in terms of equal opportunities for schooling and equitable learning outcomes. It subsumes the three Schemes of Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan (SSA), Rashtriya Madhyamik Shiksha Abhiyan (RMSA) and Teacher Education (TE).

Objectives

- Provision of quality education and enhancing learning outcomes of students;
- Bridging Social and Gender Gaps in School Education;
- Ensuring equity and inclusion at all levels of school education;
- Ensuring minimum standards in schooling provisions;
- Promoting Vocationalisation of education;

- Support States in implementation of Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education (RTE) Act, 2009; and
- Strengthening and up-gradation of SCERTs/State Institutes of Education and DIET as a nodal agencies for teacher training.

Features

- Treat school education holistically as a continuum from Pre-school to Class 12
- Supporting States to initiate pre-primary education
- Single and unified administrative structure leading to harmonized implementation
- Flexibility to States to prioritise their interventions under the Scheme
- An integrated administration looking at 'school' as a continuum
- Allocation of grants as per Learning outcomes and steps taken for quality improvement
- Emphasis on improvement of Learning Outcomes
- Enhanced Capacity Building of Teachers
- Focus on strengthening Teacher Education Institutions like SCERTs and DIETs
- SCERT to be the nodal institution for in-service and pre-service teacher training
- Strengthening of Teacher Education Institutions SCERT/DIET/BRC/CRC/CTEs/IASEs.
- Annual Grant per school for strengthening of Libraries
- Use of digital technology in education through smart classrooms, digital boards and DTH channels
- "DIKSHA", digital portal for teachers to be used extensively for upgrading skills of teachers
- Transport facility to children across all classes from I to VIII for universal access to school
- Increased allocation for infrastructure strengthening in schools
- Composite school grant increased and to be allocated on the basis of school enrolment.
- Specific provision for Swachhta activities – support 'Swachh Vidyalaya'
- Improve the Quality of Infrastructure in Government Schools

- Upgradation of KGBVs from Class 6-8 to Class 6-12 .
- Self-defence training for girls from upper primary to higher secondary stage
- Stipend for CWSN girls to be provided from Classes I to XII (earlier only IX to XII).
- Allocation for uniforms under RTE Act enhanced per child per annum.
- Allocation for textbooks under the RTE Act, enhanced per child per annum.
- Allocation for Children with Special Needs (CwSN) increased from ₹ 3000 to ₹ 3500 per child per annum. Stipend of ₹ 200 per month for Girls with Special Needs from Classes 1 to 12.
- Exposure to Vocational Skills at Upper Primary Level would be extended.
- Strengthening of vocational education at secondary level as an integral part of curriculum
- Vocational education which was limited to Class 9-12, to be started from class 6
- Sports Education to be an integral part of curriculum
- Every school will receive sports equipments under the scheme
- Preference to Educationally Backward Blocks (EBBs), LWEs, Special Focus Districts (SFDs), Border areas and the 115 aspirational districts identified by Niti Aayog

NATIONAL TALENT SEARCH SCHEME (NTSS)

Launched: 1963

National Talent Search Scheme is a flagship activity of the NCERT started in the year 1963. The purpose of the scheme was to identify talented students and nurture their talent. Talent refers to the potentiality that manifests itself in a high level of performance in one or more specialized areas. The scheme, therefore, covers areas like Sciences, Social Sciences, Engineering, Medicine, Management and Law. It honours and helps talented students by providing financial assistance in the form of a monthly scholarship. For the courses in Basic Sciences, Social Sciences and Commerce, this assistance is provided up to Ph.D. level. For professional courses like Engineering, Medicine, Management and

Law this assistance is given only up to Post Graduation. The NCERT conducts the National Talent Search Examination for students studying in Class X only.

Coverage and Scholarship Amount

On the basis of the examination conducted, 1000 scholarships will be awarded for different stages of education as follows.

- Scholarship of ₹ 1250/- per month for Class XI to XII
- Scholarship of ₹ 2000/- per month for UG and PG
- Amount of scholarship for PhD be fixed in accordance with UGC norms

General Eligibility

Students of Class X studying in recognized schools are eligible to appear for Stage I examination conducted by the States/UTs in which the schools are located. There will be no domicile restriction.

Mode of Selection

- There will be two-stage selection process for award of scholarship. For Stage-I, selection will be done by States/UTs through a written examination. Students who qualify Stage I will be eligible to appear for Stage II examination conducted by NCERT. The written test is followed by an interview. Candidates qualifying the written examination at the national level are invited for an interview. The final award is made on the basis of combined scores of MAT, SAT and the interview.

  The pattern of written examination for Class VIII will be as follows:

  - **Stage I** examination at the State/UT level will comprise two parts, namely (a) Mental Ability Test (MAT) and (b) Scholastic Ability Test (SAT) covering social sciences, sciences and mathematics.
  - **Stage II** examination at the National level will comprise (a) Mental Ability Test (MAT), (b) Scholastic Ability Test (SAT) covering Social Sciences, Sciences and Mathematics.

Total Number of Scholarships

- A total of (at least) 1,000 students are selected each year.
- Reservation: 15% scholarships are reserved for SC category students, 7.5% for ST category and 3% for Physically Challenged students.

Important Dates

- Please visit the NCERT website for Dates for Submission of Application Form and conduct of examination etc as they may change time to time.

Application Procedure

- Please visit the NCERT website for common application form and admit card etc as they may change time to time

PRE-MATRIC SCHOLARSHIP FOR STUDENTS OF THE MINORITY COMMUNITIES

Objective

The scholarship at pre-matric level will encourage parents from minority communities to send their school going children to school, lighten their financial burden on school education and sustain their efforts to support their children to complete school education. Empowerment through education, which is one of the objectives of this scheme, has the potential to lead to Upliftment of the socio economic conditions of the minority communities

Coverage of the Scheme

The scholarship will be awarded for studies in India in a government or private school from class I to class X, including such residential Government institutes and eligible private institutes selected and notified in a transparent manner by the State Government and Union Territory Administration concerned.

Distribution

Muslims, Sikhs, Christians, Buddhists, Jain and Zoroastrians (Parsis) have been notified as minority communities under Section 2 (c) of the National Commission for Minorities Act, 1992. A total of thirty (30)

lakh scholarships are targeted to be distributed as 'Fresh' Scholarships, besides, Renewal scholarships. The distribution of scholarship among the States/Union Territories will be made on the basis of population of minorities in the States/Union Territories as per Census 2001 for 2017-18 and as per the population of minorities in the States/Union Territories of Census 2011 for 2018-19 and 2019-20.

Earmarked for Girl Students

30% of scholarship will be earmarked for girl students. In case sufficient numbers of eligible girl students are not available, then the balance earmarked scholarships may be awarded to eligible boy students.

Eligibility

Scholarship will be awarded to the students who have secured not less than 50% marks in the previous final examination and annual income of their parents/guardian from all sources does not exceed ₹ 1 Lakh.

Scholarship Amount and Duration

Actual financial assistance will be provided for admission/tuition fee and maintenance allowance as given below subject to a maximum ceiling indicated against item concerned.

S.No	Item	Rate of Scholarship
1	Rate of Scholarship Admission + Tuition Fee	Admission Fee for Class VI to X: ₹ 500/- per annum subject to actuals (both Hosteller & Day Scholar) Tuition Fee for Class VI to X: ₹ 350/-per month subject to actuals (both Hosteller & Day Scholar)
2	Maintenance allowance	For Class I to V*: ₹ 100/- per month for Day Scholar For Class VI to X*: ₹ 600/-per month for Hosteller ₹ 100/-per month for Day Scholar * For 10 months in an academic year.

* Hostellers include students who are staying in hostel of the school/institute concerned or those provided by the State Government/Union Territory Administration concerned.

Renewal of Scholarship

The scholarship, once awarded, may be renewed during next academic year of the course on the production of certificate that the student has secured 50% marks.

Announcement of Scheme

The scheme will be announced by the concerned State Government/ Union Territory Administration well in time, by giving advertisements in the leading language newspapers and local dailies/vernacular and by using other suitable publicity media.

Mode of Applying

The scheme is implemented through the National Scholarship Portal (NSP). It is mandatory for all students to apply online on the website i.e. www.scholarships.gov.in.

PRE-MATRIC SCHOLARSHIP SCHEME FOR OBC

Objective

The scheme of Pre-matric Scholarship for the benefit of children belonging to Weaker Section amongst OBCs has been formulated and this Scholarship would be helpful in spreading education amongst such children especially amongst the girl child of weaker sections.

Coverage Value of Scholarship and Ad-Hoc Grant

Hostlers: The students as hostlers will be covered from class III to X. The rate of scholarships is ₹ 500 per month for 10 months.

Day Scholars: The students as day scholars will be covered from Class I to Class X. The rate of scholarships is ₹ 100 per month for 10 months.

Ad-Hoc Grant: An ad-hoc grants of ₹ 500/- per student per annum to all students i.e. hostlers as well as day scholars will also be given.

Amount will be payable from the date of joining to the date of leaving the school, excluding the period of vacation, which will be about 10 months in a year except in the cases where the students enters late or leaves early in the midst of academic year.

Duration and Course

The scholarships may be given to the students enrolled in class I or any subsequent class of pre-matric stage in the case of day scholars, and class III or any subsequent class of pre-matric stage in the case of hostlers. The scholarship will terminate at the end of class X. The duration of scholarship in an academic year will be 10 months.

Mode of Selection

The concerned State Governments and Union Territory Administrations will lay down the detailed procedure for selection of students.

Eligibility

Scholarship award will be sanctioned in the case of students whose parents/ guardians income from all sources does not exceed ₹ 2,50,000 per annum.

Conditions of Award

- The students may not be allowed to take up employment or render help to parents in their work during the course of studies.
- The award will be discontinued if a student fails to secure annual promotion except in case of unavoidable reasons to be certified by the competent authority of the scheme.
- If a student violates school discipline or any other terms and conditions of the scholarship, scholarship may be suspended or even cancelled, subject to the satisfaction of the competent school authority. The State Government/ Union Territory Administrations can also directly cancel the award if duly satisfied of the reasons of violation of these regulations governing the scheme.
- Migration of students from one institution to another would not normally be allowed during the course of academic year except under exceptional circumstances and in the interest of student's academic career.
- The scholar obtaining benefits under this scheme shall not be allowed to avail of benefits under any other pre-matric scholarship scheme.
- The students should be regular in attendance for which the yardstick shall be decided by the competent authority of the school.

Renewal of Scholarship

The scholarship, once awarded, may be renewed during next academic year also by the concerned State Government/ Union Territory Administration unless the competent authority of the school recommends to the State Government/ Union Territory Administration, to discontinue the award with reference to relevant clause of these regulations governing the scheme.

Announcement of the Scheme

The scheme will be announced by the concerned State Government/ Union Territory Administration well in time, by giving advertisements in the leading language newspapers local dailies and by using other suitable publicity media.

Application Procedure

The concerned Department of the State Government/ Union Territory Administration will supply the application forms, which should be received back by the Department along with prescribed certificate, by the last date.

PRE-MATRIC SCHOLARSHIPS TO THE CHILDREN OF PARENTS ENGAGED IN OCCUPATIONS INVOLVING CLEANING AND PRONE TO HEALTH HAZARDS

Objective

The object of the scheme is to provide financial assistance to children whose parents/guardian belongs to one of the following categories, to pursue Pre-matric education:

- Persons who are either presently engaged in manual scavenging or were so engaged upto or after 1.1.1997 or the date on which the "The Employment of manual scavengers and construction of Dry latrines (Prohibition) Act 1993" came into force in their State/UT, whichever is earlier.
- Tanners and
- Flayers
- Waste pickers

Coverage, Value of Scholarship and Ad-Hoc Grant

Hostellers: The students as hostellers will be covered from class III to X. The rates of scholarships for Class III to X is ₹ 700/- per month for 10 months.

Day Scholars: The students as day scholars will be covered from Class I to Class X. The rates of scholarships are ₹ 110/- per month for 10 months

Ad-Hoc Grant: An ad hoc grant of ₹ 750/- per student per annum to all day scholars and ₹ 1000/- per student per annum to hostellers would be admissible.

The scholarship amount will be payable from the date of joining to the date of leaving the school, excluding the period of vacation, which will be about 10 months in a year except in the cases where the students enters or leaves early in the midst of academic year.

Duration and Course

The scholarships may be given to students enrolled in class I or any subsequent class or pre-matric stage in the case of day scholars, and class III or any subsequent class of pre-matric stage in case of hostellers. The scholarship will terminate at the end of class X. The duration of scholarship in an academic year is ten months.

The scholarship will be tenable only in such institutions and for such pre matriculations courses, which have been duly recognised by the concerned State Government and Union Territory Administrations.

Mode of Selection

- The Parental occupation of the applicant is the important criteria for selection of the candidate eligibility.
- The concerned State Governments and Union Territory Administrations will lay down the detailed procedure for selection of students.

Conditions of Award

- The students may not be allowed to take up employment or render help to parents in their work during the course of studies.
- The award will be discontinued if a student fails to secure annual promotion except in case of unavoidable reasons to be certified by the competent authority of the scheme.

- The students should be regular in attendance for which the yardstick is to be decided by the competent authority of the school.

Renewal of Scholarship

The scholarship, once awarded, may be renewed during next academic year also by the concerned State Government/Union Territory Administration unless the competent authority of the school recommends to the State Government/Union Territory Administration, to discontinue the award with reference to relevant clause of these regulations governing the scheme.

PRE-MATRIC SCHOLARSHIP (CLASS IX AND X) FOR ST STUDENTS

Objective

- To support parents of ST children for education of their wards studying in classes IX and X so that the incidence of drop-out, especially in the transition from the elementary to the secondary stage is minimized, and
- To improve participation of ST children in classes IX and X of the prematric stage, so that they perform better and have a better chance of progressing to the post-matric stage of education.

Scope

- Scholarship under the Scheme will be available for studies in India only and will be awarded by the Government of the State/Union Territory to which the applicant belongs i.e. where she/he is domiciled.

Eligibility

- Student should belong to Scheduled Tribe
- Her/his Parents'/Guardian's income should not exceed ₹ 2.00 lakh per annum.
- She / he should not be getting any other Centrally-funded Pre-Matric Scholarship.
- She/ he should be a regular, full time student studying in a Government School or in a School recognized by Govt. or a Central/State Board of Secondary Education.
- Scholarship for studying in any class will be available for only one year. If a student has to repeat a class, she / he would not get scholarship for that class for a second (or subsequent) year.

Value of Scholarship

Item	Day Scholars	Hostellers
Scholarship for 10 months (₹ per month)	150	350
Books and Ad hoc Grant (₹ per annum)	750	1000

Selection of Candidates

1. All eligible Scheduled Tribe candidates will be given scholarships as prescribed in this scheme.
2. Candidates belonging to one State but studying in another State will be awarded scholarships by the State to which they belong and will submit their applications to the competent authority in that State.

Duration and Renewal of Awards

1. The scholarship will be payable for 10 months in an academic year.
2. The award once made will continue subject to good conduct and regularity in attendance. It will be renewed for Class X after the student passes Class IX.

Source: National Scholarship Portal

POST-MATRIC SCHOLARSHIP SCHEME TO OBC

Revised: w.e.f. September 2018

This is a 100 % centrally sponsored scheme being implemented through the State Government and Union Territories. The objective of the scheme is to provide financial assistance to the OBC students studying at post-matriculation or post-secondary stage to enable them to complete their education. The income ceiling of parents/guardians for eligibility is ₹ 1.00 lakh per annum (including self income, if employed).

Objective

The objective of the scheme is to provide financial assistance to the OBCs students studying at post matriculation or post-secondary stage to enable them to complete their education.

Scope

These scholarships shall be available for studies in India only and will be awarded by the Government of State/Union Territory to which the applicant actually belongs, i.e. permanently settled.

Value of Scholarship

- The rates under different Post-Matric Courses ranges between ₹ 750 per month and ₹ 260 per month for hostellers. For the day scholars the range is ₹ 350 to ₹ 160. Scholarship also include study tour charges @ ₹ 900 per annum (subject to actual expenditure), Thesis typing and printing charges @ ₹ 1000 (maximum), Book allowance for correspondence course @ ₹ 900 per annum and Reader charges for blind students in the range between ₹ 90 p.m. to ₹ 175 p.m.
- The scholarship for Commercial Pilot License (CPL) course is also covered under this scheme. Upto 20 awards per year for the whole country are provided on the first come first-serve basis. The selected candidates are provided an amount of ₹ 5000/- per flying hour in single/multiengine aircraft for 200 hours. In addition, maintenance allowances @ ₹ 750 p.m. for hostlers and ₹ 350 p.m. for day scholars is also paid.

Fees

Scholars will be paid enrolment/registration, tuition, games, union, library, magazine, medical examination and such other fees compulsorily payable by the scholar to the institution or University/Board. Refundable deposit-like caution money, security deposit will, however, be excluded.

Study Tours

Study tour charges upto a maximum of ₹ 900/- per annum limited to the actual expenditure incurred by the student on transportation charges etc., will be paid to the scholars studying professional and technical courses, provided that the head of the institution certifies that the study tour is essential for the scholar for completion of his/her course of study.

Thesis Typing /Printing charges

Thesis typing/printing charges upto a maximum of ₹ 1000 will be paid to research scholars on the recommendation of the Head of the Institution.

Mode of Selection

All the eligible Other Backward Classes candidates will be given scholarships subject to the condition of eligibility prescribed in conditions of eligibility of this Scheme. Candidates belonging to one State but studying in another State will be awarded scholarship by the State to which they belong and will submit their applications to the competent authorities in that State. In the matter of exemption from fees or other concessions also they will be treated as if they were studying in their own State.

Eligibility

The scholarships will be open to India nationals belonging to OBCs as notified by the Central Govt./State Govt. UT Admn.

NATIONAL FELLOWSHIP (NF) SCHEME FOR OBC STUDENTS

Revised with effect from 2017-2018

Objectives

The scheme aims at providing financial assistance to the OBC students in obtaining quality higher education leading to degrees such as M.Phil. and Ph.D. in universities, research institutions and scientific institutions.

Features

The scheme is designed to provide a total number of 300 Junior Research Fellowships per year from the year 2014-15 onwards and 300 Senior Research Fellowships during 2016-17 to Other Backward Class (OBC) students. The UGC is the nodal agency for implementing the scheme and notifies the scheme through advertisements in the media at a suitable date. The scheme covers all universities/institutions recognized by the University Grants Commission (UGC). Fellowships are awarded to research students pursuing M. Phil. and Ph.D. The rate of fellowship for JRF level is ₹ 25000 per month and for SRF level, it is ₹ 28000 per month.

An OBC student admitted to M.Phil./Ph.D. course in a University or academic institution after completing the required formalities of admission, is eligible for the award of Fellowship subject to provisions of the scheme as per the advertisement of UGC. The total period of award of JRF and SRF shall not exceed a period of 5 years. The fellowship will be paid from the date of registration of the student in the M.Phil./Ph.D. course. Only those, doing regular and full time M.Phil./Ph.D. course of a University/Research Institution shall be eligible for the fellowship.

4 Sector-Wise Recent Schemes Launched by Government: Banking and Financial Inclusion

BANKING AND FINANCIAL INCLUSION

Empowerment through Financial Inclusion

In the current economic scenario, financial inclusion is seen as an indispensable tool for empowerment. Time and again, various schemes have been introduced by the government to promote financial inclusion. This article focuses on various financial inclusion initiatives that are currently in place.

Banking Correspondents

They visit the villages and promote the use of banking services.

They bring banking system to the doorstep, thereby eliminating the inability of rural people to access banking facilities and at the same time helping the banks lower their cost of operation and also mobilize substantial capital.

NABARD's Initiatives

Promoting digital banking there by addressing the last mile connectivity problem. This is being done by providing RuPay Kisan credit cards, providing banking correspondents with micro ATMs, Point of Sale (PoS) machines at fertilizer outlets.

Promoting financial literacy by developing audio-visual tools like short films for educating the people about RuPay Kisan credit cards and RuPay debit cards.

Supporting 'Rural Entrepreneurship Development Programmes – REDPs' through NGOs by way of grant support to enable rural youth to take up self-employment.

Supports Self-Help Groups through 'Micro Enterprise Development Programme'.

SIDBI and Its Role in Promoting MSMEs

Large section of the rural population is dependent on agriculture sector for income. Fifty-four per cent of the country's population is dependent on agriculture sector which contributes only 16% to the national income. This is the prime reason for low-income levels among those dependent on agriculture for livelihood. Reduction of poverty in rural areas is directly linked to the ability of rural population, especially the youth to diversify and complement their agriculture income through off-farm micro and small enterprises.

SIDBI Foundation for Micro Credit (SFMC) was set up with a mission to create a network of strong, viable and sustainable Micro Finance Institutions (MFIs) for providing Micro Finance Services to the economically disadvantaged sections of the society.

Micro Unit Development Refinance Agency Limited (MUDRA) has been set as a wholly owned subsidiary of SIDBI. The main aim of MUDRA limited is to refinance the micro lending institutions.

Under ASPIRE – 'A Scheme for promotion of innovation, Rural Industry and Entrepreneurship' a fund of ₹ 60 crore has been created by SIDBI. The fund would invest in various venture capital funds with investment focus on start-ups and early stage enterprises in the areas of rural and agro industries.

Urban Migration and Employment Opportunities

Rural India accounts for 68% of the Indian population. Agriculture as an occupation is losing lustre among the rural population, especially the rural youth owing to low income. Hence, they are on the look for alternate employment. This could be addressed by promoting agro-based industries in the rural areas to supplement their income from agriculture and also reduce migration to urban areas in search of livelihood opportunities.

Need for empowerment of rural youth:

- Seventy four per cent of the rural households have monthly income less than ₹ 5,000.
- Monthly per capita expenditure in rural areas is ₹ 1,430 as against ₹ 2,630 in urban areas.
- Literacy rate is low in rural area compared to the urban areas.
- Labour participation rate among females in rural areas in only 25.5% leading to non-utilization of large section of manpower.
- Agriculture is the major source of employment.
- Only 3% of the workforce in rural areas is formally trained and 7% informally trained.

Migration from rural areas and associated problems:

- Every year, an estimated 2 million people migrate from rural to urban areas, depriving the rural areas of workforce, with direct consequences on agricultural productivity. This migration is primarily due to low income from agriculture and can be comprehensively addressed by providing alternative non-farm-based employment to the rural population.
- The migrated youth face problem of lack of housing, language barrier, underpaid jobs and skill deficiency in the initial years, which seriously affects their morale.
- The government has to set up youth hostels in urban areas to ensure adequate quality accommodation at affordable rates and career guidance programmes.

Dependence on farming fortunes:

Farming can be a suitable employment avenue, when the income levels are adequate to ensure a decent standard of living. This can be ensured by adoption of scientific practices in agriculture. Crop diversification, mixed farming, precision irrigation methods, judicious use of chemical fertilizers and supplementing the same with organic manures are some simple initiatives that can provide better returns and also ensure sustainability of agriculture.

Value addition

Food processing industries offer immense opportunities in terms of better income for farmers, employment generation and minimization of wastage of cultivated crops.

The employment generation potential of food processing industry is 2.5 times that of other industries for the same amount of capital invested.

Value addition plays a vital role in price stability. Better storage facilities can help in keeping a check over inflation in the event of a crop failure. Incidents of farmers dumping agriculture produce to sustain price levels at times of bumper harvest can also be avoided by promoting food processing industry.

Promoting private sector participation will bring in competition in the sector, which is essentially beneficial to the consumers in terms fulfilling nutritional needs at an affordable cost.

Need for non-farm employment opportunities:

If the current migration trend continues, we may soon face an unprecedented increase in urban population despite the fact that, even

current rate of increase in urban population has not been matched by expansion of amenities in the urban areas.

People would in fact prefer to live in rural areas and small towns, provided there is good employment opportunity, access to healthcare and education, road and telecom network.

Employment opportunities in rural areas in industrial sector can be promoted, but at the same time, the educational and vocation skills of the rural youth will have to be augmented to benefit from such industries. This can be done by promoting skill development through industrial training institutes.

Agritourism

India has a vast and varied agriculture landscape. This can be used to promote Agritourism which will have huge multiplier effect on the rural economy leading to new job generation in diverse occupations.

The state governments of Maharashtra, Kerala and Himachal Pradesh have already initiated efforts in this direction.

There is an imperative need to enhance rural infrastructure in terms of manpower and facilities so that the dream of Mahatma Gandhi of 'Gram Swaraj' is realized in every village of the country.

Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana

Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY) is national mission for financial inclusion to ensure access to financial services, namely, banking/savings and deposit accounts, remittance, credit, insurance, pension in an affordable manner.

Account can be opened in any bank branch or Business Correspondent (Bank Mitr) outlet. PMJDY accounts are being opened with zero balance. However, if the accountholder wishes to get cheque book, he/she will have to fulfil minimum balance criteria.

Special Benefits under PMJDY Scheme

- Interest on deposit
- Accidental insurance cover of ₹ 1 lakh
- No minimum balance required
- Life insurance cover of ₹ 30,000/-
- Easy transfer of money across India
- Beneficiaries of government schemes will get direct benefit transfer in these accounts

- After satisfactory operation of the account for sixmonths, an overdraft facility will be permitted
- Access to pension, insurance products
- Accidental insurance cover, RuPay debit card must be used at least once in 45 days.
- Overdraft facility upto ₹ 5,000/- is available in only one account per household, preferably lady of the household.

Documents required for opening an account under Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana

If Aadhaar card is not available, then any one of the following officially valid documents (OVD) is required: Voter ID card, driving license, PAN card, passport & NREGA card. If these documents also contain your address, it can serve both as 'Proof of Identity and Address'.

Highlights:

- Scheme for comprehensive financial inclusion launched by the Prime Minister of India, Narendra Modi, on 28 August 2014
- Run by department of financial services, Ministry of Finance
- Inauguration day, 1.5 crore bank accounts were opened under this scheme

Kisan Vikas Patra (KVP) (Reintroduced)

The re-launched Kisan Vikas Patra (KVP) will be available to the investors in the denomination of ₹ 1,000, 5,000, 10,000 and 50,000, with no upper ceiling on investment.

The certificates can be issued in single or joint names and can be transferred from one person to any other person/persons, multiple times. The facility of transfer from one post office to another anywhere in India and of nomination will be available. The certificate can also be pledged as security to avail loans from the banks and in other case where security is required to be deposited. Initially, the certificates will be sold through post offices, but the same will soon be made available to the investing public through designated branches of nationalized banks.

KVPs have unique liquidity feature, where an investor can, if he so desires, encash his certificates after the lock-in period of two years and six months and thereafter in any block of six months on pre-determined maturity value. The investment made in the certificate will double in 100 months.

Reintroduction of KVP is a welcome step not only in the direction of providing safe and secure investment avenues to the small investors but will also help in augmenting the savings rate in the country. The scheme will also safeguard small investors from fraudulent schemes. With a maturity period of eight years four months, the collections under the scheme will be available with the government for a fairly long period to be utilized in financing developmental plans of the centre and state governments and will also help in enhancing domestic household financial savings in the country.

History

KVP – a certificate savings scheme was launched by the government on 1 April 1988. The scheme provided facility of unlimited investment by way of purchase of certificates from post offices in various denominations. The maturity period of the scheme when launched was 5½ years and the money invested doubled on maturity.

SUKANYA SAMRIDDHI ACCOUNT

Sukanya Samriddhi Account is another welcome step from Government of India. Honourable Prime Minister of India, Shri Narendra Modi Ji launched Sukanya Samriddhi Account 'A Small Savings Scheme' on 22 January 2015. It is part of 'Beti Bachao Beti Padhao' initiative of Government of India (GOI) also known as BBBP.

Objective

Sukanya Samriddhi Account is trying to give a social message that girl child is not a financial burden if parents of a girl child secure their future through proper financial planning.

Seven Benefits

1. **Highest Interest Rate among All Small Savings Schemes Offered by Government of India:** Sukanya Samriddhi Account will offer interest rate of 9.1% for current financial year, i.e., FY 2014–2015. It is highest among all small savings schemes.
2. **Tax Savings:** In order to encourage people to open Sukanya Samriddhi Account, governmenthas exempted contribution to this account u/s 80C of the Income Tax Act, 1961.
3. **Lock-in Period:** In my opinion, this is the BEST feature of this scheme. The maturity of account is 21 years from the date of opening of the account or marriage of the girl child, whichever is earlier.

For marriage, girl should be of 18 years at the time of marriage. The operation of account is not permitted beyond date of marriage.

4. **Purpose of Sukanya Samriddhi Account:** As I mentioned earlier, it is quite evident that Sukanya Samriddhi Account is launched with sole objective of financial planning for the marriage of girl child. Social message is that marriage or education of a girl child is not a financial burden if parents plan well in advance.
5. **Maturity Proceeds to be Paid to Girl Child:** On maturity of Sukanya Samriddhi Account, the account balance along with accrued interest will be paid directly to the account holder, i.e., girl child. It gives financial independence to girl child which is currently missing in India.
6. **Interest to be Paid even after Maturity:** Unlike other financial schemes where interest is not paid after maturity of the deposit/ investment scheme,the unique feature of Sukanya Samriddhi Account is that even after maturity, if the account is not closed by the account holder, interest shall be payable in the account till final closure of the account.
7. **Flexibility to Operate Sukanya Samriddhi Account:** Based on past experience, Government of India has given lot of flexibility in terms of account operations.

Some are as follows:

- Account can be opened with initial deposit of ₹ 1,000 and thereafter any amount in multiple of ₹ 100 can be deposited subject to max limit of 1.5 lakh during financial year. Every FY, a min sum of ₹ 1,000 should be deposited to keep account operative.
- On attaining age of 10 years, a girl child can operate her account.
- Account can be closed if it is proved that account is causing undue hardship to the account holder.
- Account can be transferred anywhere in India.

Mudra Bank Yojana

Background

The Prime Minister Narendra Modi launched the Micro Units Development and Refinance Agency Ltd (MUDRA) Bank on 8 April 2015 with a corpus of ₹ 20,000 crore and a credit guarantee corpus of ₹ 3,000 crore. The launch was the fulfilment of an announcement made earlier by the Finance Minister Arun Jaitley in his FY 2015–2016 Budget speech.

The Principal Objectives of the MUDRA Bank are

- Regulate the lender and the borrower of microfinance and bring stability to the microfinance system through regulation and inclusive participation.
- Extend finance and credit support to Microfinance Institutions (MFI) and agencies that lend money to small businesses, retailers, self-help groups and individuals.
- Register all MFIs and introduce a system of performance rating and accreditation for the first time. This will help last-mile borrowers of finance to evaluate and approach the MFI that meets their requirement best and whose past record is most satisfactory. This will also introduce an element of competitiveness among the MFIs. The ultimate beneficiary will be the borrower.
- Provide structured guidelines for the borrowers to follow to avoid failure of business or take corrective steps in time. MUDRA will help in laying down guidelines or acceptable procedures to be followed by the lenders to recover money in cases of default.
- Develop the standardized covenants that will form the backbone of the last-mile business in future.
- Offer a credit guarantee scheme for providing guarantees to loans being offered to micro businesses.
- Introduce appropriate technologies to assist in the process of efficient lending, borrowing and monitoring of distributed capital.
- Build a suitable framework under the Pradhan Mantri MUDRA Yojana for developing an efficient last-mile credit delivery system to small and micro businesses.

Major Product Offerings

- **MUDRA Bank has rightly classified the borrowers into three segments:** the starters, the mid-stage finance seekers and the next level growth seekers.
- To address the three segments, MUDRA Bank has launched three loan instruments:
- **Shishu:** covers loans upto ₹ 50,000/-
- **Kishor:** covers loans above ₹ 50,000/- and upto ₹ 5 lakh
- **Tarun:** covers loans above ₹ 5 lakh and upto ₹ 10 lakh

Initially, sector-specific schemes will be confined to 'Land Transport, Community, Social & Personal Services, Food Product and Textile

Product sectors'. Over a period of time, new schemes will be launched to encompass more sectors.

Some of the Offerings Planned for the Future

- MUDRA card
- Portfolio credit guarantee
- Credit enhancement.

SOLAR CHARKHA MISSION

Launched: June 27, 2018

President Ram Nath Kovind on June 27, 2018 launched the Solar Charkha Mission covering artisans in 50 identified clusters and the Sampark portal, a digital platform to connect five lakh job seekers with recruiters at an event to mark the important economic role played by micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs).

Features

- The Solar Charkha Mission will entail a subsidy of ₹ 550 crore in the initial two years for 50 clusters and every cluster will employ 400 to 2000 artisans. The mission will generate employment in rural areas and contribute to the green economy.
- The digital platform `Sampark portal' will be useful in creating a skill pool of workers and connecting trained youth with job opportunities.
- "According to a survey, there are about 6.5 crore MSMEs in India which have created over 11 crore job opportunities.
- In 2017, the UN General Assembly had declared June 27 as MSME Day, recognising the importance of the sector in achieving sustainable development goals and in promoting innovation, creativity and sustainable work for all.

SINGLE POINT REGISTRATION SCHEME

The Government is the single largest buyer of a variety of goods. With a view to increase the share of purchases from the small-scale sector, the Government Stores Purchase Programme was launched in 1955-56. NSIC registers Micro & small Enterprises (MSEs) under Single Point Registration scheme (SPRS) for participation in Government Purchases.

Benefits of Single Point Registration Scheme

- Free of Cost Tender Information

- Exemption from EMD (Earnest Money Deposit)
- Advantage in Tender Participation
- Procurement from MSES

Eligibility

- All Micro & Small Enterprises having EM Part-II (Optional)/ Udyog Aadhaar Memorandum (UAM) are eligible for registration with NSIC under its Single Point Registration Scheme (SPRS).
- Micro & Small Enterprises who have already commenced their commercial production but not completed one year of existence.

How to Apply

- Micro & Small Enterprises may fill up 'Point of Interest' form available at website: www.nsicspronline.com or on the prescribed application form (in duplicate) either to be downloaded from website or avail from NSIC offices along-with requisite fee and documents to the Zonal/Branch/Sub Branch and Sub-office/Extension office of NSIC situated nearest to their location.
- Duplicate copy of the G.P. Registration Application Form submitted by the Micro & Small Enterprise will be forwarded to the concerned Inspecting agency along with copies of required documents and requisite Proof of inspection charges remitted in favor of concerned Inspection Agency requesting for carrying out the Technical Inspection of Micro & Small Enterprise and forward their recommendations in this regard.
- After receiving Inspection Report, NSIC will issue the SPRS Registration Certificate to Micro & Small Enterprise for items/stores as recommened.

Validity Period of Single Point Registration

1. The Registration Certificate granted to the Micro & Small Enterprise under Single Point Registration Scheme (Revised), 2003 is valid for Two Years and will be reviewed and renewed after every two years by verifying continuous Commercial and Technical Competence of the registered Micro & Small Enterprise in manufacturing / producing the stores for which it has been registered by NSIC.
2. The Provisional Registration Certificate can be issued to those Micro & Small Enterprises under Single Point Registration scheme with monitory limit of ₹ 5.00 Lacs which shall be valid for the period of one year who have already commenced their commercial production but not completed one year of existence.

EXTRA MURAL RESEARCH OR CORE RESEARCH GRANT SCHEME

Extra Mural Research (EMR) funding scheme of Science and Engineering Research Board (SERB) to academic institution, research laboratories and other R&D organizations to carry out basic research in all frontier areas of Science and Engineering is in limelight for more than four decades since from the inception of SERC. This scheme encourages emerging and eminent scientist in field of science and engineering for individual centric competitive mode of research funding. Since the scheme provides core research support to the active researchers, the existing name Extramural Research (EMR) has been renamed as Core Research Grant (CRG).

Objective

The scheme provides core research support to active researchers to undertake research and development in frontier areas of Science and Engineering.

Eligibility

- Applicants [Principal Investigator (PI) and Co Principal Investigator (s) (Co-PI(s))] should be Indian citizens. Foreign nationals (including OCI and NRI) are also eligible to apply provided they fulfil the eligibility criteria notified by SERB (SERB Funding Guidelines for foreign nationals dated 27th Oct 2016).
- The applicant(s) must hold a regular academic/research position in a recognized academic institution or national laboratory or in any other recognized R & D institution in India.
- Faculties recruited through UGC-Faculty Recharge Program are eligible to apply.
- INSPIRE Faculty, Ramanujan and Ramalingaswamy Fellows are also eligible to apply provided they have at least three and half years of tenure remaining at the time of submission of application.
- Investigators who will be superannuating during the duration of the project or already superannuated are also eligible to apply. In such cases, a Faculty/Scientist from the host institute who has at least 5 years of service remaining should be associated as a Co-PI. The host institution should allow the investigator to continue after superannuation and provide required support towards implementation of the project.

- Aspirants of NPDF, ECRA and CRG (EMR) can submit their proposal only once in a calendar year in any one of these schemes.
- The PI and Co-Investigator(s) should hold Ph.D. degree in Science, Mathematics, Engineering or M.D / M.S. / M.D.S. / M.V.Sc degree at the time of applying for grant.
- The term "Regular" in the context of CRG refers to the applicants who are appointed against the sanctioned post or in a tenure post, but are likely to be renewed after the end of the tenure.

Nature and Duration of Support

- The CRG scheme provides research support to an individual researcher or a group of researchers working in a recognized academic institution or national laboratory or in other recognized R & D institution in India.
- [Private Academic institutions with valid UGC/AICTE/PCI approval, Private R&D Institutions with valid DSIR-SIRO recognition and Voluntary and Non-Governmental Organizations registered under NITI-AAYOG Darpan portal are eligible to host a project.]
- The funding is provided normally for a period of three years.
- The research grant is provided for equipment, manpower, consumables, travel and contingency. "Overheads"is also be provided to the implementing institution as per prevailing norms of SERB.

Mode &Selection of Application

The Call for applications will be made twice a year (July and December) and will be notified through the website www.serbonline.in and www.serb.gov.in. The application form along with a proper research proposal highlighting the research work to be undertaken should be submitted online through the website www.serbonline.in.

PM SVANidhi

The PM Street Vendor's AtmaNirbhar Nidhi (PM SVANidhi) was launched by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs on June 01, 2020 for providing affordable Working Capital loan to street vendors to resume their livelihoodsthat have been adversely affected due to Covid-19 lockdown.

The duration of the scheme is until March 2022.

Target Beneficiaries

- This scheme targets to benefit over 50 lakh Street Vendors.
- A vendor, according to the scheme guidelines is any person engaged in vending of articles, goods, wares, food items or merchandise of daily use or offering services to the public in a street, footpath, pavement etc., from a temporary built up structure or by moving from place to place. The goods supplied by them include vegetables, fruits, ready-to-eat street food, tea, pakodas, breads, eggs, textile, apparel, artisan products, books/ stationary etc. and the services include barber shops, cobblers, pan shops, laundry services etc.

To avail the loan, a vendor should

- Possess Certificate of Vending / Identity Card issued by Urban Local Bodies (ULBs);
- The vendors, who have been identified in the survey of street vendors but have not been issued Certificate of Vending / Identity Card;
- In case a vendor is left out of the survey, he/she need to produce one of the following documents to obtain the Letter of Recommendation (LoR) from Urban Local Bodies /TVC:
  - ❖ Documents of past loan taken from a bank/ NBFC/ MFI for the purpose of vending; or
  - ❖ Membership details, If member of street vendors' association like NASVI, NHF, SEWA etc.; or
  - ❖ Any other documents to prove that she/he is a vendor;
  - ❖ The vendor can also request ULB through a simple application on white paper to conduct local enquiry to ascertain the genuineness of his/her claim for receipt of LoR.
- KYC document needed : Aadhaar Card / Voter's Identity Card / Driving Licence / MNREGA Card / PAN Card.

Scheme Benefits

- Vendors can avail a working capital loan of up to Rs. 10,000, which is repayable in monthly instalments in the tenure of one year.
- On timely/ early repayment of the loan, an interest subsidy @ 7% per annum will be credited to the bank accounts of beneficiaries through Direct Benefit Transfer on quarterly basis.
- There will be no penalty on early repayment of loan.
- The scheme promotes digital transactions through cash back incentives up to an amount of Rs. 100 per month.
- The vendors can avail the facility of escalation of the credit limit on timely/ early repayment of loan.

5 Sector-Wise Recent Schemes Launched by Government: Agriculture and Irrigation

AGRICULTURE AND FARMERS' WELFARE

New Initiatives and Challenges

- The union government has taken a number of initiatives in the area of agricultural development and farmers' welfare to boost the productivity and raise income of the farmers in the country.
- These initiatives may be seen in the background of low agricultural growth, a fallout of two consecutive drought years. It is also evident from the facts and figures released by Central Statistical Office (CSO) which show that the agricultural growth rate is plummeting, causing much concern among policy makers.
- The new initiatives taken by the government are aimed at correcting this distortion. Finance minister in his budget speech stressed that there is a need to think beyond 'food security' and give farmers a sense of 'income security'.
- In order to achieve it, government is reorienting its interventions in the farm and non-farm sectors to double the farmers' income by 2022. To achieve this, total allocation for agriculture and farmers' welfare were raised to ₹ 35,984 crore. The new initiatives taken by the present government have been designed to economize the inputs for getting more production from less.

Redefining Agricultural Growth and Its Challenges

- Indian agriculture has come a long way since independence, with chronic food scarcity giving way to grain self-sufficiency despite a two and a half fold increase in population.
- Although agriculture share in the GDP is about one-fifth, agriculture and allied activities remain the major sources of livelihood for about half of the population.

- The government policies for the last two years from launching of different farm centric programmes to enhanced allocations under different agriculture-related schemes reaffirm the commitment work under the form sector.

Some Highlights

- Despite the increase in number and coverage of financial institutions in the country, the truth is that most of the farming community is still outside the framework of these institutions. In the budget 2017–2018, the fiscal allocation increased to ₹ 10 lakh crores for the settlement of farming community.
- To ensure the flow of credit to small farmers, government to support NABARD for computerization and integration of all the functional Primary Agricultural Credit Societies (PACS) with core banking system of district co-operative banks. This will ensure the seamless flow of credit to small and marginal farmers.
- The farmers should feel secure against the natural calamities at the time of sowing. The Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY) is a step in that direction. The target of 50% from 30% coverage aims to bring more farmers under safety net.
- The new budget has made a provision of soil testing mini labs in all Krishi Vigyan Kendras across the country. Farmers will get their soils tested by these centres which are run by rural entrepreneurs, with the assistance of the government.
- The increased allocation of up to ₹ 40,000 crores to the already established long-term irrigation fund and the 5,000 crores to the micro irrigation fund will help to achieve the goal of 'Per crop more drop'.
- The coverage of National Agricultural Market (e-NAM) to be expanded from 250 marks to 585 APMCs. Assistance up to ₹ 75 lakhs will be provided to every e-NAM market for establishment of cleaning, grading and packaging facilities. This will lead to value addition of farmer's produce.

Reforms

- Market reforms will be undertaken to denotify the perishables from APMCs and allow farmers to sell such items directly to consumers to get better prices.

- A proposal was made in the budget to integrate farmers who grow fruits and vegetables with agro processing units for better price realization and reduction of post-harvest losses.
- NITI AAYOG recommended for enacting a model law on contract farming on the pattern of Punjab. The government had made a draft and will send it to various state governments for the opinion before making into a final act.
- Dairy and Infrastructure Development fund under NABARD with ₹ 8000 crores for the next three years has been set up. This will create an additional milk processing capacity and additional income to farmers.
- The increased allocation of funds under MGNREGA which is about ₹ 48,000 crores is the highest allocation ever made. This provides a great thrust to rural India.

Challenges

- Small size of land reduces the farmer's ability to invest in lumpy inputs, or gain from economies of scale and favourable agribusiness opportunities or have the necessary bargaining power in markets and service agencies.
- Many face insecurity of tenure and the growing threat of land alienation and pressures from urbanization, industrialization and powerful interests.
- They often lack access to sufficient productive resources, such as land, water, fertilizers and seeds as well as to markets information and technology.
- Problem of lack of timely access to credit from formal institutional sources, small holdings needs credit for both consumption and investment purposes.
- Low level of formal education limits public dissemination of knowledge and information on agriculture. This can further result into lack of training and capacity building to acquire and adequate skills.

PARAMPARAGAT KRISHI VIKAS YOJANA

- The Paramparagat Krishi Vikas Yojana (PKVY) is a new scheme to develop organic clusters and make available chemical free inputs to farmers, and to improve soil health in the fields, with an outlay

of ₹ 300 crore. It has open a new era for organic production system by allocating separate funds for this purpose. The PKVY will be implemented through the state governments.

- It is proposed under the scheme that groups of 50 or more farmers, having 50 acre land, would be motivated to take up organic farming under PKVY. In the next three years, it plans to target 10,000 clusters covering 5 lakh acres. To make the scheme attractive for the farmers, it is designed to provide ₹ 20,000 per acre as subsidy to every farmer in the cluster for three years towards adoption of organic farming besides market assistance.
- It is interesting to note that a special scheme with an allocation of ₹ 125 crore has been launched in North Eastern Region for promotion of organic farming and export of organic produce.

PRADHAN MANTRI KRISHI SINCHAI YOJANA

The Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchai Yojana (PMKSY) has been launched to ensure the water security in the country with the aim of 'Har Khet Ko Paani' (water for each field). The scheme is based on three pronged strategy:

- Creating sources of assured irrigation
- Per drop-more crop
- Harnessing rain water at micro level through 'jalsanchay' and 'jalsinchan'

In this way, the scheme lays stress on end-to-end solutions in irrigation supply chain which includes water sources, distribution network and farm level applications. A total of ₹ 5,300 crore has been allocated for the year 2015–2016 to rollout the scheme.

NATIONAL AGRICULTURE MARKET

- The agricultural markets are fragmented not only among the states but even at inter-state level into different market areas, each governed by separate Marketing Committee.
- This poses the problems of requirement of multiple licenses for trading, levy of market fee at multiple points and other monopolistic and restrictive market practices. This not only hinders the proper market access by the farmers but also develops the required infrastructure for handling the produce in the markets.

- To overcome these problems of marketing the agricultural produce, the government has taken the initiative to set up a National Agriculture Market (NAM).
- For this purpose, the Department of Agriculture and Cooperation (DAC) is constantly in dialogue with states and UTs to carry out reforms in their Agri Market Laws.
- These reforms include doing away with the concept of market area and enforcing single license which is valid across the state, single point levy of market fee and electronic auction as a mode of price discovery.

HORTICULTURE: TOWARDS A SILENT REVOLUTION

Within the agriculture sector, the horticulture sector is widely recognized as the most rapidly growing sector. It has been rightly called as the silent revolution because of its varied achievements.

Milestones in Horticulture

- The fifth consecutive year horticultural production outstrips the food grains production is an evidence of structural changes in the agricultural sector.
- The overall share of the horticulture in the agriculture sector's gross domestic product has grown to over 30% even though it accounts for nearly 17% of the farmland.
- As per the consumption data from the National Sample Survey Organization (NSSO), consumption of vegetables per person increased from 2.7 kg in 1993–1994 to 4.3 kg in 2011–2012, and this growth is because of the increased production in spite of the surge in the population.
- The impact of irrigation better agronomic practices and improved varieties has been reflected very well in the robust growth of horticultural output which is estimated around 7% a year in the past decade.
- The acreage under horticulture has also grown by around 2% a year and dipped only marginally in bad monsoon years and the drought years.

Schemes for promotion of Horticulture

- National horticultural mission under Mission for Integrated Development of Horticulture (MIDH)
- Horticulture mission for north east and Himalayan states under Mission for Integrated Development of Horticulture (MIDH)
- Market Intervention Scheme (MIS)
- Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana
- Micro Irrigation Scheme

Challenges

- The lack of good planting materials like seeds and technologies hinders the production of this sector. For example, in India, the average mango production is 3–4 tonnes per acre as against 8–10 tonnes per acre in developed countries.
- As most of the horticultural products are perishable, the lack of suitable post-harvest technologies and value addition facilities at the grass root level de-incentivize the farming community to take horticulture as primary profession.
- Lack of regulated markets and multiplicity of intermediaries in marketing makes the price higher in the consumer end lower in the production end.
- Improper knowledge about the climate and irrigation facilities makes the production to fluctuate.

Way forward

- Provision of quality planting material to the growers will help in raising the yields. More produce will come with more income for farmers, and farmers will be motivated to grow more of these crops, ultimately reducing the pressure from the cereal crops.
- Expansion of fruits and vegetables processing industry with backward linkages with farmers can help in value addition and waste reduction.
- The financial interventions of the government like price stabilization fund will eliminate the unexpected shocks in the market.
- The national agricultural market which provides the farmers better prices for the crops must be strengthened and the perishables must be denotified to get high and remunerative prices.
- Drought prone and climate resilient plants must be developed and supplied to the farmers so that it will help to overcome the climate change and give good yields.

- The private sectors must be encouraged to set up more cold chain storages and post-harvest facilities on modern scientific lines to eliminate distress sales.
- Rejuvenation of old orchards is going on and it should be continued on the larger scale.
- Insurance against weather risks like hail storms and other natural calamities which result in fruit drop must be compensated with suitable subsidy, and MSP should be extended to the horticultural crops.

Doubling Farmers Income Through Horticulture

- In present times, India is at the highest rate of urbanization and there has been a continuous and sizeable shift from the primary sector to the industrial and services sector. As a result, the share of agriculture sector to India's GDP has been falling continuously.
- Over the years, horticulture has emerged as one of the potential agricultural enterprise in accelerating the growth of the economy. Its role in the country's nutritional security, poverty alleviation and employment generation programmes is becoming increasingly important.
- On account of significant production increases in horticultural crops across the country, a Golden Revolution is in the offing and India has emerged as a leading player in the global scenario.
- Therefore, there is a great scope for the horticulture industry to grow and flourish. Some of the major horticultural interventions are listed below which can help in the goal of doubling farmers income by 2022.
- Revisiting zones for different crops keeping into account the changing climate particularly in the hills.
- Ensuring availability of quality seed including hybrid of vegetables, flowers and planting material of fruit trees for better quality and produce.
- Diversification of horticultural crops along with other activities like bee keeping, mushroom cultivation, backyard poultry, seri culture, fish culture, etc.
- Post-harvest management of horticultural crops through grading, packaging, and on farm primary processing for value addition and product development.

- Introduction of potential new varieties and replacing the old and low productive varieties. Rejuvenation of old and unproductive orchards.
- Tree architecture management through training and pruning for enhanced quality and production of crops.
- Promotion of organic farming practices in vegetables and fruits production and suitable marketing must be done for the organic produce.
- Popularization of local/indigenous or underutilized horticultural crops and promoting cultivation of flowers and medicinal plants.
- Promoting intercropping with vegetables, flowers, medicinal and aromatic plants and short duration fruit crops.
- Adopting drip irrigation cum fertigation system of irrigation for more crop per drop. Weather forecasting advisory body to be popularized for strategic planning of cultural practices for minimizing losses.
- Promotion of contract farming and buy back arrangement for encouraging farmers to adopt horti-based farming.
- Promotion of horti-tourism in states like J&K, HP, Uttarakhand, and North Eastern states.

FLORICULTURE: POTENTIAL SOURCE OF FARMERS INCOME

- Floriculture or flower farming is the branch of horticulture that deals with the cultivation of flowering and ornamental plants for sales and for use as raw materials in cosmetic, perfume industry and in the pharmaceutical sector.
- Ancient literature such as Harsha Charita, Ramayana describes that India has a long history of use of flowering plants from eras on large scale in religious purposes, social ceremonies, for making surrounding peaceful and a place ideal for meditation.

Present Scenario

- Though, India dominates in terms of area under cultivation compares with some leading countries which are relatively prosperous in floriculture like the Netherlands, Colombia, yet India's per hectare yield is very low.
- Nearly 77% of the area under floricultural crops is concentrated in seven states comprising Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, West Bengal, Maharashtra, Haryana, UP and Delhi. Among these, Tamil Nadu ranks first in flower cultivation followed by Karnataka.

- India is enriched with diverse agro climatic conditions such as fertile lands, suitable climate, abundant water supply, low labour cost, availability of skilled manpower, and the recent investment climate by corporates, etc., which are the strengths of Indian floriculture Industry.
- As per the national horticultural database published by the National Horticulture Board, during the last two decades, the production of both the loose and cut flowers has been growing at a Compound Annual Growing Rate (CAGR) of 9.92 and 26.66%, respectively.
- The Indian floriculture industry is facing number of challenges mainly associated to trade environment, infrastructure and marketing issues such as high import tariff, low availability of perishable carriers, higher freight rates and inadequate refrigerated and transport facilities.
- At the production level, the industry faces challenges mostly related to availability of basic inputs including good quality seeds and planting materials, efficient irrigation system and skilled manpower.

Enhancing Farmer's Income

- Floriculture is an age old farming activity in India and has emerged as an important agribusiness with immense potential for generating employment and entrepreneurship among small and marginal farmers in both urban and rural areas.
- In present times, the increasing demand for cut flowers, protected cultivation in green houses is the best alternative for using land and other resources efficiently because it provides favourable conditions for growth which provides quality products.
- Floriculture activity has also evolved as a viable and profitable alternative for income generation and empowerment, helping in sustainable livelihood of farmers in changing climate by using every inch of land for raising the flower and foliage crops.
- Government initiated many schemes for the promotion of the horticulture sector, and NABARD provides the credit facilities also to promote the methods of protected cultivation and precision farming.
- Various training-related programmes are introduced by the government for farmers and entrepreneurs and also offer a range of concession on seeds, planting materials, various types of equipment and air freight for export.

Initiatives for Horticulture Promotion in India

- The horticulture sector has been an engine of growth for the rural economy while providing food and nutritional security to the people. Implementation of the centrally sponsored and central sector schemes has provided necessary stimulus to the horticulture sector, which has enabled the achievement of a healthy growth rate in the sector.
- Mission for Integrated Development of Horticulture (MIDH) has been launched for the holistic development of horticulture in the country since 2014–2015. It subsumed six ongoing schemes of the Department of Agriculture and cooperation on horticulture development. Out of these six schemes, three are centrally sponsored schemes:
  - ❖ National Horticultural Mission
  - ❖ Horticulture Mission for North East and Himalayas
  - ❖ National Bamboo Mission and the three Central sector schemes are
  - ❖ National Horticulture Board
  - ❖ Coconut Development Board
  - ❖ Central Institute of Horticulture, Nagaland

NATIONAL HORTICULTURE MISSION (NHM)

- National Horticulture Mission (NHM) is one of the sub schemes of MIDH which is being implemented by State Horticulture Missions (SHM) in selected districts of 18 states and four UTs.
- NHM was launched in 2005–2006 as centrally sponsored scheme to enhance the horticulture production and improve nutritional security and income support to farm households and others. It adopts area-based regionally differentiated strategies.

National Horticulture Mission for North East and Himalayan States (HMNEH)

- Horticulture Mission for North East and Himalayan States (HMNEH) is one of the sub schemes of MIDH which is being implemented by SHM in the North Eastern States and Himalayan States.
- The mission covers all North Eastern states including Sikkim and three Himalayan states of Jammu and Kashmir, Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand. These states have rich bio diversity and hold immense potential for horticulture. So in a view to improve livelihood of these people, this scheme is launched in 2001–2002.

- The NER is known for minimum usage of chemical fertilizers and pesticides. This is proposed to be converted into a strength through appropriate technology-based development and adoption of organic management of horticultural development activities supported by this mission.

National Horticulture Board (NHB)

- National Horticulture Board (NHB) was set up by Government of India in April 1984 on the basis of recommendations of the 'Group on Perishable Agricultural Commodities', headed by Dr. M. S. Swaminathan, the then Member (Agriculture), Planning Commission, Government of India. The NHB is registered as a Society under the Societies Registration Act, 1860, with its headquarters at Gurgaon.
- The main objectives of the NHB are to improve integrated development of Horticulture industry and to help in coordinating, sustaining the production and processing of fruits and vegetables.

Coconut Development Board (CDB)

- Coconut Development Board (CDB) is a statutory body established in 1981 under the Ministry of Agriculture, Government of India, for the integrated development of coconut cultivation and industry in the country with focus on productivity increase and product diversification.
- It has headquarters at Kochi in Kerala and Regional Offices at Bangalore in Karnataka, Chennai in Tamil Nadu and Guwahati in Assam. There are six state centres situated at Bhubaneswar in Odisha, Calcutta in West Bengal, Patna in Bihar, Thane in Maharashtra, Hyderabad in Andhra Pradesh and Port Blair in the Union Territory of Andaman & Nicobar Islands. The board has nine Demonstration cum Seed Production (DSP) Farms in different locations of the country and now seven farms are maintained.

Central Institute for Horticulture (CIH)

- Central Institute for Horticulture (CIH) was established at Medizipehima, Nagaland, in 2006–2007 with an ambitious objective of providing technical back stopping through capacity building and training of farmers and field functionaries in the North Eastern Region.

- CIH is now one of the sub schemes of MIDH. However, CIH is not implementing any schemes directly.

Strengthening of Research

- Government initiated the process to establish two new agriculture universities in Andhra Pradesh and Rajasthan, and two new horticulture universities in Telangana and Haryana with initial budget of ₹ 200 crore.
- In order to give thrust to biotechnology in agriculture, Indian Institute of Agricultural Biotechnology is being established in Ranchi. National Research Centre on Integrated Farming System is to be established in Bihar.
- National institute of High Security Animal Diseases has been established at Bhopal to address the emergence of exotic and trans-boundary animal and zoonotic diseases. Similarly, National Institute of Veterinary Epidemiology and Disease informatics has been established in Bengaluru to study the changing pattern of emerging and re-emerging animal diseases.
- The performance of Krishi Vigyan Kendras (KVKs) has been examined by a high-level committee with a view to make them more relevant and progressive for agricultural development.
- The recommendations of the Committee include – upgradation of facilities such as soil testing, integrated farming system, improved seed production and processing, water harvesting and microirrigation, ensuring availability of electrical/solar power backup, regular and systematic monitoring and third-party evaluation. Action has been initiated to implement the recommendations of the committee.
- Five new KVKs were opened in Baksa, Morigaon and Bongaigaon in Assam, Raigarh in Jharkhand and Banaskantha in Gujarat. Each KVK will organize pre-Kharif and pre-Rabi Kisan Sammelan with the consent and participation of local member of Parliament.

It is well known that the indigenous bovine breeds of India are robust and possess the genetic potential to play an important role in the economy. However, in the absence of a specific programme for development and conservation of indigenous breeds, their potentials have also not been optimally utilized and their population has been declining.

NATIONAL GOKUL MISSION

In view of the above, National Gokul Mission, a new initiatives under 'National Programme for Bovine Breeding and Dairy Development' (NPBBDD) has been launched to conserve and develop indigenous bovine breeds in a focused and scientific manner with an outlay of ₹ 500 crore. For this purpose, integrated cattle development centres named as 'Gokul Grams' will be developed. The Gokul Grams will be established in the native breeding tracks and near metropolitan cites for housing the urbancattle. Gokul Grams which will act as centre for development of indigenous breeds and a dependable source for supply of high genetic breeding stock. Under the scheme, 25 projects from 24 states have been approved.

ATAL PENSION YOJANA (APY)

Under Atal Pension Yojana (APY), farmers who have opened their bank account under the Jan Dhan Yojana can get benefits of monthly pension. Salient features of the APY are given below:

- The scheme is applicable for citizens between the age group of 18 and 40 years.
- The Government of India will pay 50% of the premium subject to an upper limit of ₹ 1,000 per year, and remaining 50% would be borne by the farmer.
- On attaining the age of 60 years, the beneficiary farmers would get a monthly· pension ranging from ₹ 1,000 to ₹ 5000, depending upon their contributions.
- In order to get monthly pension between ₹ 1,000 and ₹ 5,000 per month, the subscriber has to contribute on monthly basis between ₹ 42 and ₹ 210, if he or she joins at the age of 18 years. For the same fixed pension levels, the contribution would range between ₹ 291and ₹ 1,454 if the subscriber joins at the age of 40 years.

PRADHAN MANTRI FASAL BIMA YOJANA (PMFBY)

A new crop insurance scheme named as Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY) has been launched from Kharif-2016 season in place of existing National Crop Insurance Scheme, which had some shortcomings like high premium for the farmers, reduced claims due to capping in premium, delay in payment of claims, its complex provisions, etc. Main features of PMFBY are as follow:

- The maximum limit of the farmers' share of premium as token premium is capped at 2% for kharif crops, 1.5% for Rabi crops and 5% for annual commercial/horticultural crops. Remaining amount will be borne by the Government
- Uniform premium for the crop in the country against the earlier different premium in different districts
- Claims on full sum insured
- Enhanced coverage of riskscoverage of additional risks of inundation risks, risks of post-harvest losses
- Target to double the agri insurance coverage in 2–3 years from the present 23% to 50%. Special attention on non-loanee farmers
- Localized assessment at individual farm from area approach
- Provision for assessment of loss at individual farm level on account of losses due to hailstorm, landslide, inundation, cyclone or cyclonic rain and unseasonal rains after harvesting
- Use of technology like mobile, satellite, etc., in the accurate assessment of loss and early payment

Two-third of our population depends on agriculture directly or indirectly for their livelihoods and thus agriculture and farmers form the backbone of our economy. Strengthening this backbone is the ultimate objective of new initiatives of the government. The deceleration in the agriculture growth rate is mainly due to three reasons:

1. inputs intensive farming like water and fertilizers
2. lack of infrastructural investment and
3. lack of unified market

The new initiatives by the government aim to redress above problems. But, there are some challenges in achieving these objectives, which have been mentioned as follows.

Challenges

- There were initial reactions that budget allocation under agriculture and farmers' welfare was increased. But this was not the fact because increase in agriculture budget was more an account adjustment of funds.
- Another challenge is that the centrally sponsored schemes are to be financed as per the re-structured way where, the state governments would be more involved in implementation of the schemes.

- The centralized approach adopted in the implementation of the schemes of agricultural production, insurance, irrigation in a country which is heterogeneous and different in agro-climatic zones, may be a challenge.
- The benefits of various initiatives in the form of credit, direct benefit transfer, insurance,etc., is dependent on the tenancy reforms and modernization of land records as commented by the Niti Aayog. Because at present, the benefits of various schemes are going to the owners of the landholdings and not to the operators (tenants) of the landholding. In fact, the operators are bearing risks and reward is enjoyed by the owner of the holdings. It gives disincentive to de facto farmers.
- The benefits under various insurance schemes are useful for farming community, as they reduce the risk in undertaking various agricultural activities. But that is only possible if the farmers have their accounts in banks as well as operating them regularly.

Agricultural research is very important for the success of lab-to-land programme in the countryside. In this sector, situation is as commented by the Economic Survey 2015–2016, 'In more recent years, however, agricultural research has been plagued by severe under investment and neglect'. During 12th Five Year Plan, the entire budget allocation in different years for the education and extension has not been spent by the Indian Council of Agricultural Research.

Given the significance of agriculture sector in the economy and society, the Government of India has initiated several steps for its sustainable development and to enhance the income of the farmers in the country by way of improving soil fertility, improved access efficiency of irrigation, insurance cover to farmers and unified national agriculture market. Different stockholders have to be involved to put these initiatives into action in a sustainable mode. The challenges mentioned in this paper may be addressed so that the expectations of the people may be fulfilled.

KRISHI AMDANI BEEMA YOJANA

- To give an impetus to the dying agricultural practice.
- There are 14 crore hectares of agricultural land in India, of which only 44% is under irrigation.
- Pradhan Mantri Gram Sinchai Yojana would be introduced so that more agricultural land is irrigated.

- Talking about the plight of small and marginal farmers, he said that most of them were leaving the agricultural practice because of the uncertainty over the produce and returns.
- The farmers don't bear any financial burden if their produce gets destroyed due to unexpected weather or for any other reason.

PRADHAN MANTRI GRAM SINCHAI YOJANA

- Ensure water supply to farmers round the year.
- Basic contours of the agri-irrigation programme would be on lines of the PMGSY, under which each irrigation project would be selected for releasing funds by the state government after seeking nod of the concerned Zilla Parishad.
- Importance in the wake of poor implementation of various irrigation projects in some states despite release of central funds by different ministries under various schemes for several years.
- Besides, water is necessary for farmers as country's 50% of the agriculture land is rainfed.

PRADHAN MANTRI SANSAD ADARSH GRAM YOJANA

- The Sansad Adarsh Gram Yojana was launched for the development of model villages. Under the Yojana, Members of Parliament (MPs) will be responsible for developing the socio-economic and physical infrastructure of three villages each by 2019, and a total of eight villages each by 2024.
- The first Adarsh Gram must be developed by 2016, and two more by 2019. From 2019 to 2024, five more Adarsh Grams must be developed by each MP, one each year. This implies that a total of 6,433 Adarsh Grams, of the 2,65,000 Gram Panchayats, will be created by 2024.

Objectives

- The development of model villages, called Adarsh Grams, through the implementation of existing schemes, and certain new initiatives to be designed for the local context, which may vary from village to village.
- Creating models of local development which can be replicated in other villages.

Identification of villages

- MPs can select any gram panchayat, other than their own village or that of their spouse, to be developed as an Adarsh Gram. The village must have a population of 3,000–5,000 people if it is located in the plains, or 1,000–3,000 people if located in hilly areas.
- Lok Sabha MPs can choose a village from their constituency, and Rajya Sabha MPs from the state from which they are elected. Nominated members can choose a village from any district of the country. MPs which represent urban constituencies can identify a village from a neighbouring rural constituency.

SOIL HEALTH CARD SCHEME FOR EVERY FARMER

Farming as an activity contributes nearly 1/6th of our Gross Domestic Product and a majority of our population is dependent on it for their livelihood. Deteriorating soil health has been a cause of concern and that has been leading to sub optimal utilization of farming resources. Imbalanced use of fertilizers, low addition of organic matter and non-replacement of depleted micro and secondary nutrients over the years has resulted in nutrient deficiencies and decrease in soil fertility in some parts of the country.

Key facts

- Soil health needs to be assessed at regular intervals so as to ensure that farmers apply the required nutrients while taking advantages of the nutrients already present in the soil.
- Government has launched a scheme to provide every farmer a Soil Health Card in a Mission mode. The card will carry crop-wise recommendations of nutrients/fertilizers required for farms, making it possible for farmers to improve productivity by using appropriate inputs.
- Central government provides assistance to state governments for setting up Soil Testing Laboratories for issuing Soil Health Cards to farmers. State governments have adopted innovative practices like involvement of agricultural students, NGOs and private sector in soil testing, determining average soil health of villages, etc., to issue Soil Health Cards.

- A Soil Health Card is used to assess the current status of soil health and, when used over time, to determine changes in soil health that are affected by land management. A Soil Health Card displays soil health indicators and associated descriptive terms. The indicators are typically based on farmers' practical experience and knowledge of local natural resources. The card lists soil health indicators that can be assessed without the aid of technical or laboratory equipment.

Benefits

- The scheme will provide all 145 million farm owners in the country with a Soil Health Card in the next three years.
- The budget is allotted as ₹ 100 crore for issuing cards and an additional ₹ 56 crore to set up 100 mobile soil testing laboratories across the country.
- The Soil Health Card details existing nutrient status of the soil and crop-wise recommendations of nutrients and fertilizers required, making it easier for farmers to improve productivity by using appropriate inputs.
- 'Applying fertilizer, best quality seeds and ample water is not enough. Farmers should nurture their soil and know what inputs to use and in what quantities', Modi said while launching the scheme. 'Starting soil health laboratories could be an employment avenue for rural youth. In Gujarat where every farmer has a Soil Health Card, unnecessary expenses on inputs have come down and farmers have saved a lot of money'.
- The agriculture ministry released ₹ 86 crore for the Soil Health Card scheme. In comparison, between 2007–2008 and April 2014, the ministry had spent ₹ 112 crore on the scheme. The flagship scheme of the ministry has been sanctioned ₹ 568 crore for the next three years.
- Imbalanced use of fertilizer has led to declining crop productivity in the country, further fuelled by a skewed fertilizer policy where urea is heavily subsided, leading to overuse.
- While urea consumption increased from 59 to 66% of total consumption in 2012–2013 over 2010–2011, per hectare consumption of fertilizer declined from 140 to 128 kg over the same period.

GREEN REVOLUTION KRISHONNATI YOJANA

Launched: 2005

11 Schemes Clubbed: 2017-18

Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) has approved continuation of Umbrella Scheme, Green Revolution – Krishonnati Yojana in agriculture sector beyond 12th Five Year Plan from 2017-18 to 2019-20.

Features

- The government of India introduced the green revolution Krishonnati Yojana in 2005 to boost the agriculture sector.
- The 11 schemes and missions were clubbed together under one umbrella scheme 'Green Revolution – Krishonnati Yojana in 2017-18.
- Government through the scheme plans to develop the agriculture and allied sector in a holistic & scientific manner to increase the income of farmer.
- The scheme looks to enhance agricultural production, productivity and better returns on produce.

It Comprises of 11 Schemes and Mission Under a Single Umbrella Scheme

1. **Mission for Integrated Development of Horticulture (MIDH)**: It aims to promote holistic growth of horticulture sector; to enhance horticulture production, improve nutritional security and income support to farm Households.
2. **National Food Security Mission (NFSM)**
   - ❖ It aims to increase production of rice, wheat, pulses, coarse cereals and commercial crops, through area expansion and productivity enhancement.
   - ❖ It will work toward restoring soil fertility and productivity at the individual farm level and enhancing farm level economy.
   - ❖ It further aims to augment the availability of vegetable oils and to reduce the import of edible oils.
3. **National Mission for Sustainable Agriculture (NMSA)**: NMSA aims at promoting sustainable agriculture practices best suitable to the specific agro-ecology focusing on integrated farming, appropriate soil health management and synergizing resource conservation technology.

4. **Submission on Agriculture Extension (SMAE)**
   - ❖ SMAE aims at achieving food and nutritional security and socio-economic empowerment of farmers.
   - ❖ To forge effective linkages and synergy amongst various stake-holders and to promote pervasive and innovative use of electronic/print media, inter-personal communication and ICT tools, etc.
5. **Sub-Mission on Seeds and Planting Material (SMSP)**
   - ❖ SMSP aims to increase production of certified/quality seed
   - ❖ Strengthen the seed multiplication chain and modernizing infrastructure for seed production, storage, certification and quality etc.
   - ❖ Promoting new technologies and methodologies in seed production, processing, testing etc.
6. **Sub-Mission on Agricultural Mechanization (SMAM)**
   - ❖ SMAM aims to increase the reach of farm mechanization to small and marginal farmers and to the regions where availability of farm power is low.
   - ❖ It will promote 'Custom Hiring Centers' to offset the adverse economies of scale arising due to small landholding and high cost of individual ownership.
   - ❖ It will create hubs for hi-tech and high value farm equipment and create awareness among stakeholders through demonstration and capacity building activities.
7. **Sub-Mission on Plant Protection and Plan Quarantine (SMPPQ)**
   - ❖ SMPPQ aims to minimize loss to quality and yield of agricultural crops from the ravages of insect pests, diseases, weeds, nematodes, rodents, etc.
   - ❖ It will ensure agricultural bio-security from the incursions and spread of alien species facilitating exports of Indian agricultural commodities to global markets.
   - ❖ Promote good agricultural practices, particularly with respect to plant protection strategies and strategies.
8. **Integrated Scheme on Agriculture Census, Economics and Statistics (ISACES)**
   - ❖ It aims to undertake the agriculture census, study of the cost of cultivation of principal crops, to undertake research studies on agro-economic problems of the country.

- It seeks to improve agricultural statistics methodology and create a hierarchical information system on crop condition and crop production from sowing to harvest.

9. Integrated Scheme on Agricultural Cooperation (ISAC)

- It aims to provide financial assistance for improving the economic conditions of cooperatives, remove regional imbalances and to speed up cooperative development.
- The scheme will particularly help cotton growers fetch remunerative price for their produce through value addition besides ensuring supply of quality yarn at reasonable rates to the decentralized weavers.

10. Integrated Scheme on Agricultural Marketing (ISAM)

- ISAM aims to develop agricultural marketing infrastructure;
- Promote innovative and latest technologies and competitive alternatives in agriculture marketing infrastructure.
- Provide infrastructure facilities for grading, standardization and quality certification of agricultural produce.
- It aims to establish a nationwide marketing information network and integrate markets through a common online market platform to facilitate pan-India trade in agricultural commodities, etc.

11. National e-Governance Plan in Agriculture (NeGP-A)

- It aims to bring farmer centricity & service orientation to the programs.
- Improving access of farmers to information & services throughout crop-cycle.
- It looks to enhance efficiency & effectiveness of programs by giving timely and relevant information to the farmers for increasing their agriculture productivity.

Benefits of the Scheme

- The scheme will help achieve food security in the nation by providing impetus to the production of rice, wheat, pulses and coarse grains.
- It will help in identifying the best sustainable agricultural practices most suitable to specific agro-ecological climate focusing on integrated farming.
- The scheme through its various missions will help realize the government's vision of doubling farmer's income by 2022.

- Agrarian infrastructure like warehousing facilities, storehouses, watershed development, rural electrification, roads, markets etc will get a push through the scheme.

Challenges in the Scheme

- Affordability of technology remains a huge constraint due to small and marginal landholding amongst the farmers.
- Agriculture research in the country remains skewed due to inadequate resources, multiple regulations and Intellectual Property Rights (IPR).
- Lack of non-farms employment opportunities has resulted in excessive dependence on agriculture.
- Inability to acquire land for setting up markets remains a huge challenge due to restrictions on land leasing and land acquisition.

Way Forward

- There is a need for progressive agricultural marketing reforms such as setting up of markets in the private sector, farmer-consumer markets, e-trading, etc.
- Government of India should come up with a coherent and stable agricultural export policy, ideally with a five to ten-year time horizon.
- Several breakthroughs have potential for quickly doubling farmers' income such as ZBNF (Zero Budget Natural Farming), herbal inputs that improve soil quality and make plants more pest resistant, etc.

  India needs to accelerate growth in the manufacturing, services and exports sectors to wean labour away from agriculture resulting in higher productivity and income for farmer.

PRADHAN MANTRI KISAN SAMMAN NIDHI/ PM KISAN SCHEME

Launched: 01.12.2018

The Government with a view to augment the income of the farm families is implementing a Central Sector Scheme, namely,"Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi (PM-KISAN)". The Scheme is in effect from 01.12.2018.

Objective

With a view to provide income support to all land holding eligible farmer families, the Government has launched PM-KISAN. The scheme aims to supplement the financial needs of the farmers in procuring various inputs to ensure proper crop health and appropriate yields, commensurate with the anticipated farm income.

Benefits and Eligibility conditions

All land holding eligible farmer families (subject to the prevalent exclusion criteria) are to avail of the benefits under this scheme, as per the recent cabinet decision taken during May 2019. The revised Scheme is expected to cover around 2 crore more farmers, increasing the coverage of PM-KISAN to around 14.5 crore beneficiaries, with an estimated expenditure by Central Government of ₹ 87,217.50 crores for year 2019-20.

Earlier, under the scheme, financial benefit has been provided to all Small and Marginal landholder farmer families with total cultivable holding upto 2 hectares with a benefit of ₹ 6000 per annum per family payable in three equal installments, every four months.

Exclusion Categories

The following categories of beneficiaries of higher economic status shall not be eligible for benefit under the scheme:

- All Institutional Land holders.
- Farmer families in which one or more of its members belong to following categories
  - ❖ Former and present holders of constitutional posts
  - ❖ Former and present Ministers/ State Ministers and former/ present Members of LokSabha/ RajyaSabha/ State Legislative Assemblies/ State Legislative Councils,former and present Mayors of Municipal Corporations, former and present Chairpersons of District Panchayats.
  - ❖ All serving or retired officers and employees of Central/ State Government Ministries /Offices/Departments and its field units Central or State PSEs and Attached offices /Autonomous

Institutions under Government as well as regular employees of the Local Bodies (Excluding Multi Tasking Staff /Class IV/Group D employees)

- All superannuated/retired pensioners whose monthly pension is ₹ 10,000/-or more (Excluding Multi Tasking Staff / Class IV/ Group D employees) of above category.
- All Persons who paid Income Tax in last assessment year
- Professionals like Doctors, Engineers, Lawyers, Chartered Accountants, and Architects registered with Professional bodies and carrying out profession by undertaking practices.

Details Required From the Beneficiary

The States shall prepare database of eligible beneficiary landholder farmer families in the villages capturing the Name, Age, Gender, Category(SC/ ST), Aadhaar Number (in case Aadhaar Number has not been issued then Aadhaar Enrollment Number together with any other prescribed documents for purposes of the identification such as Driving Licence, Voters' ID Card, NREGA Job Card, or any other identification documents issued by Central/State/UT Governments or their authorities,etc.), Bank Account Number and the Mobile Number of the beneficiaries.

In case of beneficiaries in States of Assam, Meghalaya, J&K where Aadhaar number has not been issued to most of the citizens, Aadhaar number shall be collected for those beneficiaries where it is available and for others alternate prescribed documents can be collected for identity verification purposes.

Responsibility of identifying the landholder farmer family eligible for benefit under the scheme shall be of the State/UT Government.

NEW PENSION SCHEME FOR FARMERS

Launched: 2019

Feature

This is a voluntary and contributory pension scheme for all Small and Marginal Farmers (SMF) across the country.

The entry age is 18 to 40 years with a provision of minimum fixed pension of ₹ 3,000/- on attaining the age of 60 years. For example, a beneficiary farmer is required to contribute ₹ 100/ - per month at median entry age of 29 years.

The Central Government shall also contribute to the Pension Fund an equal amount as contributed by the eligible farmer.

After the subscriber's death, while receiving pension, the spouse of the SMF beneficiary shall be entitled to receive 50% of the pension received by the beneficiary as family pension, provided he/she is not already an SMF beneficiary of the Scheme. If, the death of the subscriber happens during the period of contribution, the spouse shall have the option of continuing the Scheme by paying regular contribution.

An interesting feature of the Scheme is that the farmers can opt to allow his/her monthly contribution to the Scheme to be made from the benefits drawn from the Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi (PM-KISAN) Scheme directly. Alternatively, a farmer can pay his monthly contribution by registering through Common Service Centres (CSCs) under MeitY.

Benefit

The Union Cabinet has approved a new Central Sector Scheme. It is estimated that 5 crore small and marginal farmers will benefit in the first three years itself. The Central Government would spend ₹ 10774.50 crore for a period of 3 years towards its contribution (matching share) for providing social security cover as envisaged under the scheme.

PM KISAN MAAN DHAN YOJANA

Government has launched the Pradhan Mantri Kisan Maan DhanYojana (PM-KMY) on 12.9.2019 with a view to provide social security to Small and Marginal Farmers in their old age when they have no means of livelihood and minimal or no savings to take care of their expenses.

Benefits

- Under this scheme, a minimum fixed pension of ₹ 3,000/- is provided to the small and marginal farmers, subject to certain exclusion criteria, on attaining the age of 60 years.

- It is a voluntary and contributory pension scheme.
- The eligible farmer is required to contribute to a Pension Fund between ₹ 55 to ₹ 200 per month depending on the entry age.
- The Central Government also contributes in equal amount to the Pension Fund.

Eligibility

1. Small and Marginal Farmer (SMF) - a farmer who owns cultivable land up to 2 hectare as per land records of the concerned State/UT.
2. Age of 18- 40 years

Farmers who are not eligible for the scheme

The following categories of farmers have been brought under the exclusion criteria:

- SMFs covered under any other statuary social security schemes such as National Pension Scheme (NPS), Employees' State Insurance Corporation scheme, Employees' Fund Organization Scheme etc.
- Farmers who have opted for Pradhan Mantri Shram Yogi Maan Dhan Yojana (PM-SYM) administered by the Ministry of Labour & Employment
- Farmers who have opted for Pradhan Mantri Laghu Vyapari Maan-dhan Yojana (PM-LVM) administered by the Ministry of Labour & Employment
- Further peoples of higher economic status shall not be eligible for benefits under the scheme

NATIONAL SCHEME OF WELFARE OF FISHERMEN

Launched date : 09-05-2019

Brief Objective

- The Centrally Sponsored 'National Scheme of Welfare of Fishermen' envisaging to provide financial assistance to fishers for construction of house among other things.
- For housing, the State Governments may ensure equitable distribution of houses among all villages in proportion to the number of eligible

fishermen, as far as possible. The plinth area and cost of construction of a house would be limited to 35 Sq. mts and Rs 40,000/- respectively.

- The ceiling on land and cost of construction indicate the upper limit. The State Government may plan and ensure optimizing the use of available resources so that more number of houses could be built within the budgeted amount.

Benefits to the Citizens

- Fishermen who are in the marine and inland sector are entitled for the benefits under the scheme. Land for the development of these resources will be provided by the respective Union Territories (UTs) and States.
- Subject to the type of amenity that is being provided, the State and Central Government share the cost of providing these amenities.

Eligibility

The States should keep the following criteria in view while selecting beneficiaries for allotment of houses under the scheme:-

- The beneficiary should be an active fisherman identified by the State Government.
- Preference should be given to fishermen below poverty line and to landless fishermen.
- Fishermen owning land or kutcha structure may also be considered for allotment of houses under the scheme.

AGRICULTURE INFRASTRUCTURE FUND

The Union Cabinet in July 2020 has approved a new pan India Central Sector Scheme called Agriculture Infrastructure Fund. The scheme shall provide a medium - long term debt financing facility for investment in viable projects for post-harvest management Infrastructure and community farming assets through interest subvention and financial support.

The duration of the Scheme shall be from FY2020 to FY2029 (10 years).

Intended beneficiaries

Under the scheme, ₹ One Lakh Crore will be provided by banks and financial institutions as loans to Primary Agricultural Credit

Societies (PACS), Marketing Cooperative Societies, Farmer Producers Organizations (FPOs), Self Help Group (SHG), Farmers, Joint Liability Groups (JLG), Multipurpose Cooperative Societies, Agri-entrepreneurs, Startups, Aggregation Infrastructure Providers and Central/State agency or Local Body sponsored Public Private Partnership Project.

Benefits

- All loans under this financing facility will have interest subvention of 3% per annum up to a limit of ₹ 2 crore. This subvention will be available for a maximum period of seven years.
- Further, credit guarantee coverage will be available for eligible borrowers from this financing facility under Credit Guarantee Fund Trust for Micro and Small Enterprises (CGTMSE) scheme for a loan up to ₹ 2 crore. The fee for this coverage will be paid by the Government.
- In case of FPOs the credit guarantee may be availed from the facility created under FPO promotion scheme of Department of Agriculture, Cooperation & Farmers Welfare (DACFW).
- Moratorium for repayment under this financing facility may vary subject to minimum of 6 months and maximum of 2 years.

INTEREST SUBVENTION FOR DAIRY SECTOR

Objective of the Scheme

To offset the economic impact of Covid-19 on Dairy Sector, Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying has introduced a new scheme "Interest subvention on Working Capital Loans for Dairy sector" for Supporting Dairy Cooperatives and Farmer Producer Organizations engaged in dairy activities (SDC&FPO). The scheme will be implemented through National Dairy Development Board (NDDB), Anand

Period of Implementation

The scheme is to be implemented during 2020-21.

Eligible Beneficiaries

Dairy Cooperatives and Farmer owned milk producer companies

Benefits

In order to meet the working Capital needs of the Cooperatives and Farmer owned milk producer companies, Interest subvention will be given on working capital loan taken from scheduled Commercial Banks/ R.R.Bs/Cooperative Banks/Financial Institutions between 1st April 2020 and 31st March 2021 by Cooperatives/FPOs for conversion of milk into conserved commodities and other milk products.

The scheme has made provisions for providing interest subvention of 2% per annum, with an additional incentive of 2% per annum interest subvention to be given in case of prompt and timely repayment/interest servicing.

6 Sector-Wise Recent Schemes Launched by Government: Social Security Schemes

SOCIAL SECURITY FOR BETTER HEALTH

The recent budget aimed at overall development of the nation with focus on fulfilling the dreams of every section inducing the poor, the farmers and the under privileged.

Initiatives

- The increased allocation in PMFBY will support the farmers and cover that risk, for long they have been facing many adversities because of risks that were not covered.
- Participation of women in MGNREGA has increased to 55% and the increased allocation to ₹ 48,000 crore will empower more women.
- The increased allocation of funds for PMGSY will help in transport of farm produce to nodal villages. Infrastructure of storage, processing and distribution of produce can be developed along these roads to facilitate farmers.
- The Swachh Bharat mission coverage went up to 60% from 42%. This will save lot of funds, as the villages will be healthy and lesser medical expenditure is required.
- The proposed micro irrigation fund will promote micro irrigation, which will help in reducing depletion of water due to optimal use.
- NABARD being a specialized organization, which has the spread and know-how of ground level realities and needs has been given importance in this budget. This further strengthens the rural credit system.
- Government will set up minilabs in KVKs, which will have employment opportunities. Village level understanding of soil and research work will be an enabler to maximize from farms.
- The proposed dairy development fund will propel the dairy industry, and in turn, it will benefit the women as they are majority in tending to cattle in villages.

- The schemes like Janani Suraksha Yojana, National Rural Health mission, Janani Sishu Suraksha Konyakam, etc., have been addressed well in the budget and the outcomes of these schemes are also in the positive note.
- Agencies implementing health programmes must induce gram panchayats in planning and monitoring the implementation of all health-related programmes.
- More optimum utilization of the rural health infrastructure already created including human resource to yield expected results.
- Print and electronic media have a responsibility to identity the gaps in the successful implementation of the programmes in the rural areas.
- There should be continuous studies by independent accredited institutions to identify the factors inhibiting the progress in rural areas as compared to urban areas within the block, district and state.
- The elected state legislatures and parliamentarians must be involved in the half-yearly review of the progress of each health programme in their constituencies and necessary improvements must be made accordingly.

  Prime Minister Narendra Modi launched three ambitious social security schemes, relating to the insurance and pension sector and intended at widening the process of financial inclusion. The schemes –two insurance products and one pension product –are targeted especially to the unorganized sector and economically weaker population but others can enrolled themselves as well.

PRADHAN MANTRI JEEVAN JYOTI BIMA YOJANA

- The new life insurance plan will offer ₹ 2 lakh cover at ₹ 330 premium every year.
- Bank account holders in the age 18 to 50 years are eligible to take this facility.
- The life risk cover will get terminated after 55 years.

PRADHAN MANTRI SURAKSHA BIMA YOJANA

- It will offer a renewable one year accidental death cum disability cover of ₹ 2 lakh at ₹ 12 premium every year.
- The insured will get ₹ 1 lakh in case of partial permanent disability.
- Multiple bank account holders are eligible to join the schemes through any one of the savings accounts.

ATAL PENSION YOJANA

- The scheme is for the people in the unorganized sector who are outside a formal pension net so far.
- The pension scheme would allow subscribers of age 18 to 40.
- The government has promised to co-contribute 50% of total contribution or ₹ 1,000 per annum whichever is lower, for the first five years.
- Subscribers without any social security and who don't pay income tax will get this added benefit. However, people have to enrol themselves before 31 December 2015 to get government contribution.
- Under this scheme, subscriber will get guaranteed minimum pension from the age of 60. The pension could be ₹ 1,000, ₹ 2,000, ₹ 3,000, ₹ 4,000 or ₹ 5,000 per month, depending on the size of contribution.

NATIONAL HEALTH POLICY

Launched: 15 March 2017

Objective: To achieve universal health coverage and delivering quality healthcare services to all at affordable cost.

Features

This policy helps in problems and solutions with private sector as strategic partners.

It seeks to promote quality of care focus on emerging diseases and investment in promoting and preventing healthcare. The policy is patient centric and quality driven. It addresses issues on health security and makes in India for drugs and devices.

The main objective of the National Health Policy 2017 is to achieve the highest possible level of good health and well-being and to achieve universal access to good quality healthcare services without facing any financial hardship.

SWAVLAMBAN HEALTH INSURANCE SCHEME

About the Scheme

- Affordable health insurance scheme for disabled
- Provides comprehensive cover to beneficiary as well as his family (PwD, spouse and 2 children)

- Single premium across age band
- Availed by PWD aged between 18 and 65 years with family annual income of less than ₹ 3 lakh per annum
- MoU with New India Assurance Company to create network of hospitals where insured people can get cashless treatment.

Implementation body: Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment

CYBER SWACHHTA KENDRA

Launched: By the Minister of Electronics and Information Technology.

Objective: Creating a secure cyber space by detecting botnet infections in India.

Features

It is a Digital India initiative in creating a secure cyber space by detecting botnet infections in India and to enable cleaning and securing systems of end-users to prevent further infections.

The centre is operated by the Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT-In).The centre aims to enhance coordination between the government and industry in order to encourage cyber hygiene among all endusers and to create a secure and safe Internet in India.

Some of the tools released for citizens are as follows:

1. **USB Pratirodh:** A desktop security solution, which protects from USB mass storage device threats.
2. **AppSamvid:** A desktop security solution which protects systems by allowing installation of genuine applications through white listing. This helps in preventing threats from malicious applications.
3. **M-Kavach:** An indigenously developed solution to address the security threats in mobiles.

CREDIT GUARANTEE LIMIT FOR SMALL AND MEDIUM BUSINESSES

Launched: By Prime Minister Narendra Modi

Objective: To give a boost to the small entrepreneurs and job creation, the government today doubled the credit guarantee limit for small and medium businesses to ₹ 2 crore to help them over the liquidity problems.

Features

- The government has taken certain decisions in the interest rate of small and medium businesses which will also boost employment.
- Government underwrites loans given by banks to small businesses through a trust. So far, loans were covered up to ₹ 1crore. This limit is now being enhanced to ₹ 2 crore.
- Earlier, the scheme only covered bank loans. But now it will cover loans given by NBFCs (non-banking financial companies) as well.
- This will enable better access to credit for small shopowners and small enterprises, and the banks and NBFCs will not levy high interest on these loans, as the government is bearing the cost of underwriting them.

PRADHAN MANTRI GRAMIN DIGITAL SAKSHARTA ABHIYAN

Launched: By Finance Minister in the Union Budget 2016–2017

Objective: To make 6 crore rural households digitally literate. This project is ₹ 2,351.38 crore to use in digital literacy in rural India by March 2019.

Features

- PMGDISHA is expected to be one of the largest digital literacy programmes in the world. Under this scheme, 25 lakh candidates will be trained in the FY 2016–2017, 275 lakh in the FY 2017–2018 and 300 lakh in the FY 2018–2019. To ensure geographical reach, each of the 2,50,000 gram panchayats would be expected to register an average of 200–300 candidates.
- Digitally literate persons will be able to operate computers/digital access devices, send and receive emails, browse Internet, access government services, search for information, undertaking cashless transactions, etc., and use IT to actively participate in the process of nation building.
- The implementation of this scheme would be carried out under overall supervision of Ministry of Electronics and IT in active collaboration with states/UTs through their designated State Implementing Agencies, District e-Governance Society, etc.

VARISHTHA PENSION BIMA YOJANA

Launched: Prime Minister Narendra Modi has given its postfacto approval for launching of Varishtha Pension Bima Yojana 2017.

Objective: To provide social security during old age and protect elderly persons aged 60 years and above against a future fall in their interest income due to uncertain market conditions.

Features

- This scheme will provide an assured pension based on a guaranteed rate of return of 8% per annum for 10 years, with an option to opt for pension on a monthly/quarterly/half-yearly and annual basis.
- The difference between the return generated by LIC and the assured return of 8% per annum would be borne by Government of India as subsidy on an annual basis.
- Minimum investment is not yet specified. However, the maximum investment limit is ₹ 7,50,000.

LUCKY GRAHAK YOJANA AND THE DIGI-VYAPAR YOJANA

Objective: The primary aim of these schemes is to incentivize digital transactions so that electronic payments are adopted by all sections of the society, especially the poor and the middle class.

Features

- Lucky Grahak Yojana (consumers).
- Daily reward of ₹ 1,000 to be given to 15,000 lucky consumers for a period of 100 days.
- Weekly prizes worth ₹ 1 lakh, 10,000 and 5,000 for each consumer who uses the alternate modes of digital payments.
- This will include all forms of transactions viz. UPI, USSD, AEPS and RuPay Cards but for the time being exclude transactions through private credit cards and digital wallets.

DIGI-VYAPAR YOJANA (MERCHANTS)

Prize for merchants for all kinds of digital transactions conducted at merchant establishments.

Weekly prizes worth ₹ 50,000, 5,000 and 2,500

Mega draw on 14th of April (Ambedkar Jayanti)

Three mega prizes for consumers worth ₹ 1 crore, 50 lakh and 25 lakh for digital transactions between 8 November 2016 and 13 April 2017 to be announced on 14 April 2017.

Three mega prizes for merchants worth ₹ 50 lakh, 25 lakh and 12 lakh for digital transactions between 8 November 2016 and 13 April 2017 to be announced on 14th April.

FIRST FLIGHT UNDER UDAN SCHEME TO TAKE OFF

Launched: The Minister of State for Civil Aviation, Jayant Sinha, on 19 January 2017 announced that the first flight under UDAN Scheme is likely to take off in February 2017.

Objective: To form more airports and to make air service available at low cost.

Features

- Presently there are 75 operational airports in the country and after the implementation of UDAN scheme, 43 new airports will be added.
- Under this scheme, traveller can buy tickets at ₹ 2,500. A single user can book from 9 seats to maximum 40 seats.

MODIFIED SPECIAL INCENTIVE PACKAGE SCHEME

Objective: To further incentivize investments in electronic sector and further move towards the goal of 'Net Zero imports' in electronics by 2020.

Features

- The incentive under the scheme will be available from the date of approval of a project and not from the date of receipt of application.
- The incentives will be available for investments made within five years from the date of approval of the project.
- Approvals will normally be accorded to eligible applications within 120 days of submission of the complete application.
- The unit receiving incentives under the scheme will provide an undertaking to remain in commercial production for a period of at least three years.
- The Appraisal Committee recommending approval of project will be chaired by Secretary, Ministry of Electronics and IT.

CCEA APPROVES 40,000 MW SOLAR PARK SCHEME

Launched: By the Union Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs.

Objective: For the development of solar parks and ultra mega solar power parks.

Features

This Scheme for Development of solar parks and ultra mega solar power projects with the production target enhancement to 40,000 MW from the present 20,000 MW.

The enhanced target capacity would ensure the development of at least 50 solar parks each with a capacity of 500 MW and above in various parts of the country.

In the recent development, smaller parks in Himalayan and other hilly states where contiguous land may be difficult to acquire in view of the difficult terrain will also be considered under the scheme.

CREDIT LINKED SUBSIDY SCHEME (CLSS) OF PMAY

Launched: PM Modi has given its approval on 1 February 2017.

Objective: To extend the tenure of loans under the Credit Linked Subsidy Scheme (CLSS) of PMAY from 15 to 20 years.

Features

The scheme has been introduced for the middle-income group (MIG) category and an initial allocation of ₹ 1,000 crore has been made at Budgetary Estimate stage in 2017–18 for the proposed CLSS for MIG.

The Primary Lending Institutions (PLIs) that have signed a MoU with the Central Nodal Agencies (CNAs), under the CLSS of PMAY (Urban), have also been directed to extend the necessary conditions of their MoU to CLSS for MIG with appropriate changes as applicable.

The schemes aim to ensure greater participation among the economically weaker section (EWS), LIG and MIG segment of the society to provide housing for all by 2022.

MISSION FINGERLING

Fisheries in India are very important economic activities and a flourishing sector with varied resource and potential. By seeing this potential, P.M.

Modi named the revolution as Neel Kranti Mission (Blue revolution) with the vision to improve and sustainable maintenance of fisheries industry.

Objectives

- To fully tap the total fish potential of the country, both in inland and the marine sector, and triple the production by 2020.
- To transform the fisheries' sector as a modern industry with special forms on new technology and process.
- To double the income of the fishers and fish farmers.
- To ensure inclusive participation of the fishers and fish farmers in the income enhancement.
- To triple the export earnings by 2020 from fisheries sector.
- To enhance the food and nutritional security of the country.
- The ministry rolled out an umbrella scheme called 'Blue revolution: Integrated Development and Management of Fisheries' with a total outlay of ₹ 3,000 crores with seven components.

The scheme provides the convergence of:

- Sagarmala Project
- MGNREGA
- Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana
- NRLM

Launched: By Union government on 11 March 2017.

Objective: To achieve Blue Revolution with the holistic development and management of fisheries in the country.

Features

- The Blue Revolution programme focuses on creating an environment that envisages integrated and holistic development and management of fisheries for the socio-economic development of the fishers and fish farmers.
- The main motive behind this programme is to enhance the fisheries' production from 10.79 to 15 mmt by 2020–21.
- The department has identified 20 states based on their potential and other relevant factors to strengthen the Fish Seed infrastructure in the country.

AYUSHMAN BHARAT – NATIONAL HEALTH PROTECTION MISSION (AB-NHPM)

Launched: September 25, 2018

Ayushman Bharat Yojana is a health care services to all-inclusive. It is a National Health Protection Scheme to provide health insurance coverage worth ₹ 5 lakh to each of the selected 10 crore poor families (called beneficiaries) every year for secondary and tertiary care hospitalization. The 1,354 medical packages include surgical procedures and medical treatments involving expenses relating to medicines, transport, and diagnostics. The scheme is an amalgamation of the two central government schemes – Senior Citizen Health Insurance Scheme (SCHIS) and Rashtriya Swasthya Bima Yojana (RSBY). The scheme was announced on the auspicious occasion of Independence Day by Prime Minister Narendra Modi and will be launched on September 25, 2018. The scheme is also called 'Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Abhiyaan' and is dubbed as 'Modicare'.

Objectives

1. Setting up of health and wellness centers all over India to provide extensive primary medical services to the poor, vulnerablefamilies.
2. Granting health insurance coverage to about 40 percent of the population deprived of basic healthcare services.

Features

- Its beneficiaries can have cashless health benefits from any public or private empanelled hospitals in India.
- The payment rates for the treatment of the beneficiaries will be decided by the government in advance in order to control the costs.
- To promote co-operative federalism and adaptability to the states.
- The members of the eligible families are required to carry Aadhar card or other IDs prescribed by the government to avail the benefits of this scheme at the empanelled hospitals.
- Ayushman Bharat National Health Protection Mission Council (AB-NHPMC) will be set up at the apogee to formulate policies and foster coordination between the center and the states. The council will be led by the Union Health and Family Welfare Minister.
- The states implementing the scheme will have a State Health Agency (SHA).

- The funds will be directly transferred by the Central Government to the State Health Agencies.
- The central government will create an IT platform to assist in paperless, cashless transactions.

Implementation

- **At national Level:** Ayushman Bharat-National Health Protection Mission Agency (AB-NHPMA) will be set up to manage the scheme.
- **At the state level:** State Health Agency (SHA) in every state shall be created to implement the scheme in the states and union territories.

National Health Agency (NHA)

The National Health Agency (NHA) is a self-governing entity established on May 11, 2018, to effectively implement AB-NHPM all over India. The agency is registered as a society under the Society Registration Act, 1860.

TRANSFORMATION OF ASPIRATIONAL DISTRICTS PROGRAMME

Launched: January 2018

Objectives

- The 'Transformation of Aspirational Districts' initiative to remove this heterogeneity through a mass movement to quickly and effectively transform these districts.
- With States as the main drivers, this program will focus on the strength of each district, identify low-hanging fruits for immediate improvement, measure progress, and rank districts.

Strategy

- Convergence (of Central & State Schemes),
- Collaboration (of Central, State level 'Prabhari' Officers & District Collectors), and
- Competition among districts driven by a spirit of mass Movement.

Districts Selection

The 112 districts were identified from 27 states, at least one from each state, in a transparent manner by a committee of Senior Officers to the Government of India, in consultation with State Officials using a

composite index of key data sets that included deprivation enumerated under the Socio-Economic Caste Census, key health and education sector performance and state of basic infrastructure.

Methodology

Baseline Ranking

The objective of the program is to monitor the real-time progress of aspirational districts based on 49 indicators (81 data-points) from the 5 identified thematic areas. With the latest available data from the ministries concerned, NITI Aayog has completed a baseline ranking of 101 districts.

1. **Health and Nutrition (30%):** With 30% of the overall composite score on health & nutrition, the program has identified 13 indicators to focus on antenatal care, postnatal care, gender parity, health of new - borns, growth of children, contagious diseases, and health infrastructure.
2. **Education (30%):** The education sector accounts of 30% of the overall index. 8 indicators have been identified focussing on learning outcomes (transition rate from primary to upper primary, and subsequently to secondary schooling, average scores in mathematics and language etc.), as well as infrastructural (toilet access for girls, drinking water, electricity supply) and institutional indicators (RTE mandated pupil-teacher ratio, timely delivery of textbooks).
3. **Agriculture & Water resources (20%):** Agriculture is the backbone of India, with more than 50% of our workforce engaged in cultivation and allied activities. 10 indicators have been identified for the 20% weightage allocated to agriculture. The focus is on outputs (yield, price realisation etc.), inputs (quality seed distribution, soil health cards), and institutional support (crop insurance, electronic markets, artificial insemination, animal vaccination etc.).
4. **Basic Infrastructure (10%):** A roof over one's head with water, electricity, and road connectivity is the priority of the Government. 7 important indicators have been identified including availability of individual household latrines, drinking water, electricity, and road connectivity. Districts are also tracked for the number of internet connected Gram Panchayats, and panchayats with Common Service Centres.

5. **Financial Inclusion & Skill Development (10%):** Together, these two themes account for 10% of the overall index. 6 indicators have been identified in financial inclusion to measure progress in take - up of important central government schemes (Atal Pension Yojana, Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana etc.), reach of institutional banking (number of accounts opened under Jan Dhan Yojana), and ease of institutional financing for small businesses (disbursement of Mudra loans). 5 indicators have been identified in skill development to keep track of the progress in skilling of youth, employment, and the skilling of vulnerable/marginalized youth.

THE NATIONAL NUTRITION MISSION (NNM)

Launched: March 8, 2018

National Nutrition Mission was launched as an expansion of Beti Bachao Beti Padhao programme by Prime Minister Narendra Modi at Jhunjhunu in Rajasthan on the occasion of the International Women's Day on March 8, 2018.

Objective

The main objectives of this scheme are to attain proper nutritional status among children from 0-6 years, adolescent girls, pregnant women, and lactating mothers in a timely manner; reduce stunting, under-nutrition, and anaemia among young children, women, and adolescent girls; and lowering low birth weight by at least 2% per annum.

Features

- The National Nutrition Mission (NNM), also known as Rashtriya Poshan Mission has been launched by the government of India with three year budget of 9046.17 crore rupees.
- National Nutrition Mission as an apex body under Ministry of Women and Child Development will supervise, monitor, fix targets and guide nutrition related interventions all over the Ministries.
- It will also monitor an assortment of schemes contributing towards addressing malnutrition in India.
- 50% of the NNM will be funded by the Government Budgetary Support and 50% will be funded by International Bank for

Reconstruction and Development (IBRD, also known as World Bank). The Government budgetary support would be of 60:40 between Centre and States/UTs, 90:10 for Northeast region and Himalayan States and 100% for UTs without legislature.

- National Nutrition Mission will bring in measurement of height of children at the Anganwadi Centres (AWCs).
- The scheme will assist to conduct Social Audits.
- It will also set-up Nutrition Resource Centres, which will involve masses through Jan Andolan for their participation on nutrition throughout various activities, among others.

ANTI-NARCOTICS SCHEME

Launched: October 2004
Ministry/Department: Ministry of Home Affairs

Objective

Aims to combat illicit trafficking in drugs and psychotropic substances by assisting states and Union Territories financially which are contributing in controlling inter-state and cross-border drug trafficking.

Features

- The scheme was first launched in October 2004 for period of five years.
- It was later extended twice in subsequent years.
- It aims to assist states and Union Territories financially which are contributing in controlling inter-state and cross-border drug trafficking.
- The main strategy under the scheme includes reduction of both supply and demand of drugs and psychotropic substances.
- The supply reduction will include enforcement activities and demand reduction will involve rehabilitation and de-addiction measures.

Extention of the Scheme

- The Scheme is in news as it has been extended for 3 more years.
- The Anti-Narcotics Scheme is further extended by the Union government for three years from 2017 to 2020 to prevent drug

consumption and trafficking in the nation. The government has provided a financial assistance of ₹ 21 crore towards this scheme. The scheme monetarily assists the states and the Union Territories engaged in the controlling of inter-state and cross-border drug trafficking.

Other Facts

- There are approximately 40 lakh drug addicts in the country.
- The most common drugs of abuse are ganja, hashish, opium and heroin.
- Moreover there is serious abuse of pharmaceutical preparations like 'buprenorphine', codeine based cough syrups and painkillers like 'proxivon'.
- In certain regions of country, drug abuse already has become severe social-economic problem affecting vulnerable age groups.

SCHEME FOR PREVENTION OF ALCOHOLISM AND DRUGS ABUSE

Launched: 1985-86

Revised: January 2015

Recognizing Substance Abuse and Alcoholism as a psycho-socio medical problem, the approach would be to provide whole range of service including awareness generation, identification, treatment and rehabilitation of addicts through the Voluntary Organizations. With a view to reducing the demand for the consumption of alcohol and dependence producing substances, the thrust will be on preventive education programmes and on reintegration of the addicts into the mainstream of the society. While the Govt. of India would provide financial support to the organizations for institutionalized activities, stress would be on mobilization of community resources and greater community participation.

Objectives

- to create awareness and educating the people about the ill-efforts of alcoholism and substance abuse on the individual, the family and the society at large.
- to involve culture-specific models for the prevention of alcoholism and substance and the treatment and rehabilitation of addicts;

- to provide for the whole range of community based services for the identification motivation, counseling, de-addiction, after care and rehabilitation of addicts;
- to promote collective initiatives and self-help endeavors among individuals and groups vulnerable to addiction or found at risk;
- to establish appropriate linkage between state interventions and voluntary efforts in the field of alcoholism and substance abuse prevention;
- to increase community participation and public cooperation in the reduction of demand for dependence-producing substances and;
- to support activities which are in consonance with the mandate of the Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment in this field.

The Organisation Eligible for Assistance

- A society registered under the Societies' Registration Act, 1860 (XXI of 1860) or any relevant Act of the State Governments / Union Territory or under any State law relating to registration of charitable societies.
- A registered public Trust.
- A Company established under Section 25 of the Companies Act, 1956.
- An organisation / institution fully funded or managed by Government or a local body.

Other Facts

- The Ministry has issued an advisory to all States and Union Territories on 11.8.2016 for taking coordinated action to address the problem of drug abuse.
- The National Institute of Social Defence (NISD), an autonomous organization under this Ministry, conducts sensitization and preventive education programmes in schools and colleges on regular basis. During the year 2017-18, NISD has conducted 247 awareness generation programmes in various Schools and Universities/Colleges covering 23006 beneficiaries.

GOBAR-DHAN SCHEME

Launched: 30th April 2019

The Galvanising Organic Bio-Agro Resources Dhan (GOBAR-DHAN) scheme was launched by Haryana's Chief Minister Manohar Lal Khattar

and Uma Bharti (Union Minister for Sanitation and Drinking Water) on 30th April 2019 at the National Dairy Research Institute (NDRI) Auditorium, Karnal. The scheme was first announced in the Union Budget session of 2018-19 by the then Finance Minister, Arun Jaitley.

Features

- The GOBAR-DHAN scheme is an effort by the government to improve the living conditions in the Indian villages and make them open-defecation free. A segment of the Swachh Bharat initiative (Gramin), this scheme will focus on useful conversion of waste into energy.
- Under this scheme, the solid waste of the dung and fields will be converted into compost and fuels such as biogas and bio-CNG. The government has covered over 115 districts for the implementation of this scheme.
- The scheme envisages the implementation of 700 biogas units in different states of the country in the year 2018-19.

Objectives

- Ensure cleanliness and sanitation in the villages of India.
- Generate energy and wealth from cattle dung and organic waste.
- Promotion of compost made of cattle dung and farm compost for agriculture.
- Utilisation and processing of the residue so that it can be converted into more usable forms of energy like bio
- CNG and biogas that can be used by the villagers as a clean fuel.
- Connect farmers to the buyers of the dung and agricultural waste so that farmers can get the right price for it.
- The scheme will make sure that everything is well-managed and processed in such a manner that the farmers in their farmlands can further use residual solid waste as compost fertilizer.

Benefits

- Villages will be clean and sanitized due to the removal of solid wastes.
- Helps in saving electricity and environment too by causing less pollution.

- Create new rural livelihood opportunities for newer jobs linked to waste collection, transportation, biogas sales etc. and enhance income for farmers and other rural people.
- Generation of biogas will help in increasing self-reliance in energy utilized for cooking and lighting.
- Improvement in the health of the livestock and farm yields.

SENIOR CITIZENS QUALITY OF LIFE IMPROVEMENT SCHEME

Revised: 01.04.2018

There has been a steady rise in the population of senior citizens in India. The number of elderly persons has increased from 1.98 crore in 1951 to 7.6 crore in 2001, and 10.38 crore in 2011. The projections indicate that the number of 60+ in India will increase to 14.3 crore in 2021 and 17.3 crore in 2026. Continuous increase in life expectancy means that more people are now living longer. General improvement in the health care facilities over the years is one of the main reasons for continuing increase in proportion of population of senior citizens. Ensuring that they not merely live longer, but lead a secure, dignified and productive life is a major challenge.

This clearly reveals that ageing has become a major social challenge and there is a need to provide for the economic and health needs of the elderly and to create a social milieu, which is conducive and sensitive to the emotional needs of the elderly.

Objectives

The main objective of the Scheme is to improve the quality of life of the Senior Citizens by providing basic amenities like shelter, food, medical care and entertainment opportunities and by encouraging productive and active ageing through providing support for capacity building of State/ UT Governments/Non-Governmental Organizations (NGOs)/ Panchayati Raj Institutions (PRIs) / local bodies and the community at large.

Approach

Assistance under the scheme will be given to the Implementing Agencies such as State/ UT Governments /Panchayati Raj Institutions / local bodies and eligible Non-Governmental/Voluntary Organizations etc. as mentioned in Para 6, for the following purposes:

1. Programmes catering to the basic needs of Senior Citizens particularly food, shelter and health care to the destitute elderly;
2. Programmes to build and strengthen intergenerational relationships particularly between children / youth and Senior Citizens, through Regional Resource and Training Centres (RRTCs);
3. Programmes for encouraging Active and Productive Ageing, through RRTCs;
4. Programmes for proving Institutional as well as Non-Institutional Care/ Services to Senior Citizens;
5. Research, Advocacy and Awareness building programmes in the field of Ageing through RRTCs; and
6. Any other programmes in the best interest of Senior Citizens

SEXUAL HARASSMENT OF WOMEN AT WORKPLACE ACT 2013

Features

- The Act recognizes the right of every woman to a safe and secure workplace environment irrespective of her age or employment/work status.
- It includes all women whether engaged directly or through an agent including a contractor, with or without the knowledge of the principal employer. They may be working for remuneration, on a voluntary basis or otherwise.
- Their terms of employment can be express or implied.
- Further, she could be a co-worker, a contract worker, probationer, trainee, apprentice, or called by any other such name.
- The Act also covers a woman, who is working in a dwelling place or house.

Definition of Workplace

- A workplace is defined as "any place visited by the employee arising out of or during the course of employment, including transportation provided by the employer for undertaking such a journey."
- As per this definition, a workplace covers both the organised and un-organised sectors.
- It also includes all workplaces whether owned by Indian or foreign company having a place of work in India.

As Per the Act, Workplace Includes

- Government organizations, including Government company, corporations and cooperative societies
- Private sector organisations, venture, society, trust, NGO or service providers etc.
- Hospitals/Nursing Homes
- Sports Institutes/Facilities
- A dwelling place or house.
- Any enterprise owned by an individual or self-employed workers engaged in the production or sale of goods or providing services of any kind;
- Any enterprise which employs less than 10 workers.

Nature of Sexual Harassment

1. Physical contact or advances
2. A demand or request for sexual favours
3. Making sexually coloured remarks
4. Showing pornography
5. Any other unwelcome physical, verbal or non-verbal conduct of a sexual nature

Impact of Inappropriate Behaviour

The impact of sexual harassment at the workplace is far-reaching and is an injury to the equal right of women. Not only does it impact her, it has a direct bearing on the workplace productivity as well as the development of the society.

MATERNITY BENEFITS (AMENDMENT) ACT, 2017

The Maternity Benefit Act 1961 protects the employment of women during the time of her maternity and entitles her of a 'maternity benefit', i.e. full paid absence from work - to take care for her child. The Act is applicable to all establishments employing 10 or more persons.

The Maternity Benefit (Amendment) Act, 2017 provides for the followings:

- Maternity leave available to the working women to be increased from 12 weeks to 26 weeks for the first two children.
- Maternity leave for children beyond the first two will continue to be 12 weeks.

- Maternity leave of 12 weeks to be available to mothers adopting a child below the age of three months as well as to the "commissioning mothers". The commissioning mother has been defined as biological mother who uses her egg to create an embryo planted in any other woman.
- Every establishment with more than 50 employees to provide for crèche facilities for working mothers and such mothers will be permitted to make four visits during working hours to look after and feed the child in the crèche.
- The employer may permit a woman to work from home if it is possible to do so.
- Every establishment will be required to make these benefits available to the women from the time of her appointment.

REHABILITATION OF BONDED LABOURER SCHEME

Launched: May, 1978

Revised: 17th May, 2016

Evolution of scheme

- The issue of 'bonded labour' came to the list of national priority when it was included in the old 20-Point Programme in 1975.
- The Bonded Labour System (Abolition) Ordinance was promulgated on 25th October, 1975.
- This Ordinance was later on replaced by the Bonded Labour System (Abolition) Act, 1976.
- Under the Act- 1976, it is the responsibility of State governments to identify, release and rehabilitate the bonded labour.
- In order to assist the State Governments in the task of rehabilitation of identified and released bonded labourers, a Centrally Sponsored Plan Scheme for Rehabilitation of Bonded Labour was in operation since May, 1978.

Revised Scheme Guidelines

The revised Scheme is a Central Sector Scheme and came into effect from 17th May, 2016.

The Salient features are as follows.

- Every bonded labour including child bonded labour in the country is covered under the Scheme.

- The State Governments shall not be required to pay any matching contribution for the purpose of cash rehabilitation assistance. The fund is released by the Ministry of Labour and Employment under the Scheme to the District National Child Labour Project Society and the District Project Society in turn releases the fund to the implementing agencies including the district administration.
- The amount of assistance for survey of bonded labourers is ₹ 4.50 lakh per district.
- The Rehabilitation package shall be
- ₹ 1,00,000 per adult male beneficiary. Beneficiary shall have the option to either deposit it in an annuity scheme or receive cash grant.
- For special category beneficiaries such as children including orphans or those rescued from organised and forced begging rings or other forms of forced child labour and women, the amount of rehabilitation assistance shall be 2 lakhs out of which at least ₹ 1,25,000/- shall be deposited in an annuity scheme in the name of each beneficiary and the balance amount shall be transferred to the beneficiary account through ECS.
- In cases of bonded or forced labour involving extreme cases of deprivation or marginalization such as trans-genders, or women or children rescued from ostensible sexual exploitation such as brothels, massage parlours, placement agencies etc., or trafficking, or in cases of differently abled persons, or in situations where the District Magistrate deems fit, the rehabilitation assistance shall be ₹ 3 lakhs, out of which at least ₹ 2 lakhs shall be deposited in an annuity scheme in the name of each beneficiary and ₹ 1 lakh shall be transferred to the beneficiary account through ECS.
- The above benefits would be additionality to other land and housing elements, etc. of the original scheme as mentioned below:
- Allotment of house-site and agricultural land
- Land development
- Provision of low cost dwelling units
- Animal husbandry, dairy, poultry, piggery etc.
- Wage employment, enforcement of minimum wages etc.
- Collection and processing of minor forest products.

- Supply of essential commodities under targeted public distribution system.
- Education for children.
- For adult bonded labour who do not come under any of the above categories, employable skill development training shall be a compulsory element of rehabilitation.
- A Bonded Labour Rehabilitation Fund shall be created at the District level by each State with a permanent corpus of at least ₹ 10 lakhs at the disposal of the District Magistrate which should be renewable. This fund will be utilised for extending immediate help to the released bonded labourers. The entire penalties recovered from the perpetuators of the bonded labour upon conviction, may be deposited in this special fund.
- Immediate assistance of at least ₹ 5,000/- shall be provided by the District Administration to the rescued.

The Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports is Sports Fund for Pension to Meritorious Sportspersons to provide life long monthly pension to medal winners in Olympic Games, Commonwealth Games, World Championships in the disciplines included in Olympic Games and Asian Games, Paralympic Games after their retirement from active sports or they attain the age of 30years, whichever is later.

AIMS AND OBJECTIVES

To provide incentive as well as an added measure of financial security to sportspersons in recognition of their outstanding performance in identified international competitions i.e., Olympic Games, Commonwealth Games and Asian Games and World Cups/World Championships in Olympics and Asian Games disciplines and Para-Olympic Games.

Eligibility

- The Scheme will be applicable to sportspersons, who are Indian citizens and have won Gold, Silver or Bronze medals in Olympic Games, World Cup/World Championships in Olympics and Asian Games disciplines, Asian Games, Commonwealth Games and Para-Olympic Games.
- The pension shall be payable to a sportsperson on his or her attaining the age of 30 years and will continue during his/her life time provided

that the sportsperson at the time of applying such pension would have retired from an active sports career. An undertaking to this effect will have to be given by the sportsperson in the application from itself.

- A sportsperson availing of the pension under this Scheme will not be deprived of financial benefits/scholarships/ex - gratia/ grants or any other monetary benefit admissible to him/her from any other source and, vice-versa, any sportsperson availing of any such benefit will not be deprived of the admissible pension under this scheme.
- Those sportspersons who are eligible under the scheme can contact the Department of Sports, Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports to enable them to get immediate benefit of the Scheme.

Assistance given

The revised rates of pension are as follows.

Category of meritorious pension	Amount in ₹
Medallist at the Olympic/Para-Olympic Games	₹ 20,000/-
Gold medallist at World Cup/World Championship (in Olympic/Asian Games disciplines)	₹ 16,000/-
Silver/Bronze medallist at World Cup/World Championship (in Olympics / Asian Games disciplines)	
Gold medallist in Asian Games/Commonwealth Games/Para Asian Games	₹ 14,000/-
Silver and Bronze medallist in Asian Games/ Commonwealth Games/Para Asian Games	₹ 12,000/-

National Pension Scheme for Traders and Self Employed Persons

- The National Pension Scheme for Traders and Self Employed Persons Yojana (Pradhan Mantri Laghu Vyapari Maan-dhan Yojana) is a pension scheme for shopkeeper's/ retail traders and self-employed persons for providing monthly minimum assured pension of Rs 3000/- for the entry age group of 18-40 years.
- It is a voluntary and contribution based central sector scheme.
- The scheme is in effect from 22nd day of July, 2019. The scheme would benefit more than 3 crore small shopkeepers and traders.

Eligibility

1. The scheme is open to Laghu Vyaparis, who are self-employed and working as shop owners, retail traders, rice mill owners, oil mill owners, workshop owners, commission agents, brokers of real estate, owners of small hotels, restaurants and other Laghu Vyaparis. The operations of such small traders are generally characterized by family owned establishments, small scale of operations, labour intensive, inadequate financial aid, seasonal in nature and extensive unpaid family labour.
2. Age group of 18-40 years
3. Laghu Vyapari whose annual turnover does not exceed Rs 1.5 crore, based on self-declaration. GSTIN is required only for those with turnover above ₹ 40 lakhs.
4. Who has a savings bank account in his/her name and Aadhar number.
5. The following are not eligible to join the Scheme
   - ❖ If covered under National Pension Scheme contributed by the Central Government or Employees' State Insurance Corporation Scheme under the Employees' State Insurance Act, 1948 (34 of 1948) or Employees' Provident Fund Scheme under the Employees' Provident Fund and Miscellaneous Provisions Act, 1952 (19 of 1952) or
   - ❖ Is an income-tax assessee.

Benefits of the Scheme

- Each eligible subscriber under this Scheme shall receive assured minimum monthly pension of ₹ 3000 after attaining the age of sixty years.
- The Government of India will make matching contribution in the subscribers' account. For example if a person with age of 29 years contributes ₹ 100/- month, then the Central Government also contributes the equal amount as subsidy into subscriber's pension account every month.
- Benefits on disablement: If an eligible subscriber has given regular contributions and become permanently disabled due to any cause before attaining his age of 60 years, and is unable to continue to contribute under this Scheme, his spouse shall be entitled to continue with the Scheme subsequently by payment of regular contribution as

applicable or exit the Scheme by receiving the share of contribution deposited by such subscriber, with interest as actually earned thereon by the Pension Fund or the interest at the savings bank interest rate thereon, whichever is higher.

- Benefits to the family on death of an eligible subscriber: During the receipt of pension, if an eligible subscriber dies, his spouse shall be only entitled to receive fifty per cent. of the pension received by such eligible subscriber, as family pension and such family pension shall be applicable only to the spouse.
- Benefits on leaving the Pension Scheme:
  - ❖ In case an eligible subscriber exits this Scheme within a period of less than ten years from the date of joining the Scheme by him, then the share of contribution by him only will be returned to him with savings bank rate of interest payable thereon
  - ❖ If an eligible subscriber exits after completion of a period of ten years or more from the date of joining the Scheme by him but before his age of sixty years, then his share of contribution only shall be returned to him along with accumulated interest thereon as actually earned by the Pension Fund or the interest at the savings bank interest rate thereon, whichever is higher;
  - ❖ If an eligible subscriber has given regular contributions and died due to any cause, his spouse shall be entitled to continue with the Scheme subsequently by payment of regular contribution as applicable or exit by receiving the share of contribution paid by such subscriber along with accumulated interest, as actually earned thereon by the Pension Fund or at the savings bank interest rate thereon, whichever is higher;
  - ❖ After death of subscriber and his or her spouse, the corpus shall be credited back to the fund.

CENTRAL VICTIM COMPENSATION FUND SCHEME (CVCF)

Introduction

The compensation part of the rehabilitation of victims of violence including rape is governed by provision of Section 357A of the Code of Criminal Procedure which states that every State Government in co-ordination with the Central Government shall prepare a scheme for

providing funds for the purpose of compensation to the victim of crime. So far 24 states and 7 UTs have formulated the Victim Compensation Scheme.

The government has introduced a Central Victim Compensation Fund (CVCF) scheme, with an initial corpus of Rs 200 crores, to enable support to victims of rape, acid attacks, human trafficking and women killed or injured in the cross border firing. Till now, there has been an absurd disparity in compensation amount paid by state governments varying from Rs 10,000 to Rs 10 lakh.

Key Objectives of Scheme

- To support and supplement the existing Victim Compensation Schemes notified by States/UT Administrations.
- To reduce disparity in quantum of compensation amount notified by different States/ UTs for victims of similar crimes.
- To encourage States/UTs to effectively implement the Victim Compensation Schemes (VCS) notified by them under the provisions of section 357A of Cr.P.C. and continue financial support to victims of various crimes especially sexual offences including rape, acid attacks, crime against children, human trafficking etc.

Eligibility for Compensation

The victim or his dependent satisfying the following criteria shall be eligible for the receipt of compensation:

- He/She should not have been in receipt of any compensation for such loss or injury from any Government authorities or any other scheme of the Central / State Government, for which the applicant or his dependents shall file a declaration to that effect along with the application form.
- The loss or injury sustained by the victim or his dependents should have caused substantial loss to the income of the family making it difficult to make both ends to meet without the financial aid or which requires such expenditure beyond his means on medical treatment of such mental/physical injury to the victim
- Where the offender of the crime is untraceable or cannot be identified, but the victim is identifiable, the victim or his dependents may also apply for grant of compensation under sub- section (4) of section 357 A of the Act.

Minimum Amount of Compensation

SI. No.	Description of Injures / loss	Minimum Amount of Compensation
1	Acid attack	₹ 3 lakhs
2	Rape	₹ 3 lakhs
3	Physical abuse of minor	₹ 2 laths
4	Rehabilitation of victim of Human Trafficking	₹ 1 lakh
5	Sexual assault(Excluding rape)	₹ 50,000/-
6	Permanent Disability(80% or more)	₹ 2 lakhs
7	Death	₹ 2 lakhs
8	Partial Disability (40% to 80%)	₹ 1 lakh
9	Burns affecting greater than 25% of the body (excluding Acid Attack cases)	₹ 2 lakhs
10	Loss of fertility	₹ 50,000/-
11	Loss of foetus	₹ 1.5 laths
12	Women victims of cross border firing:	
	(a) Death or Permanent Disability (80% or more)	₹ 2 laths
	(b) Partial Disability	₹ 1 lakh

Note: If the victim is less than 14 years of age, the compensation shall be increased by 50% over the amount specified above.

7 Other Sector-Wise Recent Schemes Launched by the Government

SOLAR ENERGY SCHEME

Launched: 1 April 2017

Objectove: To mitigate the problem of power cut/shortage faced by decentralized power loom units in the country so as to improve utilization, efficiency and productivity to face both the domestic and international markets competitively.

Features

To provide financial assistance/capital subsidy to small power loom units, for installation of Solar Photo Voltaic (SPV) plant.

The Scheme is meant for units having 04, 06 and 08 power looms and subsidies for different SPV plants will be given in the range of ₹ 2,25,000 to 8,55,000 depending upon the capacity of the SPV plant (4, 6 and 8 KWP).

The Government of India will provide financial assistance/capital subsidy to the extent of 50%, 75% and 90% of the basic cost of the Solar Energy Plant (cost of solar panel + inverter + batteries) to the applicants of General category, SC & ST, respectively.

RASHTRIYA VAYOSHRI YOJANA

Launched: On 1 April 2017

Objective: To provide physical aids and assisted-living devices for senior citizens belonging to BPL category.

Features

- Free of cost distribution of the devices, commensurate with the extent of disability/infirmity that is manifested among the eligible senior citizens.

- In case of multiple disabilities/infirmities manifested in the same person, the assistive devices will be given in respect of each disability/ impairment.
- The devices will help the senior citizens to overcome their age-related physical impairment and to lead a dignified and productive life with minimal dependence on caregivers or other members of the family.
- The scheme is implemented through the implementing agency, 'Artificial Limbs Manufacturing Corporation' (ALIMCO), a PSU under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment.

ATAL BHUJAL YOJANA

Launched: 2018-19

The Central Government scheme, "Atal Bhujal Yojana" is to address the conditions of water bodies across the country. The scheme, which is endorsed and funded by the World Bank, is intended to improve groundwater management and maintain it as a sustainable source. It will be operational for a period of five years from the current period, i.e., the scheme will run its course from 2018-19 through 2022-23.

Objectives

- The scheme is aimed at improving groundwater management in specific areas of the country through community participation.
- The areas of consideration include the States of Gujarat, Haryana, Karnataka, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Rajasthan, and Uttar Pradesh;
- As these states rank higher among the over-exploited, critical, and semi-critical blocks in terms of the groundwater scenario.
- Also, these states cover the nation's major groundwater in alluvial and hard rock aquifers and are blessed with varying degrees of institutional readiness and expertise in groundwater management.
- One of the stand-out features of the scheme is that it facilitates the beneficiaries to utilize the groundwater from the Ganges.

Budget Allocation

A total budget of ₹ 6000 crore has been allocated for the scheme. The quantum of funds will be mutually shared between the Government of

India and the World Bank. These funds will be dispersed to the various states for strengthening the institutions undertaking water governance and encouraging community involvement for improving ground water management, which will in-turn trigger behavioral changes that could pave the way for promoting conservation and efficient use of water.

Moreover, the scheme will be integrated with the current schemes of the Government by incentivizing their focused implementation in targeted areas. The scheme is to be extended to almost 8350 Gram Panchayats across 78 districts.

Regulation

The Central Ground Water Authority (CGWA) is vested with the responsibility of regulating groundwater development. Deputy Commissioners and District Magistrates of the respective states and union territories have been licensed to initiate actions under the Environment (Protection) Act, 1936 in the event of any contraventions of the directives prescribed by CGWA.

Community Participation

The scheme proposes to involve the community with activities such as formation of water user associations, observing and circulating groundwater data, allocation of budgets, and so on and so forth. Moreover, the community would be pursuing the formulation and implementation of water security plans for each Gram Panchayat and will actively participate in IEC activities that are connected with sustainable groundwater management.

The involvement of the community is likely to encourage bottom-up groundwater planning process which improves the effectiveness of public financing and align the implementation of other similar initiatives of the government.

Expected Result

The scheme is to:

- Provide more awareness on aspects related to groundwater.
- Render a focused and integrated community-based approach to tackle issues connected with groundwater depletion.

- Provide sustainable groundwater management through the convergence of current governmental schemes.
- Facilitate adoption of efficient water use practices that limit the use of water for irrigation.
- Augmentation of groundwater resources in targeted areas.

KHELO INDIA SCHOOL GAMES PROGRAMME

Launched: January 31, 2018

The Central Government of India inaugurated the first edition of the Khelo India School Games (KISG) at the Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium in New Delhi from January 31 to February 8, 2018. This program highlighted India's young sporting talent and their potential in sports.

Objectives

The main objectives behind KISG were

- To revive the sports culture in India at the grass-root level,
- To build a strong foundation of all the sports played in the country, and
- Make India a great sporting nation.

Participation

This mega event was held across 16 disciplines, e.g. Archery, Athletics, Badminton, Basketball, Boxing, Football, Gymnastics, Hockey, Judo, Kabaddi, Kho-Kho, Shooting, Swimming, Volleyball, Weightlifting, and Wrestling in the under-17 age category. Around 5,000 school children from all the 29 states and 7 union territories participated in the event.

NATIONAL BAMBOO MISSION

Approval: 25-04-2018

Restructured National Bamboo Mission approved by the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) on 25-04-2018. The Mission envisages promoting holistic growth of bamboo sector by adopting area-based, regionally differentiated strategy and to increase the area under

bamboo cultivation and marketing. Under the Mission, steps have been taken to increase the availability of quality planting material by supporting the setting up of new nurseries and strengthening of existing ones. To address forward integration, the Mission is taking steps to strengthen marketing of bamboo products, especially those of handicraft items.

The Union Government has allocated ₹ 1,290 crore towards the mission to promote holistic development of bamboo production as an industry in the country. It will offer a continuous source of income to the bamboo farmers and communities owning bamboo groves. There is a proposition of utilizing this mission under the Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana, the government's flagship programme for housing to set up bamboo houses.

Objective

To increase the area under bamboo plantation in non forest Government and private lands to supplement farm income and contribute towards resilience to climate change as well as availabilty of quality raw material requirements of industries. The bamboo plantations will be promoted predominantly in farmers, fields, homesteads, community lands, arable wastelands, and along irrigation canals, water bodies, etc.

Strategy

The Mission will focus on development of bamboo in limited States where it has social, commercial and economical advantage, particularly in the North Eastern region and States including Madhya Pradesh, Maharastra, Chhattisgarh, Odisha, Karnataka, Uttarakhand, Bihar, Jharkhand, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Gujarat, Tamil Nadu and Kerala.

Key Points

NBM would be an exclusive initiative focusing on comprehensive development of bamboo sector through cross sectoral and multi-disciplinary approach. Keeping in view Hon'ble Prime Minister's vision of doubling farmers income and 'Har Medh Par Ped', it will supplement income and livelihood sources, including during crop damage caused by extreme events.

ASSISTANCE FOR SKILL DEVELOPMENT OF OBCS/DNTS/EBCS (NGO SCHEME)

Launched: Online w.e.f 2014-15

Revised: w.e.f. 01.10.2017

Objective

The aim of this scheme is to involve the Voluntary Organization and National Backward Classes Finance and Development Corporation (NBCFDC) to improved educational and socio-economic conditions of the target group i.e. OBCs/DNTs/EBCs, with a view to upgrade their skill to enable them to start income generation activites on their own or get gainfully employed in some sector or the other.

Eligibility

The beneficiaries who parents/guardians income from all sources including the income of beneficiary does not exceed ₹ 1.00 lakh per annum are eligible under the Scheme.

Features

The quantum of assistance shall be determined in each case on merit. The Government of India may, however, meet 90% of the approved expenditure of the training. Presently, GIA is given to the extent of about ₹ 3.00 lakh to an NGO on an average for imparting training to 50 beneficiaries, i.e. ₹ 6,000/- for the training of a person. This includes cost of manpower, training material, rent, stationery, etc.

All the processes including applying, processing up to release of grant has been made online.

As per revised scheme, all applications as new cases of NGOs under the scheme are to be applied to National Backward Classes Finance and Development Corporation (NBCFDC) directly. All ongoing cases of NGOs under the scheme are to be applied as usual to the Ministry's online NGO Portal.

SMART CITIES MISSION

Launched: 2015

Cities accommodate nearly 31% of India's current population and contribute 63% of GDP (Census 2011). Urban areas are expected to house 40% of India's population and contribute 75% of India's GDP by 2030. This requires comprehensive development of physical, institutional, social and economic infrastructure. All are important in improving the quality of life and attracting people and investment, setting in motion a virtuous cycle of growth and development. Development of Smart Cities is a step in that direction.

Objectives

- The objective of Smart Cities Mission is to promote cities that provide core infrastructure and give a decent quality of life to its citizens, a clean and sustainable environment and application of 'Smart' Solutions.
- The Smart Cities Mission is meant to set examples that can be replicated both within and outside the Smart City, catalysing the creation of similar Smart Cities in various regions and parts of the country.

Strategy

- Pan-city initiative in which at least one Smart Solution is applied city-wide
- Develop areas step-by-step – three models of area-based developments
- Retrofitting,
- Redevelopment,
- Greenfield

The Core Infrastructure Elements

- Adequate water supply,
- Assured electricity supply,
- Sanitation, including solid waste management,
- Efficient urban mobility and public transport,
- Affordable housing, especially for the poor,
- Robust IT connectivity and digitalization,
- Good governance, especially e-Governance and citizen participation,

- Sustainable environment,
- Safety and security of citizens, particularly women, children and the elderly, and
- Health and education.

Coverage and Duration

The Mission will cover 100 cities and its duration will be five years (FY2015-16 to FY2019-20). The Mission may be continued thereafter in the light of an evaluation to be done by the Ministry of Urban Development (MoUD) and incorporating the learnings into the Mission.

Financing of Smart Cities

The Smart City Mission will be operated as a Centrally Sponsored Scheme (CSS) and the Central Government proposes to give financial support to the Mission to the extent of ₹ 48,000 crores over five years i.e. on an average ₹ 100 crore per city per year. An equal amount, on a matching basis, will have to be contributed by the State/ULB; therefore, nearly Rupees one lakh crore of Government/ULB funds will be available for Smart Cities development.

Convergence with Other Government Schemes

Comprehensive development occurs in areas by integrating the physical, institutional, social and economic infrastructure. Many of the sectoral schemes of the Government converge in this goal, although the path is different. There is a strong complementarity between the AMRUT and Smart Cities Mission in achieving urban transformation. While AMRUT follows a project-based approach, the Smart Cities Mission follows an area-based strategy.

Similarly, great benefit can be derived by seeking convergence of other Central and State Government Programs/Schemes with the Smart Cities Mission. At the planning stage itself, cities must seek convergence in the SCP with AMRUT, Swachh Bharat Mission (SBM), National Heritage City Development and Augmentation Yojana (HRIDAY)- External Website that opens in a new window, Digital India, Skill development, Housing for All, construction of Museums funded by the Culture Department and other programs connected to social infrastructure such as Health, Education and Culture.

8 Important Government Schemes at a Glance

PRADHAN MANTRI UJJWALA YOJANA

About the scheme

- Provide cooking gas to 5 crore below poverty line beneficiaries over next three years.

Why such scheme?

- Serious health hazards associated with cooking fuel, especially to women.
- WHO estimates 5 lakh deaths due to unclean cooking fuel.

Objective: To protect health of women and also provide employment to rural youth in supply chain of cooking gas.

Nodal Ministry: Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas

PARAMPARAGAT KRISHI VIKAS YOJANA

Objective: To develop organic clusters, make available chemical-free inputs to farmers and improve soil health.

Features

- A special scheme for North-East states to promote organic farming and export of organic produce.
- Organic farming will be promoted by using traditional resources and the organic products will be linked with the market.
- Ministry of Agriculture is the implementation authority.

PRADHAN MANTRI KRISHI SINCHAI YOJANA

About the Scheme

Integration of Accelerated Irrigation Benefit Programme (AIBP) of Ministry of Water Resources, River Development & Ganga Rejuvenation + Integrated Watershed Management Programme (IWMP) of Department

of Land Resources + On Farm Water Management (OFWM) component of National Mission on Sustainable Agriculture (NMSA) of Department of Agriculture and Cooperation.

Objective: Har Khet ko Pani

Strategy

- Assured irrigation sources
- More cropper drop
- Recharge aquifers
- Sustainable water conservation practices
- Adoption of precision irrigation system
- Harnessing rain water through Jal Sinchai and Jal Sinchan

Stress on end-to-end solutions in irrigation supply chain, which includes water sources, distribution networks and farm level applications.

Implementation body: Ministry of Agriculture

SOIL HEALTH CARD SCHEME

Objectives

- To help farmers improve productivity through judicious use of inputs.
- To give information about nutrient level of soil and make judicious use of fertilizers.

Implementation body: Department of Agriculture, Cooperation and Farmers' Welfare

NATIONAL AGRICULTURAL MARKET

- Pan-India electronic trading portal, which networks the existing APMC mandis to create a unified national market for agricultural commodities.
- Single license valid across state.
  - ❖ Single point levy of market
  - ❖ Electronic auction as a mode of price discovery
  - ❖ Do away with concept of market area

Implementation body: Department of Agriculture, Cooperation and Farmers' Welfare

RASHTRIYA GOKUL MISSION

New initiative under 'National Programme for Bovine Breeding and Dairy Development'.

Objective: To conserve and develop indigenous bovine breeds in focussed and scientific manner.

Gokul Grams: Integrated cattle development centres to be developed for it.

ATAL PENSION YOJANA

About the Yojana

- Monthly pension scheme
- Citizens in age group 18–40 years
- Citizens who are not member of any statutory social security scheme (mainly unorganized sector workers)
- Government to pay 50% of premium (upper limit ₹ 1000/year)
- Subscriber to get monthly pension between ₹ 1000 and 5000 after attaining 60 years

Implementation Body: Ministry of Finance

PRADHAN MANTRI FASAL BIMA YOJANA

About the Scheme

- Crop insurance scheme
- 2% premium = Kharif crops, 1.5% premium= Rabi crops, 5% premium= commercial/horticulture crops
- Uniform crop premium throughout the country as against previous different premium in different districts
- Claims on full sum insured
- Enhanced risk coverage and agri-insurance coverage (50% of farmers)
- Provision of assessment of loss at individual farm level due to hailstorm, landslide, inundation, cyclone or cyclonic rain and unseasonal rains after harvesting
- Use of technology like mobile, satellite for accurate loss assessment and early payments

- Replace National Agricultural Insurance Scheme as well as the Modified NAIS.

Implementation body: Ministry of Agriculture

PRADHAN MANTRI SURAKSHA BIMA YOJANA

About the Scheme

- Accident insurance scheme
- ₹ 2 lakh to subscriber; Annual premium= ₹ 12
- For all bank account holders in age group 18–70 years

Implementation body: Ministry of Finance

PRADHAN MANTRI JEEVAN JYOTI BIMA YOJANA

About the Scheme

- Life insurance scheme
- ₹ 2 lakh to the subscriber
- Annual premium= ₹ 330
- For all bank account holders in age group 18–50 years

Implementation body: Ministry of Finance

SHYAMA PRASAD MUKHERJI RURBAN MISSION

About the Scheme

- Drive social, economic and infrastructure development in rural areas.
- Similar to PURA– providing urban amenities in rural areas.
- Development of rural clusters by provision of economic activities, developing skills & local entrepreneurship and providing infrastructure amenities.
- The Rurban Mission will thus develop a cluster of Smart Villages.
- Rural clusters identified by Ministry of Rural Development with criteria of geographically contiguous Gram Panchayats with a population of about 25,000 to 50,000 in plain and coastal areas and a population of 5,000 to 15,000 in desert, hilly or tribal areas.
- Clusters will also be scientifically analysed on the basis of demography, economy, tourism, pilgrimage significance and transportation corridor impact.

Objectives: Strengthening rural areas and de-burdening urban areas, hence leading to balanced regional development.

SANSAD AADARSH GRAM YOJANA

Objective: Instill values such as fostering mutual cooperation, participation, eco-friendliness, gender equity, self-help, self-reliance, remove poverty and achieve well-being and preserving and promoting local cultural heritage.

Provisions

- Each Member of Parliament will take the responsibility of developing physical and institutional infrastructure in three villages by 2019.
- Developing infrastructure under existing schemes like MGNREGA, ICDS, NHM, Swachh Bharat Abhiyan and others.
- To develop a model village with schools having computers and toilets, health facilities for complete immunization, gym and yoga centre, drinking water, household toilets for all and facility for soil and liquid waste management.
- Scheme implemented through Village Development Plan for every Gram Panchayat.

Implementation body: Ministry of Rural Development

UNNAT BHARAT ABHIYAN

Objective: To connect institutes of higher education like IITs, NITs and IISERs with local communities to address development challenges through appropriate technologies.

Provisions

- Eight old IITs to adopt 10 villages each
- New IITs to adopt five villages each
- IIT teachers and students shall visit villages, study their problems and work out effective solutions

Base created: Each IIT already has a rural development wing, focussing on issues such as contamination of water, poor sanitation, food processing and preservation and personal equipment to lessen labourers' burden.

Implementation body: Ministry of Human Resource Development.

BETI PADHAO, BETI BACHAO

Target group: Focuses on survival, protection and education of girl child

Objectives

- To address issue of declining child sex ratio through mass campaign across country, targeting at changing societal mindset and creating awareness about criticality of the issue.
- It is a joint initiative of MWCD, MHFW and MHRD.

SUKANYA SAMRIDDHI YOJANA

Features

- Part of Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao campaign

Objectives

- To motivate parents to open account in the name of girl child
- Open a savings account of a girl of less than 10 years with an annual minimum deposit of ₹ 1,000 and maximum ₹ 1,50,000
- Account to remain operative for 21 years from the date of opening or marriage of girl child after attaining 18 years
- Can withdraw 50% of money after 18 years for higher education

PAHAL–PRATYAKSH HANSTANTRIT LABH–DIRECT BENEFIT TRANSFER

- It is a Direct Benefit Transfer scheme for LPG customers; first launched in June 2013
- LPG subsidy only for household cooking gas and not for commercial use
- **Functioning:** Household user buys subsidy at market price and receives subsidy amount in bank.
- The consumer to mandatorily have an Aadhaar card to avail LPG subsidy

Implementation body: Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas

ONE STOP CENTRE FOR WOMEN AFFECTED BY VIOLENCE

Objective: To provide integrated support (medical, legal and psychological support) under one roof to women affected from violence, through One Stop Centres.

- Funded under Nirbhaya Fund
- Implementation body: Ministry of Women and Child Development

PRADHAN MANTRI AWAS YOJANA (GRAMIN)

Features

- Rural housing scheme
- **Aim:** To achieve housing for all by 2022 (75th year of Indian Independence)
- One crore households to be provided assistance for construction of pucca houses from 2016–17 to 2018–19
- An access to pucca houses will create durable asset for poor rural families and also ensure their upward mobility and have positive impact on their health, education, social respect and overall well-being.

DEEN DAYAL UPADHYAY ANTOYADAYA YOJANA

About the Scheme

- Skill-based scheme for urban and rural poor
- **Aim:** Empower youth through skills to generate livelihood opportunities
- Apart from skill building, it encompasses self-employment through setting up micro enterprises and group enterprises
- Also supports formation of SHGs

PANDIT DEEN DAYAL UPADHYAY SHRAMEV JAYATE KARYAKRAM

It is a labour reforms scheme.

It is an Umbrella scheme of five schemes:

1. **Dedicated Shram Suvidha Portal:** Allot Labour Identification Number
2. **Random Inspection Scheme:** Utilizing technology to eliminate human discretion in selection of units for inspection

3. **Universal Account Number:** Employees to have their PF account portable, hassle free and universally accessible
4. **Apprenticeship Protsahan Yojana:** Reimburse 50% of stipend paid to apprentices in first two years by manufacturing and other establishments
5. **Revamped Rasthriya Swasthya Bima Yojana:** Smart cards for workers in unorganized sector

Implementation body: Ministry of Labour and Employment

PRADHAN MANTRI KAUSHAL VIKAS YOJANA

About the Scheme

- Skill training scheme with certification and reward
- Implemented through National Skill Development Corporation
- **Objective:** To enable and mobilize Indian youth to take up 'outcome-based skill training'.
- Monetary rewards through DBT to trainees, which are successfully trained, assessed and certified in skill courses run by training providers
- Roping in Industrial Training Institutes to impart skills under the scheme
- The target for skilling would be aligned to demand from other flagship programmes launched in recent times such as Make in India, Digital India, National Solar Mission and Swachh Bharat Abhiyan.
- Skill training under the new scheme will primarily be focused on a first time entrants to the labour market and primarily target Class 10 and Class 12 drop outs.
- Part of Skill India Mission

Implementation body: Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship

SKILL INDIA MISSION

About the Scheme:

- Current size of India's formal skilled workforce is 2%. There also exists huge army of educated unemployed youth.
- This points out to our flawed education system, which de-contextualized vocational education from formal education. Huge gap between talent coming out of college and its suitability in terms of employment.
- Skill India focuses to correct it.

Objective: To create skilled and job-ready workforce by equipping it with employable skills.

- Skill over 40 crore people by 2022.
- It recognizes need of convergence between formal and vocational education.

Initiatives like USTAAD, Learn and Earn are promoting informal sector craftsmen, where skilling in traditional trade and employment in informal sector is recognized as skill outcome for first time.

Implementation body: Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship

DEEN DAYAL UPADHYAY GRAMEEN KAUSHAL YOJANA

About the scheme:

- Skill development for inclusive growth programme
- As a part of National Rural Livelihood Mission
- India has 5.5 crore potential workers between age of 15 and 30 years in rural areas (Census 2011)
- DDU-GKY bridges challenge like lack of formal education and marketable skills by funding training projects with an emphasis on placement, retention, career progression and foreign placement.
- Guaranteed placement for 75% trained candidates.
- Mandatory coverage of disadvantaged groups (SC/ST 50%, Minority 15% and Women 33%)
- Greater emphasis on projects for poor rural youth in J&K (HIMAYAT), North East region and 27 Left Wing Extremism affected districts (ROSHINI)

PRADHAN MANTRI MUDRA YOJANA

- There are 5.77 crore small business units, mostly individual proprietorships, which run small manufacturing, trading or service activities. Most of these 'own account enterprises' are owned by people belonging to SC, ST or Other Backward Classes (NSSO 2013).
- Only 4% of credit needs of 5.8 crore small and micro enterprises are addressed by formal banking system (Economic Census 2014).

- PM Mudra Yojana responsible to refinance all last mile financiers engaged in lending to small-scale businesses engaged in manufacturing, trading and service activities.
- Thus, it can bring down the cost of finance from the last Mile Financiers to the micro/small enterprises, most of which are in the informal sector.

Three stages of growth and funding needs of beneficiary micro units divided into

- Shishu– Loan upto ₹ 50,000
- Kishor– Loans between ₹ 50,000 and ₹ 5 lakh
- Tarun– Loans between ₹ 50 lakh and ₹ 10 lakh

Implementation body: Ministry of Finance

END OF J&K SPECIAL STATUS AND CONVERTED INTO TWO UTs

Launched: 5th August 2019

Feature of Special Status

- Jammu and Kashmir enjoyed special status under Article 370 of the Constitution of India. This Article describes it as a temporary provision and that it will cease to be operative if the President issues a public notification to that effect. However, prior to that, a recommendation is necessary from the Constituent Assembly of Jammu and Kashmir.
- Under Article 370, Jammu and Kashmir had its own Constitution, and all laws passed by Parliament will not be applicable to the State, unless the State government gives its concurrence. The President is empowered to decide what provisions of the Constitution of India would be applicable to the State and what are the exceptions, but with the State government's concurrence.
- The Constitution (Application to Jammu and Kashmir) Order, 1954, lists the Articles and provisions that apply to J&K. Further, the President also listed a set of exceptions under Article 35A of the Constitution (this Article does not figure in the text of the Constitution of India, but figures only in the J&K's Constitution). While the 1954 presidential order constituted a founding legal document for Jammu and Kashmir, Article 35A protected the exclusive laws – such as the

bar on outsiders buying property and women marrying non-Kashmiris losing their property rights of the State.

- These special measures can be altered only on the recommendation of the Sadar-i-Riyasat of Jammu and Kashmir, acting on the advice of the Council of Ministers, or by the "Constituent Assembly" of that State. As of now, there is no "Constituent Assembly".

How J&K Special Status Changed

1. President, Shri Ram Nath Kovind, issued a presidential order under Article 370 (1) of the Constitution. This clause enables the President to specify the matters which are applicable to Jammu and Kashmir. As it can be issued only with the Jammu and Kashmir government's concurrence, the notification uses the words "with the concurrence of the Government of the State of Jammu and Kashmir". This presumably means the Governor, who is now administering the State under President's Rule, has given his concurrence on behalf of the State government.
2. The Order supersedes the 1954 Order. This effectively means that all the provisions that formed the basis of a separate "Constitution" for Jammu and Kashmir stand abrogated. The Order declares that all the provisions of the Constitution of India, shall apply to Jammu and Kashmir too.
3. However, some special measures were still needed for the scrapping of Article 370 altogether. Therefore, a few clauses were added to Article 367 of the Constitution.
   (i) Article 367 contains "Interpretations". They contain guidance on how to read or interpret some provisions. The new clauses say, when applicable to Jammu and Kashmir, all references to the 'Sadar-i-Riyasat', acting on the aid and advice of the Council of Ministers, will be construed as references to the Governor of Jammu and Kashmir. All references to the State government shall mean "the Governor".
   (ii) And most importantly, the reference to the "Constituent Assembly" in a proviso to Article 370 (3) has been amended to read "Legislative Assembly of the State". This is the proviso that says the President can declare that Article 370 is no more operative only on the recommendation of the Constituent Assembly. As

there is no Constituent Assembly in existence now, there is no body to "recommend" the demise of Article 370. Therefore, the State Assembly has to play that role.

4. The issuance of the Presidential Order has set the stage for the abrogation of Article 370. Here, the Union Government has made use of the fact that Jammu and Kashmir is under President's Rule. Under the Proclamation issued under Article 356 of the Constitution, by which the President takes over the administration of a State, Parliament usually performs the legislative functions of the State Assembly. For instance, when a State is under Central rule, the budget allocations for that State are voted in Parliament in the absence of the Assembly.
5. The Union Home Minister introduced two statutory resolutions in Parliament on 5th August 2019,
   (a) to recommend that the President issue a notification rendering Article 370 inoperative, and
   (b) to accept the Jammu and Kashmir Reorganisation Bill
      - The passage of the former resolution will enable the President to declare that Article 370 has ceased to operate.
      - The Bill envisages converting Jammu and Kashmir into a Union Territory with a legislature, and carve out Ladakh region as another Union Territory, but without a legislature.

9 Summary of Government Welfare Schemes and Programmes in India

- **Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment**
  - Rashtriya Vayoshri Yojana
  - Sugamaya Pustakalaya
  - National Workshop on Autism Tools, INCLEN and ISAA
  - Vayoshreshtha Samman-2016
- **Ministry of Power**
  - Ujwal DISCOM Assurance Yojana (UDAY)
  - Unnat Jyoti by Affordable LEDs for All (UJALA) Scheme
  - GARV-II App
  - Coal Mitra
  - 24×7 Power for All
  - Deendayal Upadhyaya Gram Jyoti Yojana (DUGJY)
  - UJALA Scheme (Unnat Jyoti by Affordable LEDs for All)
- **Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship (MSDE)**
  - National Skill Development Mission
  - Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY)
  - National Apprenticeship Promotion Scheme
  - Pradhan Mantri Yuva Yojana
  - Indian Institute of Skills
  - Pravasi Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PKVY)
  - UDAAN
- **Ministry of Finance**
  - Atal Pension Yojna (APY)
  - Income Declaration Scheme
  - Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Yojana, 2016 (PMGKY)
  - Varishtha Pension Bima Yojana
  - Swachh Bharat Kosh (SBK)

- **Ministry of Women and Child Development (WCD)**
  - e-dropbox
  - Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao Yojana
  - POCSO e-Box
  - Mahila Police Volunteer Initiative
  - National Alliance Against Online Child Sexual Abuse and Exploitation
  - National Action Plan for Children, 2016
- **Ministry of Civil Aviation**
  - Civil Aviation Policy
  - Regional Connectivity Scheme 'Ude Desh ka Aam Naagrik' (UDAN)
- **Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE)**
  - National Wind-Solar Hybrid Policy
  - Solar Energy Corporation of India (SECI)
  - Development of Solar Parks and Ultra Mega Solar Power Projects
- **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology**
  - New IT Ministry to have say over UIDAI and NIC
  - Digital India Awards, 2016
  - Pradhan Mantri Gramin Digital Saksharta Abhiyan
  - Cyber Swachhta Kendra
- **Ministry of Science and Technology**
  - Solar Power Tree
  - Million Minds Augmenting National Aspirations and Knowledge (MANAK)
  - NIDHI (National Initiative for Development and Harnessing Innovations)
  - Biotech-KISAN
- **Ministry of Home Affairs**
  - National Intelligence Grid (NATGRID)
  - Operation Muskaan-II
- **Ministry of Human Resource Development**
  - 'Prashikshak'
  - Technical Education Quality Improvement Programme
  - Smart India Hackathon, 2017

- ❖ Vittiya Saksharata Abhiyan
- ❖ ShaGun
- ❖ UDAAN (Giving Wings to Girl Students)

- **Ministry of Health and Family Welfare**
  - ❖ Pradhan Mantri Swasthya Suraksha Yojana (PMSSY)
  - ❖ National Breastfeeding Promotion Programme
  - ❖ Leprosy Case Detection Campaign (LCDC)
  - ❖ Mission Parivar Vikas
  - ❖ Janani Suraksha Yojna
  - ❖ Pradhan Mantri Surakshit Matritva Abhiyan (PMSMA)
  - ❖ Healthy India Initiative/Swastha Bharat-ek pehal
  - ❖ No More Tension
  - ❖ Swachh Swasth Sarvatra initiative
  - ❖ Universal Immunization Programme (UIP)
  - ❖ National Deworming Programme
  - ❖ SAATHIYA Resource Kit
  - ❖ Rashtriya Kishor Swasthya Karyakram (RKSK)
  - ❖ National Health Policy, 2017
- **Ministry of Information and Broadcasting**
  - ❖ New Print Media Advertisement Policy
- **Ministry of Tourism**
  - ❖ Swadesh Darshan Scheme
- **The Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEF&CC)**
  - ❖ Draft National Forest Policy, 2016
- **Ministry of Labour and Employment**
  - ❖ Model Shops and Establishment (Regulation of Employment and Condition of Services) Bill 2016
  - ❖ Central Board for Workers' Education
- **Ministry of Commerce and Industry**
  - ❖ National Standards Strategy Paper
  - ❖ Merchandise Export from India Scheme (MEIS)
  - ❖ Revenue Insurance Scheme for Plantation Crops (RISPC)
  - ❖ Start-Up India Scheme

- **Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MOSPI)**
  - Member of Parliament Local Area Development (MPLAD)
  - One MP-One Idea
- **Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare**
  - FMD Mukta Bharat (FMD Free India)
  - Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana (PMKSY)
  - e-Pashuhaat Portal
  - Soil Health Card Scheme
  - Ornamental Fisheries Project
  - Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana
  - Paramparagat Krishi Vikas Yojna
  - National Agriculture Market (eNAM)
  - Pandit Deendayal Upadhyay Unnat Krishi Shiksha Scheme
- **Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions**
  - Prime Minister's Annual Award for Excellence in Public Administration
  - DARPGSEVA
- **Ministry of Food Processing Industries**
  - Mega Food Parks Scheme
- **Ministry of Railways**
  - New trains announced
  - Insurance cover for Rail passengers
  - Yatri Mitra Seva
- **Ministry of Defence**
  - Tree plantation drive
- **Ministry of Water Resources, River Development & Ganga Rejuvenation**
  - Smart Ganga City Scheme
  - Accelerated Irrigation Benefits Programme (AIBP)
  - Jal Kranti Abhiyan
- **Ministry of Urban Development**
  - Asli Tarakki
  - Swachh Survekshan, 2017
  - Heritage Infrastructure Development and Augmentation Yojana (HRIDAY)

- ❖ Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation (AMRUT)
- ❖ Smart Cities Mission

- **Ministry of Drinking Water and Sanitation**
  - ❖ Gramin Swachh Survekshan
- **Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region (MDoNER)**
  - ❖ Mobile Air Dispensary
- **Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises**
  - ❖ National SC/ST hub
  - ❖ Zero Defect, Zero Effect (ZED) Scheme
- **Ministry of Mines**
  - ❖ Mining Surveillance System (MSS)
- **Ministry of Road Transport and Highways**
  - ❖ Indian Bridge Management System
  - ❖ Setu Bharatam
- **Ministry of Shipping**
  - ❖ Sagarmala Programme
- **Ministry of Earth Sciences**
  - ❖ HIMANSH
- **Ministry of Minority Affairs**
  - ❖ Management of Haj Pilgrimage
  - ❖ Hunar Haath
  - ❖ USTTAD Scheme
- **Ministry of Housing and Urban Poverty Alleviation**
  - ❖ Pradhan Mantri Awaas Yojana (Urban)
- **Ministry of Rural Development**
  - ❖ Pradhan Mantri Awaas Yojana (Gramin)
  - ❖ Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana – National Rural Livelihoods Mission (DAY – NRLM)
  - ❖ Road Connectivity Project for Left Wing Extremism (LWE) Affected Areas
  - ❖ Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana (PMGSY)
- **Acts/Bills**
  - ❖ Pre-Conception & Pre-Natal Diagnostics Techniques (PC & PNDT) Act, 1994

- ❖ Compensatory and Afforestation Fund (CAF) Bill, 2016
- ❖ Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013
- ❖ The Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education (RTE) Act, 2009
- ❖ Prohibition of Employment as Manual Scavengers and their Rehabilitation Act, 2013
- ❖ Enforcement of Security Interest and Recovery of Debts Laws and Miscellaneous Provisions (Amendment) Bill, 2016
- ❖ Surrogacy (Regulation) Bill, 2016
- ❖ Essential Services Maintenance Act (ESMA)
- ❖ Forest Rights Act, 2006
- ❖ Bihar Prohibition and Excise Act, 2016

- **Miscellaneous**
  - ❖ National Automotive Testing and R&D Infrastructure Project (NATRIP)
  - ❖ National Disaster Management Plan (NDMP)
  - ❖ Good Samaritans
  - ❖ Central Scheme for Assistance to Civilian Victims of Terrorist/ Communal/Left Wing Extremist (LWE), Cross Border Firing and Mine/IED blasts on Indian Territory
  - ❖ Saurastra Narmada Avataran Irrigation (SAUNI) Yojana
  - ❖ Sukanya Samriddhi Account
  - ❖ INDOSAN
  - ❖ Nasha Mukt Bharat Andolan Yatra
  - ❖ Student Start-Up Policy
  - ❖ Prime Ministers Shram Awards
  - ❖ BioAsia 2017
  - ❖ Mission Kakatiya.

10 Appendix 1: Overview of Important Government Schemes in India Launched by Previous Governments

The ministries of Government of India had come up with various schemes time to time. These schemes could be either central, state specific or joint collaboration between the centre and the states. They are detailed below:

Scheme	Ministry	Launched on	Outlay/ Status	Provisions
Aam Aadmi Bima Yojana	MoP		Death and disability insurance for rural landless households	
Bachat Lamp Yojna			Reduce the cost of compact fluorescent lamps	
Central Government Health Scheme	MoHFW	1954	Comprehensive medical care facilities to the central government employees and their family members	
Deendayal Disabled Rehabilitation Scheme	MoSJE	2003	Create an enabling environment to ensure equal opportunities, equity, social justice and empowerment of persons with disabilities	
Gramin Bhandaran Yojna	MoA	2007	Creation of scientific storage capacity with allied facilities in rural areas to meet the requirements of farmers for storing farm produce, processed farm produce and agricultural inputs. Improve their marketability through promotion of grading, standardization and quality control of agricultural produce	
Indira Awaas Yojana	MoRD	1985	Housing for the rural poor	
Indira Gandhi Matritva Sahyog Yojana	MoWCD	2010	A cash incentive of ₹ 4,000 to women (19 years and above) for the first two live births	
Integrated Child Development Services	MoWCD	1975	Tackles malnutrition and health problems in children below six years of age and their mothers	

Integrated Rural Development Programme	MoRD	1978	Self-employment programme to raise the income-generation capacity of target groups among the poor	
Janani Suraksha Yojana	MoHFW	2005	One-time cash incentive to pregnant women for institutional/ home births through skilled assistance	
Kasturba Gandhi Balika Vidyalaya	MoHRD	2004	Educational facilities (residential schools) for girls belonging to SC, ST, OBC, minority communities and families below the poverty line in educationally backward blocks	
Kishore Vaigyanik Protsahan Yojana	MoST	1999	Scholarship programme to encourage students to take up research careers in the areas of basic sciences, engineering and medicine	
Livestock Insurance Scheme (India)	MoA		Insurance to cattle and attaining qualitative improvement in livestock and their products	
Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act	MoRD	2005	₹ 40,000 crore in 2010–11. Legal guarantee for 100 days of employment in every financial year to adult members of any rural household willing to do public work-related unskilled manual work at the statutory minimum wage of ₹ 120 per day in 2009 prices	
Members of Parliament Local Area Development Scheme	MoSPI	1993	Each MP has the choice to suggest to the district collector for works to the tune of ₹ 5 Crores per annum to be taken up in his/her constituency. The Rajya Sabha Member of Parliament can recommend works in one or more districts in the state from where he/she has been elected	
Mid-day Meal Scheme	MoHRD	1995	Lunch (free of cost) to schoolchildren on all working days	
National Literacy Mission Programme	MoHRD	1988	Make 80 million adults in the age group of 35 literate	
National Pension Scheme			January 1 2004, contribution-based pension system	
National Service Scheme	MoYAS		Personality development through social (or community) service	

National Social Assistance Scheme	MoRD	1995	Public assistance to its citizens in case of unemployment, old age, sickness and disablement and in other cases of undeserved wants	
Pradhan Mantri Adarsh Gram Yojana	MoRD	2010	For integrated development of 1,000 villages in the country, each with more than 50% Scheduled Castes (SC) population	
Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana	MoRD	2000	Good all-weather road connectivity to unconnected villages	
Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana	MoA	2007	Achieve 4% annual growth in agriculture through development of agriculture and its allied sectors during the XI Plan period	
Rashtriya Swasthya Bima Yojana	MoLE	2008	Health insurance to poor (BPL), domestic workers, MGNREGA workers, rickshaw pullers, building and other construction workers and many other categories as may be identified by the respective states	
RNTCP	MoHFW	1997	Tuberculosis control initiative	
Sabla or Rajiv Gandhi Scheme for Empowerment of Adolescent Girls	MWCD	2011	Empowering adolescent girls (AGs) of 11–18 years with focus on out-of-school girls by improvement in their nutritional and health status and upgrading various skills like home skills, life skills and vocational skills. Merged Nutrition Programme for Adolescent Girls (NPAG) and Kishori Shakti Yojana (KSY)	
Sampoorna Grameen Rozgar Yojana	MoRD	2001	Providing additional wage employment and food security, alongside the creation of durable community assets in rural areas	
Swabhiman	MoF	2011	To make banking facility available to all citizens and to get 5 crore accounts opened by March 2012	
Swarnajayanti Gram Swarozgar Yojana	MoRD	1999	To bring the assisted poor families above the poverty line by organizing them into self-help groups (SHGs) through the process of social mobilization, their training and capacity building and provision of income generating assets through a mix of bank credit and government subsidy	

Swavalamban	MoF	2010	Pension scheme to the workers in unorganized sectors. Any citizen who is not a part of any statutory pension scheme of the government and contributes between ₹ 1,000 and 12,000 per annum could join the scheme. The central government shall contribute ₹ 1,000 per annum to such subscribers	
Voluntary Disclosure of Income Scheme		1997	Closed on 31 December 1998. Opportunity to the income tax/ wealth tax defaulters to disclose their undisclosed income at the prevailing tax rates.	

11 Appendix 2: Complete List of Schemes Launched by Narendra Modi Government

Name of Scheme	Launch Date
Pradhan Mantri Gramin Digital Saksharta Abhiyan (PMGD-SA)	Announced
Universal Basic Income Scheme	Being Considered
Insurance Scheme for Jan Dhan Account Holders	Proposed
Start-Up India Scheme for Women Entrepreneurs	Upcoming
MUDRA Loan Scheme for Small and Marginal Fisherman	08 March 2017
Green Urban Mobility Scheme	Upcoming
Rashtriya Vayoshri Yojana	01 April 2017
PMAY Loan Scheme Under CLSS for MIG	March 2017
PowerTex India Scheme	01 April 2017
Bharat Ke Veer Portal & App	09 April 2017
BHIM Aadhaar – Aadhaar Payment App for Merchants	14 April 2017
BHIM Referral Bonus and Cashback Scheme	14 April 2017
Enemy Property Law 2017 – Shatru Sampati Kanoon	Upcoming
SAMPADA Scheme for Food Processing Sector	26 May 2017
Visiting Advanced Joint Research (VAJRA) Faculty Scheme	23 June 2017
Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY)	28 August 2014
Pradhan Mantri Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana (PMSSY)	22 January 2015
Pradhan Mantri MUDRA Yojana (PMMY)	08 April 2015
Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana (PMJJBY)	09 May 2015
Pradhan Mantri Suraksha Bima Yojana (PMSBY)	09 May 2015
Atal Pension Yojana (APY)	09 May 2015
Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana – Urban (PMAY– U)	25 June 2015
Sansad Adarsh Gram Yojana (SAGY)	11 October 2014
Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY)	11 October 2014
Pradhan Mantri Gram Sinchai Yojana (PMGSY)	01 July 2015
Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Yojana (PMGKY)	April 2015

Pradhan Mantri Jan Aushadhi Yojana (PMJAY)	March 2016
Make in India	25 September 2014
Swachh Bharat Abhiyan	02 October 2014
Kisan Vikas Patra	03 March 2015 (Re-launched)
Soil Health Card Scheme	17 February 2015
Digital India	01 July 2015
Skill India	16 July 2015
Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao Yojana	22 January 2015
Mission Indradhanush	25 December 2014
Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Gram Jyoti Yojana (DDUGJY)	25 July 2015
Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Grameen Kaushalya Yojana (DDUGKY)	25 July 2015
Pandit Deendayal Upadhyay Shramev Jayate Yojana (PDUS-JY)	16 October 2014
Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation (AMRUT)	24 June 2015
Swadesh Darshan Yojana	09 March 2015
Pilgrimage Rejuvenation and Spiritual Augmentation Drive (PRASAD)	09 March 2015
National Heritage City Development and Augmentation Yojana (HRIDAY)	21 January 2015
Udaan Scheme	14 November 2014
National Bal Swachhta Mission	14 November 2014
One Rank One Pension (OROP) Scheme	05 September 2015
Smart City Mission	25 June 2015
Gold Monetization Schemes	04 November 2015
Start-Up India, Stand-Up India	16 January 2016
DigiLocker	01 July 2015
Integrated Power Development Scheme (IPDS)	18 September 2015
Shyama Prasad Mukherji Rurban Mission	21 February 2016
Sagarmala Project	31 July 2015
'Prakash Path' – 'Way to Light' – The National LED Programme	05 January 2015
UJWAL Discom Assurance Yojana (UDAY)	20 November 2015
Vikalp Scheme	01 November 2015
National Sports Talent Search Scheme (NSTSS)	20 February 2015

Rashtriya Gokul Mission	16 December 2014
PAHAL-Direct Benefits Transfer for LPG (DBTL) Consumers Scheme	01 January 2015
The National Institution for Transforming India (NITI AAYOG)	01 January 2015
Pradhan Mantri Khanij Kshetra Kalyan Yojana (PMKKKY)	17 September 2015
Namami Gange Project	10 July 2014
Setu Bharatam Project	03 March 2016
Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana	01 May 2016
Rashtriya Gram Swaraj Abhiyan	March 2016
Clean My Coach	11 March 2016
Aadhaar Bill	March 2016
Real Estate Bill 2016	Approved in March 2016
Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana – Gramin (Renamed version of Indira Awas Yojana)	20 November 2016
Unnat Bharat Abhiyan	10 December 2014
TB-Mission 2020	28 October 2014
National Apprenticeship Promotion Scheme	01 September 2016
Gangajal Delivery Scheme	10 July 2016
Pradhan Mantri Surakshit Matritva Abhiyan	09 June 2016
Vidyanjali Yojana	16 June 2016
Stand-Up India Loan Scheme	05 April 2016
Gram Uday Se Bharat Uday Abhiyan	14 April 2016
Samajik Adhikarita Shivir	17 September 2016
Railway Travel Insurance Scheme	01 September 2016
Smart Ganga City	13 August 2016
Mission Bhagiratha in Telangana	07 August 2016
Vidyalakshmi Loan Scheme	15 August, 2015
Swayam Prabha	18 July 2016 (Announced)
Pradhan Mantri Surakshit Sadak Yojana	24 May 2016 (Announced)
Shala Ashmita Yojana	25 May 2016 (Announced)
Pradhan Mantri Gram Parivahan Yojana	Re-launched
PM National Health Insurance Scheme	Upcoming

Right to Light Scheme	Upcoming
Rashtriya Sanskriti Mahotsava	15 to 24 December 2016
Ude Desh ka Aam Nagrik (UDAN)	21 October 2016
Digital Village Scheme	Upcoming
Urja Ganga	24 October 2016
Saur Sujala Yojana	01 November 2016
Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat	01 November 2016
Green Urban Transport Scheme (GUTS)	Upcoming
Cease of ₹ 500 and 1,000 Notes to be a legal tender	08 November 2016
Pradhan Mantri Yuva Yojana (PMYY)	09 November 2016
Bharat National Car Assessment Programme (Bharat-NCAP)	Upcoming
Affordable Medicines and Reliable Implants for Treatment (AMRIT)	15 November 2015
Lucky Grahak Yojana	15 December 2016
Digidhan Vyapar Yojana	15 December 2016
BHIM App	30 December 2016
DigiDhan Mela	26 December 2016
National Tribal Carnival 2016	25 October 2016
Pravasi Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PKVY)	Upcoming
Pradhan Mantri Rojgar Protsahan Yojana (PMRPY)	01 August 2016
₹ 6,000 Financial Aid Scheme for Pregnant Women	31 December 2016
Fixed Deposit Scheme for Senior Citizens	31 December 2016
PM KISAN Scheme	1 January 2018
Transformation of Aspirational Districts Programmer	January, 2018
Khelo India School Games Programmer	31 January 2018
National Nutrition Mission	8 March 2018
National Bamboo Mission	25 April 2018
Samagra Shiksha Scheme	24 May 2018
Solar Charkha Mission	27 June 2018
Ayushman Bharat-National Health Protection Mission	25 September 2018
Atal Bhujal Yojana	2018-19
New Pension Scheme for Farmers	2019

12 Appendix 3: List of Government Schemes in India

The ministries of the Government of India have come up with various useful schemes from time to time. These schemes could be either central, state specific or joint collaboration between the centre and the states. They are detailed below:

Scheme	Ministry	Date of Launch	Outlay/ Status statistics	Sector	Provisions
Atal Pension Yojana		9 May 2015		Pension	Social Sector Scheme pertaining to pension sector.
Bachat Lamp Scheme	MoP	1 January 2009		Electrification	Reduces the cost of compact fluorescent lamps.
Central Government Health Scheme	MoHFW	1 January 1954		Health	Comprehensive medical care facilities to central government employees and their family members.
Deendayal Disabled Rehabilitation Scheme	MoSJE	1 January 2003		Social Justice	Creates an enabling environment to ensure equal opportunities, equity, social justice and empowerment of persons with disabilities.
Government Schemes	MoP	1 January 2015		Sarkari Yojana	List of all schemes launched by central government.
Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Grameen Kaushalya Yojna	MoRD	25 July 2015		Rural Development	It is a Government of India project to engage rural youth specially BPL and SC/ST segment of population, in gainful employment through skill training programmes.
Digital India Programme	Mo C & IT	1 July 2015	1 Lakh crore	Digitally Empowered Nation	Aims to ensure that government services are available to citizens electronically and people get benefited from the latest ICT.

Gramin Bhandaran Yojana	MoA	31 March 2007		Agriculture	Creation of scientific storage capacity with allied facilities in rural areas to meet the requirements of farmers for storing farm produce, processed farm produce and agricultural inputs. Improve their marketability through promotion of grading, standardization and quality control of agricultural produce.
Pradhan Mantri Gramin Awaas Yojana	MoRD	25 June 2015		Housing, Rural	Provides financial assistance to rural poor for constructing their houses themselves.
The Indira Gandhi Matritva Sahyog Yojana	MoWCD	1 January 2010		Mother Care	A cash incentive of ₹ 4,000 to women (19 years and above) for the first two live births.
Integrated Child Development Services	MoWCD	2 October 1975		Child Development	Tackle malnutrition and health problems in children below six years of age and their mothers.
Integrated Rural Development Programme	MoRD	1 January 1978		Rural Development	Self-employment programme to raise the income-generation capacity of target groups among the poor, and the scheme has been merged with another scheme named Swarnajayanti Gram Swarozgar Yojana (SGSY) since 01 April 1999.
Janani Suraksha Yojana	MoHFW	1 January 2005		Mother Care	One-time cash incentive to pregnant women for institutional/home births through skilled assistance.
Jawaharlal Nehru National Urban Renewal Mission (JnNURM)	MoUD	3 December 2005		Urban Development	A programme meant to improve the quality of life and infrastructure in the cities. To be replaced by Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation.
Kasturba Gandhi Balika Vidyalaya	MoHRD	1 July 2004		Education	Educational facilities (residential schools) for girls belonging to SC, ST, OBC, minority communities and families below the poverty line(BPL) in educationally backward blocks.

INSPIRE Programme	Department of Science and Technology (India)				Scholarships for top science students, fellowships for pursuing PhD, research grants to researchers.
Kishore Vaigyanik Protsahan Yojana	MoST	1 January 1999			Scholarship programme to encourage students to take up research careers in the areas of basic sciences, engineering and medicine.
Livestock Insurance Scheme	MoA			agriculture	Insurance to cattle and attaining qualitative improvement in livestock and their products.
Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act	MoRD	6 February 2006	₹ 40,000 crore in 2010–11	Rural Wage Employment	Legal guarantee for 100 days of employment in every financial year to adult members of any rural household willing to do public work-related unskilled manual work at the statutory minimum wage of ₹ 120 per day in 2009 prices.
Members of Parliament Local Area Development Scheme	MoSPI	23 December 1993			Each MP has the choice to suggest to the district collector for works to the tune of ₹ 5 Crores per annum to be taken up in his/her constituency. The Rajya Sabha Member of Parliament can recommend works in one or more districts in the state from where he/she has been elected.
Midday Meal Scheme	MoHRD	15 August 1995		Health, Education	Lunch (free of cost) to schoolchildren on all working days.
Namami Gange Programme	MoWR	1 March 1995	₹ 20,000 crore for 5 years	Clean & Protect Ganga	Integrates the efforts to clean and protect the River Ganga in a comprehensive manner.
National Literacy Mission Programme	MoHRD	5 May 1988		Education	To make 80 million adults in the age group of 15–35 literate
National Pension Scheme		1 January 2004		Pension	Contribution-based pension system.

National Scheme on Welfare of Fishermen	MoA			Agriculture	Financial assistance to fishers for construction of house, community hall for recreation and common working place and installation of tubewells for drinking water.
National Service Scheme	MoYAS		1969		Personality development through social (or community) service.
National Social Assistance Scheme	MoRD	15August 1995		Pension	Public assistance to its citizens in case of unemployment, old age, sickness and disablement and in other cases of undeserved wants.
Pooled Finance Development Fund Scheme					
Pradhan Mantri Adarsh Gram Yojana	MoRD	23 July 2010		Model Village	Integrated development of Schedule Caste majority villages in four states.
Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojna	MoSD&E	1 April 2015		Skill Development Initiative Schemes	To provide encouragement to youth for development of employable skills by providing monetary rewards by the recognition of prior learning or by undergoing training at affiliated centres.
Pradhan Mantri Suraksha Bima Yojana	MoF	9 May 2015		Insurance	Accidental Insurance with a premium of ₹ 12 per year.
Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana	MoF	09 May 2015		Insurance	Life insurance of ₹ 2 lakh with a premium of ₹ 330 per year.
Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana	MoF	28 August 2014		Financial Inclusion	National Mission for Financial Inclusion to ensure access to financial services, namely banking savings &deposit accounts, remittance, credit, insurance, pension in an affordable manner.

Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana	MoRD	25 December 2000		Rural Development	Good all-weather road connectivity to unconnected villages.
Rajiv Awas Yojana	MhUPA	1 January 2013		Urban Housing	It envisages a 'Slum Free India' with inclusive and equitable cities in which every citizen has access to basic civic infrastructure and social amenities and decent shelter.
Rajiv Gandhi Grameen Vidyutikaran Yojana	MoP	1April 2005	To be replaced by Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Gram Jyoti Yojana	Rural Electrification	Programme for the creation of Rural Electricity Infrastructure & Household Electrification for providing access to electricity to rural households.
Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana	MoA	1 August 2007		Agriculture	To achieve 4% annual growth in agriculture through development of agriculture and its allied sectors during the XI Plan period.
Rashtriya Swasthya Bima Yojana	MoHFW	01 April 2008		Insurance	Health insurance to poor (BPL), domestic workers, MGNREGA workers, rikshawpullers, building and other construction workers and many other categories as may be identified by the respective states.
RNTCP	MoHFW	01 January 1997		Health	Tuberculosis control initiative.
Saksham or Rajiv Gandhi Scheme for Empowerment of Adolescent Boys	MoWCD	1 January 2014		Skill Development	Aims at all-round development of adolescent boys and make them self-reliant, gender-sensitive and aware citizens, when they grow up. It covers all adolescent boys (both school going and out of school) in the agegroup of 11–18 years subdivided into two categories, viz. 11–14 and 14–18 years. In 2014–15, an allocation of ₹ 25 crore is made for the scheme.

Sabla or Rajiv Gandhi Scheme for Empowerment of Adolescent Girls	MoWCD	1 January 2011		Skill Development	Empowering adolescent girls (age) of 11–18 years with focus on out-of-school girls by improvement in their nutritional and health status and upgrading various skills like home skills, life skills and vocational skills. Merged Nutrition Programme for Adolescent Girls (NPAG) and Kishori Shakti Yojana (KSY).
Sampoorna Grameen Rozgar Yojana	MoRD	25 September 2001		Rural Self Employment	Providing additional wage employment and food security, alongside creation of durable community assets in rural areas.
Swabhiman	MoF	15 February 2011		Financial Inclusion	To make banking facility available to all citizens and to get 5 crore accounts opened by March 2012. Replaced by Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana.
Swarnajayanti Gram Swarozgar Yojana	MoRD	01 April 1999		Rural Employment	Brings the assisted poor families above the poverty line by organizing them into self-help groups (SHGs) through the process of social mobilization, their training and capacity building and provision of income generating assets through a mix of bank credit and government subsidy.
Swavalamban	MoF	26 September 2010	To be replaced by Atal Pension Yojana	Pension	Pension scheme to the workers in unorganized sectors. Any citizen who is not a part of any statutory pension scheme of the government and contributes between ₹ 1,000 and ₹ 12,000 per annum could join the scheme. The central government shall contribute ₹ 1,000 per annum to such subscribers.

Udisha	MoWCD			Child Care	Training programme for ICDS workers.
Voluntary Disclosure of Income Scheme		18 June 1997	Closed on 31 December 1998		Opportunity to the income tax/wealth tax defaulters to disclose their undisclosed income at the prevailing tax rates.
National Rural Livelihood Mission (NRLM)	MoRD	June 2011	US$5.1 Billion		This scheme will organize rural poor into self-help group(SHG) and make them capable for self-employment. The idea is to develop better livelihood options for the poor.
National Urban Livelihood Mission (NULM)	MoHUPA	24 September 2013			This scheme will reduce poverty of urban poor households, specially street vendors who constitute an important segment of urban poor by enabling them to access gainful self-employment and skilled wage employment opportunities.
HRIDAY – Heritage City Development and Augmentation Yojana	MoUD	January 2015		Urban Development	The scheme seeks to preserve and rejuvenate the rich cultural heritage of the country.
Sukanya Samridhi Yojana (Girl Child Prosperity Scheme)	MoWCD	22 January 2015			The scheme primarily ensures equitable share to a girl child in resources and savings of a family in which she is generally discriminated as against a male child.
Smart Cities Mission	MoUD	25 June 2015		Urban Development	To enable better living and drive economic growth stressing on the need for people centric urban planning and development.
AMRUT	MoUD	25 June 2015		Urban Development	To enable better living and drive economic growth stressing on the need for people centric urban planning and development.

Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana (PMAY)	MoHUPA	25 June 2015		Housing	To enable better living and drive economic growth stressing on the need for people centric urban planning and development.
National Child Labour Projects (NCLP)	Ministry of Labour and Employment	launched in 9 districts in 1987 and has been expanded in January 2005 to 250 districts in 21 different states of the country			The objective of this project is to eliminate child labour in hazardous industries by 2010. Under this scheme, the target group is that all children below 14 years of age who are working in occupations and processes listed in the Schedule to the Child Labour (Prohibition & Regulation) Act, 1986 or occupations and processes that are harmful to the health of the child.
National Career Service (India) (NCS)	Ministry of Labour and Employment	20 July 2015		Employment	The objective of this project is to help job-seekers land up at the job they deserve. Under this scheme, an online job-portal named as National Career Service portal has been launched, which acts as a common platform for Jobseekers, employers, skill providers, government departments, placement organizations and counsellors. The portal possesses more than 3.11 crore registered jobseekers and more than 9 lakh employers from across the country.

Antyodaya Anna Yojna	NDA government	25 December 2000			Under the scheme, 1 crore of the poorest among the (Below Poverty Line)BPL families covered under the targeted public distribution system are identified. Issue of Ration Cards. Following the recognition of Antyodaya families, unique quota cards to be recognized as' Antyodaya Ration Card' must be given to the Antyodaya families by the chosen power. The scheme has been further expanded twice by additional 50 lakh BPL families each in June 2003 and in August 2004,thus covering 2 crore families under the AAY scheme.
Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana	MoSD&E	15 July 2015		Skill Development	Seeks to provide the institutional capacity to train a minimum 40 crore skilled people by 2022.
National Food Security Mission	Government of India	2007 for 5 years			It was launched in 2007 for 5 years to increase production and productivity of wheat, rice and pulses on a sustainable basis so as to ensure food security of the country. The aim is to bridge the yield gap in respect of these crops through dissemination of improved technologies and farm management practices.
Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana	MoP&NG	1 May 2016	₹ 8,000 crore		Launched to provide free LPG connections to women from below poverty line families.

Pradhan Mantri Bhartiya Jan Aushadhi Kendra (PMBJK)	Government of India	1 July 2015		Generic Medicine	'Pradhan Mantri Bhartiya Janaushadhi Pariyojana' is a campaign launched by the Department of Pharmaceuticals, Government of India, to provide quality medicines at affordable prices to the masses through special kendra's known as Pradhan Mantri Bhartiya Jan Aushadhi Kendra. Pradhan Mantri Bhartiya Jan Aushadhi Kendra (PMBJK) has been set up to provide generic drugs, which are available at lesser prices but are equivalent in quality and efficacy as expensive branded drugs.
Stand-Up India	DFS, MoF Government of India	5 April 2016		Loans to SC/ ST/Women entrepreneurs for greenfield enterprises	The objective of the Stand-Up India Scheme is to facilitate bank loans between INR 10 lakh (INR 1,00,000) and INR 1 crore (INR 10,000,000) to at least one Scheduled Caste (SC) or Scheduled Tribe (ST) borrower and at least one woman borrower per bank branch for setting up a greenfield enterprise. This enterprise may be in manufacturing, services or the trading sector. In case of non-individual enterprises, at least 51% of the shareholding and controlling stake should be held by either an SC/ST or Woman entrepreneur. Loans can be applied online through the Standup Mitra or Udyami Mitra portals.

Scheme	Ministry	Date of Launch	Outlay	Sector	Provisions
Khelo India School Games (KISG)	Sports	January 31, 2018		Sports culture in India	Develop young sporting talent
Transformation of Aspirational Districts		January 2018		Health and education sector performance	Transformation of districts
National Nutrition Mission	Health	March 8, 2018		Health & nutrition	Proper nutritional status among children (0-6), adolescent girls, pregnant women, & lactating mothers
Galvanising Organic Bio-Agro Resources Dhan (GOBAR-DHAN) scheme	Rural Development	30th April 2019		Rural area	Improve the living conditions in the Indian villages and open-defecation free
Samagra Shiksha scheme	HRD	May 24, 2018	-	Quality education	Education sector-from pre-school to class 12.
Solar Charkha Mission	Power & Energy	June 27, 2018		Energy	Job creation through MSMEs
Ayushman Bharat Yojana	Health	September 25, 2018		National Health Protection	Insurance coverage of ₹ 5 lakh to 10 crore poor families
New Pension Scheme For Farmers	Agriculture	2019		Farming	Voluntry& contributory scheme
End of J&K Special States	Home Affairs	5th August 2019		Union & States	1. Art. 370 is inoperative. 2. J&K converted into: J&K Union Territory with a legislature & Ladakh Union Territory without a legislative.
Swamitva Yojana	Ministry of Panchayati Raj	2020		Rural development	Swamitva Yojana will help in mapping of properties in villages with the help of drones. This will help in reducing disputes over property. The portal will help in making it easier for villagers to avail bank loans.
Garib Kalyan Rojgar Abhiyaan	12 ministries	20 June 2020	₹ 50,000 crore		